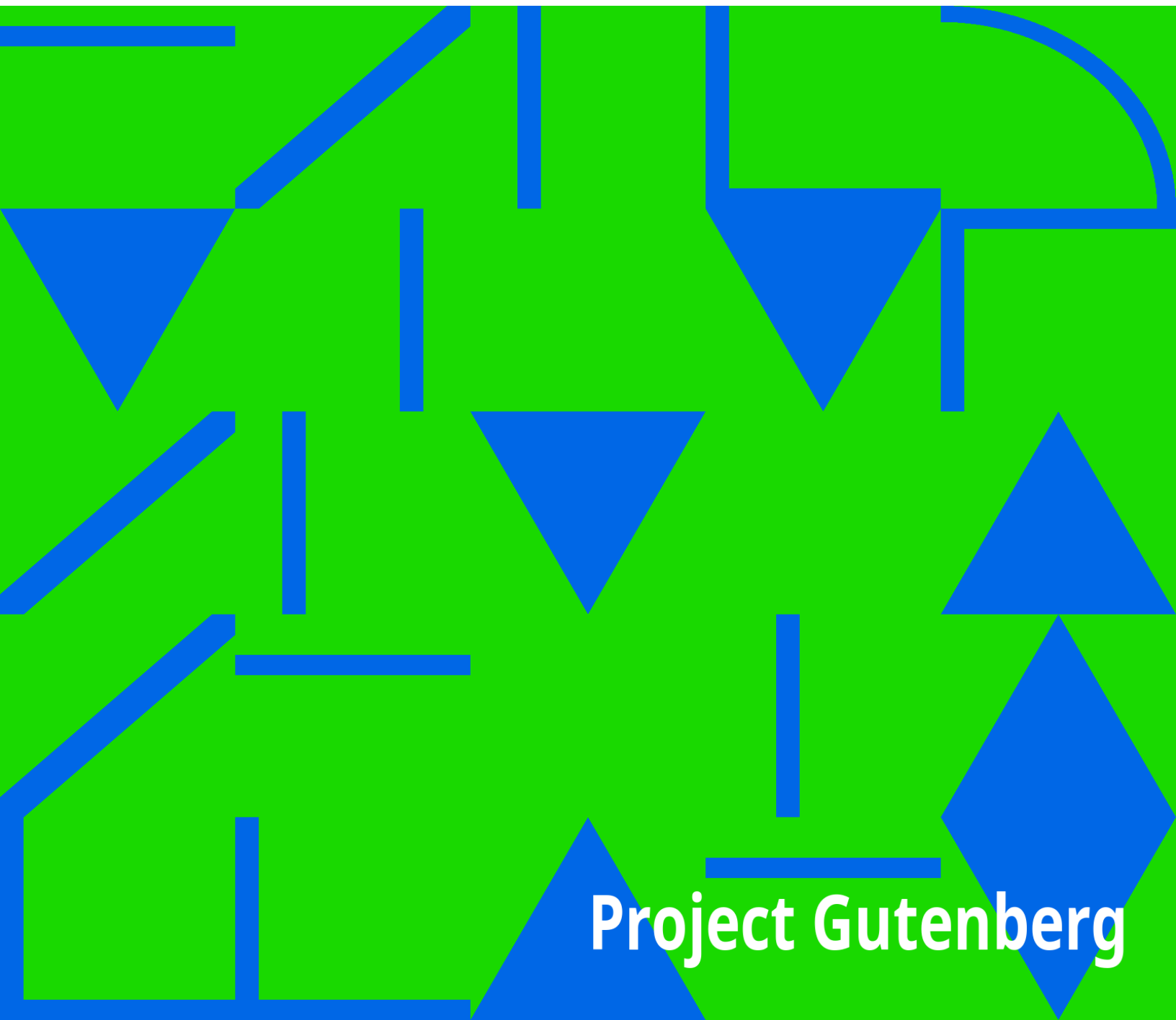


# English Songs and Ballads

The background of the lower half of the image is a vibrant green, overlaid with a complex, abstract pattern of bright blue geometric shapes. These shapes include various sizes of triangles, some pointing upwards and some downwards, as well as rectangles, lines, and a semi-circular arc. The arrangement is non-repeating and creates a dynamic, modern visual texture.

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# English Songs and Ballads

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SONGS AND BALLADS \*\*\*

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(The World's Classics Series)

(Produced by Lewis Jones)

## **ENGLISH SONGS AND BALLADS**

**COMPILED BY T W. H. CROSLAND**

LONDON GRANT RICHARDS 48 LEICESTER SQUARE 1903

Edinburgh: Printed by T. and A. CONSTABLE

First Impression April 1902

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### **NOTE**

'ENGLISH SONGS AND BALLADS' must not be regarded as 'a choice,' but simply as a bringing together of poetical pieces which are, presumably, well known to the average person,—that is to say, the compiler has endeavoured to illustrate the general taste rather than his own preference.

### **INDEX OF FIRST LINES**

(Transcriber's note: No author is cited for the first song in the collection, "My Swete Sweting." Page references in the "Index of First Lines" and in the "Index of Authors" have been expunged since they do not apply to this electronic version; please use electronic searches to locate poems.)

About the sweet bag of a bee  
A chieftain to the Highlands bound

Ae fond kiss, and then we sever  
Agincourt, Agincourt  
Ah, my swete swetyng  
Alas! my love, you do me wrong  
Allen-a-Dale has no faggot for burning  
All in the Downs the fleet was moor'd  
All ye woods, and trees, and bowers  
And did you not hear of a jolly young Waterman  
An old song made by an aged old pate  
A parrot from the Spanish main  
Arm, arm, arm, arm, the scouts are all come in  
A simple child  
As I came thro' Sandgate  
Ask me no more where Jove bestows  
Ask me no more, the moon may draw the sea  
A spirit haunts the year's last hours  
As thro' the land at eve we went  
A sweet disorder in the dress  
Attend all ye who list to hear our noble England's praise  
A weary lot is thine, fair maid  
A Well there is in the west country  
A wet sheet and a flowing sea

Beauty clear and fair  
Be it right or wrong, these men among  
Believe me, if all those endearing young charms  
Bird of the wilderness  
Blame not my Lute! for he must sound  
Blow, blow, thou winter wind  
Blow high, blow low, let tempests tear  
Break, break, break

Busk ye, busk ye, my bonny bonny bride  
But are ye sure the news is true

Call for the robin-redbreast and the wren  
Cherry ripe, ripe, ripe, I cry  
Cold's the wind, and wet's the rain  
Come all ye jolly shepherds  
Come, cheerful day, part of my life to me  
Come, cheer up, my lads, 'tis to glory we steer  
Come follow, follow me  
Come into the garden, Maud  
Come live with me and be my love  
Come not, when I am dead  
Come, Sleep, and with thy sweet deceiving

Dear is my little native vale  
Doubt thou the stars are fire  
Drink to me only with thine eyes  
Duncan Gray came here to woo

Faintly as tolls the evening chime  
Fair daffodils, we weep to see  
Fair pledges of a fruitful tree  
Fair stood the wind for France  
Fear no more the heat o' the sun  
Flow down, cold rivulet, to the sea  
Flow gently, sweet Afton, among thy green braes  
Follow thy fair sun, unhappy shadow  
For auld lang syne, my dear  
Four and twenty bonny boys  
From Oberon, in fairy land

From the forests and highlands  
From the white blossom'd sloe my dear Chloe requested  
Full fathom five thy father lies

Gather the rose-buds while ye may  
God Lyaeus, ever young  
God prosper long our noble King  
God save our gracious King  
Go fetch to me a pint o' wine  
Go, lovely Rose  
Good-morrow to the day so fair  
Good people all, of every sort  
Go where glory waits thee  
Green fields of England, wheresoe'er

Hame, hame, hame, hame fain wad I be  
Hang fear, cast away care  
Hark! now everything is still  
Hark, hark, the lark at Heaven's gate sings  
He is gone on the mountain  
Her arms across her breast she laid  
Here, a sheer hulk, lies poor Tom Bowling  
Her eyes the glow-worm lend thee  
Here's a health unto His Majesty  
Here's to the maiden of bashful fifteen  
Hide me, O twilight air  
Home they brought her warrior dead  
Ho! why dost thou shiver and shake  
How should I your true love know

I arise from dreams of thee  
I cannot eat but little meat  
I come from haunts of coot and hern  
I come, I come! ye have called me long  
I knew an old wife lean and poor  
I lov'd a lass, a fair one  
I'm lonesome since I cross'd the hill  
I'm sitting on the stile, Mary  
In going to my naked bed  
In good King Charles's golden days  
In her ear he whispered gaily  
In the merry month of May  
In Wakefield there lives a jolly pinder  
I sprang to the stirrup, and Joris, and he  
Is there for honest poverty  
I tell thee, Dick, where I have been  
It is an ancient Mariner  
It is the miller's daughter  
I travelled among unknown men  
It was a blind beggar had long lost his sight  
It was a friar of orders gray  
It was a lover and his lass  
It was a summer evening  
It was the frog in the well  
It was the time when lilies blow  
I've seen the smiling  
I wander'd by the brook-side

John Anderson, my jo, John  
John Gilpin was a citizen



Kentish Sir Byng stood for his King  
King Death was a rare old fellow

Lassie wi' the lint-white locks  
Lawn as white as driven snow  
Lay a garland on my hearse  
Let me the canakin clink, clink  
Let the bells ring, and let the boys sing  
Lithe and listen, gentlemen  
Long the proud Spaniards had vaunted to conquer us  
Lord, thou hast given me a cell  
Love wakes and weeps

Maxwelltown braes are bonnie  
Men of England who inherit  
Mine be a cot beside the hill  
Move eastward, happy earth, and leave  
My banks they are furnished with bees  
My heart is sair, I darena tell  
My heart is wasted with my woe  
My mind to me a kingdom is  
O, Willie brew'd a peck o' maut

Napoleon's banners at Boulogne  
No stir in the air, no stir in the sea  
Not a drum was heard, not a funeral note  
Now glory to the Lord of Hosts, from whom all glories are  
Now, now the mirth comes  
Now ponder well, you parents dear  
Now sleeps the crimson petal, now the white  
Now the hungry lion roars

Of all the girls that are so smart  
Of a' the airts the wind can blaw  
Of Nelson and the North  
Oft I had heard of Lucy Gray  
Oft in the stilly night  
Oh, call my brother back to me  
Oh, Mary, go and call the cattle home  
Oh! the days are gone when Beauty bright  
Oh, the sweet contentment  
Oh where, and oh where, is your Highland laddie gone  
O Jenny's a' weet, poor body  
O listen, listen, ladies gay  
O mistress mine, where are you roaming  
O, my luve 's like a red red rose  
O Nanny, wilt thou go with me  
On either side the river lie  
On Linden when the sun was low,  
On that deep-retiring shore  
On the banks of Allan Water  
Orpheus with his lute made trees  
O sing unto my roundelay  
O swallow, swallow, flying south  
Our bugles sang truce, for the night-cloud had lowered  
Over hill, over dale  
O waly, waly up the bank  
O what can ail thee, knight-at-arms  
O whistle and I'll come to ye, my lad  
O world! O life! O time!  
O, young Lochinvar is come out of the West

Pack clouds, away, and welcome, day  
Pibroch of Donuil Dhu  
Piping down the valleys wild  
Proud Maisie in the wood

Queen and huntress, chaste and fair

Red rows the Nith 'tween bank and brae  
Rich and rare were the gems she wore  
Rose cheek'd Laura, come

Scots wha hae wi' Wallace bled  
Shall I, wasting in despair  
She dwelt among untrodden ways  
She is a winsome wee thing  
She is far from the land where her young hero sleeps  
She stood breast high among the corn  
She walks in beauty like the night  
Sigh no more, ladies, sigh no more  
Sing his praises, that doth keep  
Some asked me where the rubies grew  
Some talk of Alexander, and some of Hercules  
Some years of late, in eighty-eight  
So now is come our joyfulest part  
So, we'll go no more a-roving  
Spring, the sweet Spring, is the year's pleasant king  
Still to be neat, still to be drest  
Sweet and low, sweet and low  
Sweet day, so cool, so calm, so bright  
Sweet Emma Moreland of yonder town

Tell me not, sweet, I am unkind  
Tell me, where is fancy bred  
The Assyrian came down like the wolf on the fold  
The boy stood on the burning deck  
The breaking waves dashed high  
The bride cam' out o' the byre  
The deil cam' fiddlin' thro' the toun  
The feathered songster chanticleer  
The fountains mingle with the river  
The glories of our blood and state  
The harp that once through Tara's halls  
The King sits in Dunfermline town  
The laird o' Cockpen, he's proud an' he 's great  
The lawns were dry in Euston park  
The minstrel boy to the war is gone  
There be none of Beauty's daughters  
There came to the beach a poor exile of Erin,  
There come seven gypsies on a day  
There is a garden in her face  
There is not in the wide world a valley so sweet  
There was a youth, a well beloved youth  
There was three kings into the East  
There were three ladies play'd at the ba'  
There were three sailors of Bristol city  
The splendour falls on castle walls  
The stars are with the voyager  
The stately homes of England  
The time I've lost in wooing  
They grew in beauty side by side  
Three fishers went sailing out into the west

Tiger, tiger, burning bright  
'Tis the last rose of summer  
Toll for the brave  
Turn, gentle hermit of the dale  
'Twas in the prime of summer time

Under the greenwood tree

Was this fair face the cause, quoth she  
Wha 'll buy my caller herrin'  
When all among the thundering drums  
When all is done and said  
When Britain first, at Heaven's command  
When cats run home, and light is come  
When daffodils begin to peer,  
When daisies pied and violets blue,  
When Hercules did use to spin  
When icicles hang by the wall  
When love with unconfined wings  
When o'er the hill the Eastern star  
When the British warrior queen  
When the sheep are in the fauld, when the kye 's come hame  
When this old cap was new  
When we two parted  
Where gang ye, thou silly auld carle  
Where the bee sucks, there lurk I  
While larks with little wing  
Who is Sylvia? what is she  
Why does your brand so drop with blood  
Why do ye weep, sweet babes? Can tears

Why so pale and wan, fond lover  
With fingers weary and worn

Ye gentlemen of England  
Ye little birds that sit and sing  
Ye mariners of England  
You are old, father William, the young man cried  
You spotted snakes with double tongue

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# SONGS AND BALLADS

## MY SWETE SWETING

AH, my swete swetyng!  
My lytyle prety swetyng,  
My swetyng will I love wherever I go;  
She is so proper and pure,  
Full stedfast, stabill and demure,  
There is none such, ye may be sure,  
As my swete swetyng.

In all this world, as thynketh me,  
Is none so pleasant to my eye,  
That I am glad soe ofte to see,  
As my swete swetyng.

When I behold my swetyng swete,  
Her face, her hands, her minion fete,  
They seme to me there is none so swete,  
As my swete swetyng.

Above all other prayse must I,  
And love my pretty pygsnye,



For none I fynd so womanly  
As my swete swetyng.

*LORD VAUX*

### **THINKING**

WHEN all is done and said,  
In the end thus shall you find,  
He most of all doth bathe in bliss  
That hath a quiet mind:  
And, clear from worldly cares,  
To deem can be content  
The sweetest time in all his life  
In thinking to be spent.

The body subject is  
To fickle Fortune's power,  
And to a million of mishaps  
Is casual every hour:  
And Death in time doth change  
It to a clod of clay;  
Whenas the mind, which is divine,  
Runs never to decay.

Companion none is like  
Unto the mind alone;  
For many have been harmed by speech  
Through thinking, few, or none.

Fear oftentimes restraineth words,  
But makes not thought to cease;  
And he speaks best that hath the skill  
When for to hold his peace.

Our wealth leaves us at death;  
Our kinsmen at the grave;  
But virtues of the mind unto  
The heavens with us we have.  
Wherefore, for virtue's sake,  
I can be well content,  
The sweetest time of all my life  
To deem in thinking spent.

*RICHARD EDWARDES*

### **THE FALLING OUT OF FAITHFUL FRIENDS**

IN going to my naked bed as one that would have slept,  
I heard a wife sing to her child, that long before had wept;  
She sighed sore, and sang full sweet, to bring the babe to rest,  
That would not cease, but cried still, in sucking at her breast.  
She was full weary of her watch, and grieved with her child;  
She rocked it and rated it, till that on her it smiled:  
Then did she say, Now have I found this proverb true to prove  
The falling out of faithful friends, renewing is of love.

Then took I paper, pen, and ink, this proverb for to write,  
In register for to remain, of such a worthy wight;

As she proceeded thus in song unto her little brat,  
Much matter uttered she of weight, in place whereas she sat.  
And proved plain, there was no beast, nor creature bearing life,  
Could well be known to live in love, without discord and strife:  
Then kissed she her little babe, and sware by God above,  
The falling out of faithful friends, renewing is of love.

She said that neither king, nor prince, nor lord could live aright,  
Until their puissance they did prove, their manhood and their might;  
When manhood shall be matched so that fear can take no place,  
Then weary works make warriors each other to embrace,  
And leave their force that failed them, which did consume the rout,  
That might before have lived in peace their time and nature out:  
Then did she sing as one that thought no man could her reprove,  
The falling out of faithful friends, renewing is of love.

She said she saw no fish, nor fowl, nor beast within her haunt,  
That met a stranger in their kind, but could give it a taunt;  
Since flesh might not endure for long, but rest must wrath succeed,  
And force the fight to fall to play, in pasture where they feed;  
So noble nature can well end the work she hath begun,  
And bridle well that will not cease her tragedy in some:  
Thus in her song she oft rehearsed, as did her well behove,  
The falling out of faithful friends, renewing is of love.

I marvel much pardy, quoth she, for to behold the rout,  
To see man, woman, boy, and beast, to toss the world about;  
Some kneel, some crouch, some beck, some cheek, and some can  
smoothly smile,  
And some embrace others in arm, and there think many a wile;  
Some stand aloof at cap and knee, some humble and some stout,

Yet are they never friends in deed until they once fall out:  
Thus ended she her song, and said before she did remove,  
The falling out of faithful friends, renewing is of love.

## *SIR THOMAS WYATT*

### **THE LOVER'S LUTE**

BLAME not my Lute! for he must sound  
Of this or that as liketh me;  
For lack of wit the Lute is bound  
To give such tunes as pleaseth me;  
Though my songs be somewhat strange,  
And speak such words as touch my change,  
Blame not my Lute!

My Lute, alas! doth not offend,  
Though that perforce he must agree  
To sound such tunes as I intend  
To sing to them that heareth me;  
Then though my songs be somewhat plain,  
And toucheth some that use to feign,  
Blame not my Lute!

My Lute and strings may not deny,  
But as I strike they must obey;  
Break not them so wrongfully,  
But wreak thyself some other way;  
And though the songs which I indite

Do quit thy change with rightful spite,  
Blame not my Lute!

Spite asketh spite, and changing change,  
And falsed faith must needs be known;  
The faults so great, the case so strange;  
Of right it must abroad be blown:  
Then since that by thine own desert  
My songs do tell how true thou art,  
Blame not my Lute!

Blame but thyself that hast misdone,  
And well deserved to have blame;  
Change thou thy way, so evil begone,  
And then my Lute shall sound that same;  
But if till then my fingers play,  
By thy desert their wonted way,  
Blame not my Lute!

Farewell! unknown; for though thou break  
My strings in spite with great disdain,  
Yet have I found out for thy sake,  
Strings for to string my Lute again:  
And if perchance this silly rhyme  
Do make thee blush at any time,  
Blame not my Lute!

*CHRISTOPHER MARLOWE*

**THE PASSIONATE SHEPHERD TO HIS LOVE**

COME live with me and be my Love,  
And we will all the pleasures prove  
That hills and valleys, dale and field,  
And all the craggy mountains yield.

There will we sit upon the rocks  
And see the shepherds feed their flocks,  
By shallow rivers, to whose falls  
Melodious birds sing madrigals.

There will I make thee beds of roses  
And a thousand fragrant posies,  
A cap of flowers, and a kirtle  
Embroider'd all with leaves of myrtle.

A gown made of the finest wool,  
Which from our pretty lambs we pull,  
Fair lined slippers for the cold,  
With buckles of the purest gold.

A belt of straw and ivy buds  
With coral clasps and amber studs:  
And if these pleasures may thee move,  
Come live with me and be my Love.

Thy silver dishes for thy meat  
As precious as the gods do eat,  
Shall on an ivory table be  
Prepared each day for thee and me.

The shepherd swains shall dance and sing  
For thy delight each May morning:

If these delights thy mind may move,  
Then live with me and be my Love.

*JOHN STILL*

### **JOLLY GOOD ALE AND OLD**

I CANNOT eat but little meat,  
My stomach is not good;  
But sure I think that I can drink  
With him that wears a hood.  
Though I go bare, take ye no care,  
I nothing am a-cold;  
I stuff my skin so full within  
Of jolly good ale and old.  
Back and side go bare, go bare;  
Both foot and hand go cold;  
But, belly, God send thee good ale enough,  
Whether it be new or old.

I love no roast but a nut-brown toast,  
And a crab laid in the fire;  
A little bread shall do me stead,  
Much bread I not desire,  
No frost nor snow, no wind, I trow,  
Can hurt me if I wold;  
I am so wrapp'd and thoroughly lapp'd  
Of jolly good ale and old.

And Tib, my wife, that as her life  
Loveth well good ale to seek,  
Full oft drinks she till ye may see  
The tears run down her cheek.  
Then doth she trowl to me the bowl  
Even as a maltworm should,  
And saith, 'Sweetheart, I took my part  
Of this jolly good ale and old.'

Now let them drink till they nod and wink,  
Even as good fellows should do;  
They shall not miss to have the bliss  
Good ale doth bring men to;  
And all poor souls that have scour'd bowls,  
Or have them lustily troll'd,  
God save the lives of them and their wives  
Whether they be young or old.  
Back and side go bare, go bare;  
Both foot and hand go cold;  
But, belly, God send thee good ale enough,  
Whether it be new or old.

*NICHOLAS BRETON*

### **PHILLIDA AND CORYDON**

IN the merry month of May,  
In a morn by break of day,



With a troop of damsels playing  
Forth I went forsooth a-maying.

When anon by a wood side,  
Where, as May was in his pride,  
I espied, all alone,  
Phillida and Corydon.

Much ado there was, God wot!  
He would love, and she would not,  
She said, never man was true:  
He says none was false to you;

He said he had lov'd her long;  
She says love should have no wrong,  
Corydon would kiss her then;  
She says, maids must kiss no men,

Till they do for good and all,  
When she made the shepherd call  
All the heavens to witness truth,  
Never lov'd a truer youth.

Then with many a pretty oath,  
Yea and nay, faith and troth,  
Such as silly shepherds use,  
When they will not love abuse;

Love, which had been long deluded,  
Was with kisses sweet concluded;  
And Phillida with garlands gay  
Was made the lady of May.

*THOMAS NASH*

**SPRING**

SPRING, the sweet Spring, is the year's pleasant king;  
Then blooms each thing, then maids dance in a ring,  
Cold doth not sting, the pretty birds do sing,  
Cuckoo, jug-jug, pu-we, to-witta-woo!

The palm and may make country houses gay,  
Lambs frisk and play, the shepherds pipe all day,  
And we hear aye birds tune this merry lay,  
Cuckoo, jug-jug, pu-we, to-witta-woo.

The fields breathe sweet, the daisies kiss our feet  
Young lovers meet, old wives a-sunning sit,  
In every street these tunes our ears do greet,  
Cuckoo, jug-jug, pu-we, to-witta-woo!  
Spring! the sweet Spring!

*SIR EDWARD DYER*

**MY MIND TO ME A KINGDOM IS**

My mind to me a kingdom is,  
Such perfect joy therein I find,  
That it excels all other bliss  
That God or nature hath assigned:

Though much I want that most would have,  
Yet still my mind forbids to crave.

No princely port, nor wealthy store,  
Nor force to win a victory;  
No wily wit to salve a sore,  
No shape to win a loving eye;  
To none of these I yield as thrall,  
For why, my mind despise them all.

I see that plenty surfeits oft,  
And hasty climbers soonest fall;  
I see that such as are aloft,  
Mishap doth threaten most of all;  
These get with toil, and keep with fear:  
Such cares my mind can never bear.

I press to bear no haughty sway;  
I wish no more than may suffice;  
I do no more than well I may,  
Look what I want, my mind supplies;  
Lo, thus I triumph like a king,  
My mind's content with any thing.

I laugh not at another's loss,  
Nor grudge not at another's gain;  
No worldly waves my mind can toss;  
I brook that is another's bane;  
I fear no foe, nor fawn on friend;  
I loathe not life, nor dread mine end.

My wealth is health and perfect ease,  
And conscience clear my chief defence,  
I never seek by bribes to please,  
Nor by desert to give offence;  
Thus do I live, thus will I die;  
Would all do so as well as I!

*JAMES SHIRLEY*

### **DEATH THE LEVELLER**

THE glories of our blood and state  
Are shadows, not substantial things;  
There is no armour against fate;  
Death lays his icy hand on kings:  
Sceptre and Crown  
Must tumble down,  
And in the dust be equal made  
With the poor crooked scythe and spade.

Some men with swords may reap the field,  
And plant fresh laurels where they kill:  
But their strong nerves at last must yield;  
They tame but one another still:  
Early or late  
They stoop to fate,  
And must give up their murmuring breath  
When they, pale captives, creep to death.

The garlands wither on your brow;  
Then boast no more your mighty deeds;  
Upon Death's purple altar now  
See where the victor-victim bleeds:  
Your heads must come  
To the cold tomb;  
Only the actions of the just  
Smell sweet, and blossom in the dust.

*THOMAS HEYWOOD*

**YE LITTLE BIRDS THAT SIT AND SING**

Yz, little birds that sit and sing  
Amidst the shady valleys,  
And see how Phillis sweetly walks  
Within her garden-alleys;  
Go, pretty birds, about her bower;  
Sing, pretty birds, she may not lower;  
Ah me! methinks I see her frown!  
Ye pretty wantons, warble.

Go tell her through your chirping bills,  
As you by me are bidden,  
To her is only known my love,  
Which from the world is hidden.  
Go, pretty birds, and tell her so,  
See that your notes strain not too low,

For still methinks I see her frown;  
Ye pretty wantons, warble.

Go tune your voices' harmony  
And sing, I am her lover;  
Strain loud and sweet, that every note  
With sweet content may move her:  
And she that hath the sweetest voice,  
Tell her I will not change my choice:  
—Yet still methinks I see her frown!  
Ye pretty wantons, warble.

O fly! make haste! see, see, she falls  
Into a pretty slumber!  
Sing round about her rosy bed  
That waking she may wonder:  
Say to her, 'tis her lover true  
That sendeth love to you, to you!  
And when you hear her kind reply,  
Return with pleasant warblings.

## **PACK CLOUDS, AWAY**

PACK clouds, away, and welcome, day!  
With night we banish sorrow.  
Sweet air, blow soft; mount, lark, aloft  
To give my Love good-morrow!  
Wings from the wind to please her mind,  
Notes from the lark I'll borrow;  
Bird, prune thy wing! nightingale, sing!  
To give my Love good-morrow!

To give my Love good-morrow  
Notes from them all I'll borrow.

Wake from thy nest, robin red-breast!  
Sing, birds, in every furrow!  
And from each bill let music shrill  
Give my fair Love good-morrow!  
Blackbird and thrush in every bush,  
Stare, linnet, and cocksparrow,  
You pretty elves, among yourselves  
Sing my fair Love good-morrow!  
To give my Love good-morrow!  
Sing, birds, in every furrow!

## *BEAUMONT AND FLETCHER*

### **SLEEP**

COME, Sleep, and with thy sweet deceiving  
Lock me in delight awhile;  
Let some pleasing dreams beguile  
All my fancies; that from thence  
I may feel an influence  
All my powers of care bereaving!

Though but a shadow, but a sliding,  
Let me know some little joy!  
We that suffer long annoy  
Are contented with a thought

Through an idle fancy wrought:  
O let my joys have some abiding!

### **SONG TO PAN**

ALL ye woods, and trees, and bowers,  
All ye virtues and ye powers  
That inhabit in the lakes,  
In the pleasant springs or brakes,  
Move your feet  
To our sound,  
Whilst we greet,  
All this ground,  
With his honour and his name  
That defends our flocks from blame.

He is great and he is just,  
He is ever good, and must  
Thus be honoured. Daffodillies,  
Roses, pinks, and loved lilies,  
Let us fling,  
Whilst we sing,  
Ever holy,  
Ever holy,  
Ever honoured, ever young!  
Thus great Pan is ever sung.

### **ASPATIA'S SONG**



LAY a garland on my hearse  
Of the dismal yew;  
Maidens, willow branches bear;  
Say, I died true.

My love was false, but I was firm  
From my hour of birth.  
Upon my buried body lie  
Lightly, gentle earth!

*JOHN FLETCHER*

**BEAUTY CLEAR AND FAIR**

BEAUTY clear and fair,  
Where the air  
Rather like a perfume dwells;  
Where the violet and the rose  
Their blue veins and blush disclose,  
And come to honour nothing else:

Where to live near  
And planted there  
Is to live, and still live new;  
Where to gain a favour is  
More than light, perpetual bliss—  
Make me live by serving you!

Dear, again back recall  
To this light,

A stranger to himself and all!  
Both the wonder and the story  
Shall be yours, and eke the glory;  
I am your servant, and your thrall.

## **LET THE BELLS RING, AND LET THE BOYS SING**

LET the bells ring, and let the boys sing,  
The young lasses skip and play;  
Let the cups go round, till round goes the ground,  
Our learned old vicar will stay.

Let the pig turn merrily, merrily, ah  
And let the fat goose swim;  
For verily, verily, verily, oh!  
Our vicar this day shall be trim.

The stewed cock shall crow, cock-a-loodle-loo,  
A loud cock-a-loodle shall he crow;  
The duck and the drake shall swim in a lake  
Of onions and claret below.

Our wives shall be neat, to bring in our meat  
To thee our most noble adviser;  
Our pains shall be great, and bottles shall sweat,  
And we ourselves will be wiser.

We'll labour and smirk, we'll kiss and we'll drink,  
And tithes shall come thicker and thicker;  
We'll fall to our plough, and have children enow,  
And thou shalt be learned old vicar.

## **WEEP NO MORE**

WEEP no more, nor sigh, nor groan,  
Sorrow calls no time that's gone:  
Violets pluck'd, the sweetest rain  
Makes not fresh nor grow again.  
Trim thy locks, look cheerfully;  
Fate's hid ends eyes cannot see.  
Joys as winged dreams fly fast,  
Why should sadness longer last?  
Grief is but a wound to woe;  
Gentlest fair, mourn, mourn no more.

## **PAN**

SING his praises that doth keep  
Our flocks from harm,  
Pan, the father of our sheep;  
And arm in arm  
Tread we softly in a round,  
Whilst the hollow neighbouring ground  
Fills the music with her sound.

Pan, O great god Pan, to thee  
Thus do we sing!  
Thou who keep'st us chaste and free  
As the young spring:  
Ever be thy honour spoke,  
From that place the morn is broke,  
To that place day doth unyoke!

## **GOD LYAEUS**

GOD LYAEUS, ever young,  
Ever honour'd, ever sung,  
Stain'd with blood of lusty grapes,  
In a thousand lusty shapes  
Dance upon the mazer's brim,  
In the crimson liquor swim;  
From thy plenteous hand divine  
Let a river run with wine:  
God of youth, let this day here  
Enter neither care nor fear.

## **A BATTLE-SONG**

ARM, arm, arm, arm! the scouts are all come in;  
Keep your ranks close, and now your honours win.  
Behold from yonder hill the foe appears;  
Bows, bills, glaives, arrows, shields, and spears!  
Like a dark wood he comes, or tempest pouring;  
O view the wings of horse the meadows scouring!  
The vanguard marches bravely. Hark, the drums!  
Dub, dub!

They meet, they meet, and now the battle comes:  
See how the arrows fly  
That darken all the sky!  
Hark how the trumpets sound!  
Hark how the hills rebound—  
Tara, tara, tara, tara, tara!

Hark how the horses charge! in, boys! boys, in!  
The battle totters; now the wounds begin:  
O how they cry!  
O how they die!  
Room for the valiant Memnon, armed with thunder!  
See how he breaks the ranks asunder!  
They fly! they fly! Eumenes has the chase,  
And brave Polybius makes good his place:  
To the plains, to the woods,  
To the rocks, to the floods,  
They fly for succour. Follow, follow, follow!  
Hark how the soldiers hollow!  
Hey, hey!

Brave Diodes is dead,  
And all his soldiers fled;  
The battle 's won, and lost,  
That many a life hath cost.

*ANONYMOUS*

### **MY LADY GREENSLEEVES**

ALAS! my love, you do me wrong  
To cast me off discourteously;  
And I have loved you so long,  
Delighting in your company.

Greensleeves was all my joy!  
Greensleeves was my delight!  
Greensleeves was my heart of gold!  
And who but my Lady Greensleeves!

I bought thee petticoats of the best,  
The cloth so fine as fine as might be;  
I gave thee jewels for thy chest,  
And all this cost I spent on thee.  
Greensleeves was all my joy!  
Greensleeves was my delight!  
Greensleeves was my heart of gold!  
And who but my Lady Greensleeves!

Thy smock of silk, both fair and white,  
With gold embroidered gorgeously;  
Thy petticoat of sendal right:  
And these I bought thee gladly.  
Greensleeves was all my joy!  
Greensleeves was my delight!  
Greensleeves was my heart of gold!  
And who but my Lady Greensleeves!

Greensleeves now farewell! adieu!  
God I pray to prosper thee!  
For I am still thy lover true:  
Come once again and love me!  
Greensleeves was all my joy!  
Greensleeves was my delight!  
Greensleeves was my heart of gold!  
And who but my Lady Greensleeves!

*SIR PHILIP SIDNEY*

**MY TRUE LOVE**

MY true love hath my heart, and I have his,  
By just exchange one for another given:  
I hold his dear, and mine he cannot miss;  
There never was a better bargain driven:  
My true love hath my heart, and I have his.

His heart in me keeps him and me in one,  
My heart in him his thoughts and senses guides:  
He loves my heart, for once it was his own,  
I cherish his because in me it bides:  
My true love hath my heart, and I have his.

*JOHN WEBSTER*

**DIRGE**

CALL for the robin-redbreast and the wren,  
Since o'er shady groves they hover,  
And with leaves and flowers do cover  
The friendless bodies of unburied men.  
Call unto his funeral dole  
The ant, the field-mouse, and the mole,  
To rear him hillocks that shall keep him warm,  
And (when gay tombs are robb'd) sustain no harm;

But keep the wolf far thence, that's foe to men,  
For with his nails he'll dig them up again.

## **THE SHROUDING**

HARK! now everything is still,  
The screech-owl and the whistler shrill,  
Call upon our dame aloud,  
And bid her quickly don her shroud!

Much you had of land and rent;  
Your length in clay's now competent:  
A long war disturb'd your mind;  
Here your perfect peace is sign'd.

Of what is't fools make such vain keeping?  
Sin their conception, their birth weeping,  
Their life a general mist of error,  
Their death a hideous storm of terror.  
Strew your hair with powders sweet,  
Don clean linen, bathe your feet,  
And—the foul fiend more to check—  
A crucifix let bless your neck;  
'Tis now full tide 'tween night and day;  
End your groan and come away.

*THOMAS DEKKER*

## **CONTENT**



ART thou poor, yet hast thou golden slumbers?

O sweet content!

Art thou rich, yet is thy mind perplex'd?

O punishment!

Dost thou laugh to see how fools are vex'd

To add to golden numbers, golden numbers?

O sweet content! O sweet, O sweet content!

Work apace, apace, apace, apace;

Honest labour bears a lovely face;

Then hey nonny nonny, hey nonny nonny!

Canst drink the waters of the crisped spring?

O sweet content!

Swimm'st thou in wealth, yet sink'st in thine own tears?

O punishment!

Then he that patiently want's burden bears

No burden bears, but is a king, a king!

O sweet content! O sweet, O sweet content!

Work apace, apace, apace, apace;

Honest labour bears a lovely face;

Then hey nonny nonny, hey nonny nonny!

## **TROLL THE BOWL**

COLD's the wind, and wet's the rain,

Saint Hugh be our good speed!

Ill is the weather that bringeth no gain,

Nor helps good hearts in need.

Troll the bowl, the jolly nut-brown bowl,

And here, kind mate, to thee!

Let's sing a dirge for Saint Hugh's soul,  
And down it merrily.

Down-a-down, hey, down-a-down,  
Hey derry derry down-a-down.  
Ho! well done, to let me come,  
Ring compass, gentle joy!

Troll the bowl, the nut-brown bowl,  
And here, kind mate, to thee!  
Let's sing a dirge for Saint Hugh's soul,  
And down it merrily.

Cold's the wind, and wet's the rain,  
Saint Hugh be our good speed!  
Ill is the weather that bringeth no gain,  
Nor helps good hearts in need.

## *ANONYMOUS*

### **SIR PATRICK SPENS**

THE king sits in Dunfermline toun,  
Drinking the blude-red wine;  
Oh whare will I get a gude sailor,  
To sail this ship o' mine?'

Then up and spake an eldern knight  
Sat at the king's right knee;

'Sir Patrick Spens is the best sailor  
That ever sail'd the sea.'

The king has written a braid letter,  
And seal'd it wi' his hand,  
And sent it to Sir Patrick Spens  
Was walking on the strand.

'To Noroway, to Noroway,  
To Noroway o'er the faem;  
The king's daughter to Noroway,  
'Tis thou maun tak' her hame.'

The first line that Sir Patrick read,  
A loud laugh laughed he;  
The neist line that Sir Patrick read,  
The tear blinded his ee.

'O wha is this has done this deed,  
And tauld the king o' me,  
To send us out at this time o' the year,  
To sail upon the sea?'

'Be't wind or weet, be't hail or sleet,  
Our ship maun sail the faem;  
The king's daughter to Noroway,  
'Tis we maun tak' her hame.'

They hoisted their sails on Monenday morn,  
Wi' a' the speed they may;  
And they hae landed in Noroway  
Upon a Wodensday.

They hadna been a week, a week,  
In Noroway but twae,  
When that the lords o' Noroway  
Began aloud to say—

'Ye Scotisman spend a' our king's gowd,  
And a' our queenis fee.'  
'Ye lee, ye lee, ye leears loud,  
Sae loud 's I hear ye lee!'

'For I brought as much o' the white monie  
As gane my men and me,  
And a half-fou o' the gude red gowd,  
Out owre the sea with me.

'Mak' ready, mak' ready, my merry men a',  
Our gude ship sails the morn.'  
'O say na sae, my master dear,  
I fear a deadlie storm.

'I saw the new moon late yestreen,  
Wi' the auld moon in her arm;  
And if we gang to sea, master,  
I fear we'll come to harm!'

They hadna sail'd a league, a league,  
A league but barely three,  
When the lift grew dark, and the wind blew loud  
And gurly grew the sea.

The ankers brak, and the tap-masts lap,  
It was sic a deadlie storm;

And the waves cam' owre the broken ship,  
Till a' her sides were torn.

'O whare will I get a gude sailor  
Will tak' the helm in hand,  
Till I get up to the tall tap-mast,  
To see if I can spy land.'

'O here am I, a sailor gude,  
To tak' the helm in hand,  
Till ye get up to the tall tap-mast,  
But I fear ye'll ne'er spy land.'

He hadna gane a step, a step,  
A step but barely ane,  
When a bout flew out o' the gude ship's side,  
And the saut sea it cam in.

'Gae, fetch a web o' the silken claith,  
Anither o' the twine,  
And wap them into our gude ship's side,  
And letna the sea come in.'

They fetch'd a wab o' the silken claith,  
Anither o' the twine,  
And they wapp'd them into the gude ship's side,  
But aye the sea cam' in.

O laith, laith were our Scots lords' sons  
To weet their coal-black shoon,  
But lang ere a' the play was play'd,  
They wat their hats abune.

And mony was the feather-bed  
That fluttered on the faem,  
And mony was the gude lord's son  
That never mair cam' hame.

O lang, lang may the ladies sit,  
Wi' their fans into their hand,  
Before they see Sir Patrick Spens  
Come sailing to the strand.

And lang, lang may the maidens sit,  
Wi' the gowd kaims in their hair,  
A' waiting for their ain dear loves,  
For them they'll see nae mair.

Half owre, half owre to Aberdour  
'Tis fifty fathom deep,  
And there lies gude Sir Patrick Spens  
Wi' the Scots lords at his feet.

## **THE BEGGAR'S DAUGHTER OF BEDNALL-GREEN**

### **PART I**

IT was a blind beggar, had long lost his sight,  
He had a fair daughter of beauty most bright;  
And many a gallant brave suitor had she,  
For none was so comely as pretty Bessee.

And though she was of favour most faire,  
Yet seeing she was but a poor beggar's heyre,

Of ancient housekeepers despised was she,  
Whose sons came as suitors to pretty Bessee.

Wherefore in great sorrow fair Bessy did say,  
Good father, and mother, let me go away  
To seek out my fortune, whatever it be,  
This suite then they granted to pretty Bessee.

Then Bessy, that was of beauty so bright,  
All cladd in grey russet, and late in the night  
From father and mother alone parted she;  
Who sighed and sobbed for pretty Bessee.

She went till she came to Stratford-le-Bow;  
Then knew she not whither, nor which way to go:  
With tears she lamented her hard destinie,  
So sad and so heavy was pretty Bessee.

She kept on her journey until it was day,  
And went unto Rumford along the high way;  
Where at the Queen's arms entertained was she:  
So fair and well-favoured was pretty Bessee.

She had not been there a month to an end,  
But master and mistress and all was her friend:  
And every brave gallant, that once did her see,  
Was straightway enamour'd of pretty Bessee.

Great gifts they did send her of silver and gold,  
And in their songs daily her love was extolled;  
Her beauty was blazed in every degree;  
So fair and so comely was pretty Bessee.

The young men of Rumford in her had their joy  
She showed herself courteous and modestly coy  
And at her commandment still would they be;  
So fair and so comely was pretty Bessee.

Four suitors at once unto her did go;  
They craved her favour, but still she said no;  
I would not wish gentles to marry with me;  
Yet ever they honoured pretty Bessee.

The first of them was a gallant young knight,  
And he came unto her disguised in the night:  
The second a gentleman of good degree,  
Who wooed and sued for pretty Bessee.

A merchant of London, whose wealth was not small,  
He was the third suitor, and proper withal:  
Her master's own son the fourth man must be,  
Who swore he would die for pretty Bessee.

And, if thou wilt marry with me, quoth the knight,  
I'll make thee a lady with joy and delight;  
My heart's so enthralled by thy beautie,  
That soon I shall die for pretty Bessee.

The gentleman said, Come, marry with me,  
As fine as a lady my Bessy shall be:  
My life is distressed: O hear me, quoth he;  
And grant me thy love, my pretty Bessee.

Let me be thy husband; the merchant did say,  
Thou shalt live in London both gallant and gay;



My ships shall bring home rich jewels for thee,  
And I will for ever love pretty Bessee.

Then Bessy she sighed, and thus she did say,  
My father and mother I mean to obey;  
First get their good will, and be faithful to me,  
And then you shall marry your pretty Bessee.

To every one this answer she made,  
Wherefore unto her they joyfully said,  
This thing to fulfil we all do agree;  
But where dwells thy father, my pretty Bessee?

My father, she said, is soon to be seen:  
The silly blind beggar of Bednall-green,  
That daily sits begging for charitie,  
He is the good father of pretty Bessee.

His marks and his tokens are known very well;  
He always is led with a dog and a bell:  
A silly old man, God knoweth, is he,  
Yet he is the father of pretty Bessee.

Nay then, quoth the merchant, thou art not for me.  
Nor, quoth the innholder, my wife thou shalt be:  
I loth, said the gentle, a beggar's degree,  
And therefore adieu, my pretty Bessee.

Why then, quoth the knight, hap better or worse,  
I weigh not true love by the weight of the purse,  
And beauty is beauty in every degree;  
Then welcome unto me, my pretty Bessee.

With thee to thy father forthwith I will go.  
Nay soft, quoth his kinsmen, it must not be so;  
A poor beggar's daughter no lady shall be,  
Then take thy adieu of pretty Bessee.

But soon after this, by break of the day  
The knight had from Rumford stole Bessy away.  
The young men of Rumford, as thick as might be,  
Rode after to fetch again pretty Bessee.

As swift as the wind to ryde they were seen,  
Until they came near unto Bednall-green;  
And as the knight lighted most courteouslie,  
They all fought against him for pretty Bessee.

But rescue came speedily over the plain,  
Or else the young knight for his love had been slain.  
This fray being ended, then straightway he see  
His kinsmen come railing at pretty Bessee.

Then spake the blind beggar, Although I be poor,  
Yet rail not against my child at my own door:  
Though she be not decked in velvet and pearl,  
Yet will I drop angels with you for my girl.

And then, if my gold may better her birth,  
And equal the gold that you lay on the earth,  
Then neither rail nor grudge you to see  
The blind beggar's daughter a lady to be.

But first you shall promise, and have it well known,  
The gold that you drop shall all be your Own.

With that they replied, Contented be we.  
Then here's, quoth the beggar, for pretty Bessee.

With that an angel he cast on the ground,  
And dropped in angels full three thousand pound;  
And oftentimes it was proved most plain,  
For the gentlemen's one, the beggar dropt twain:

So that the place, wherein they did sit,  
With gold it was covered every whit.  
The gentlemen then having dropt all their store,  
Said, Now, beggar, hold, for we have no more,

Thou hast fulfilled thy promise aright.  
Then marry, quoth he, my girl to this knight;  
And here, added he, I will now throw you down  
A hundred pounds more to buy her a gown.

The gentlemen all, that this treasure had seen,  
Admired the beggar of Bednall-green:  
And all those, that were her suitors before,  
Their flesh for very anger they tore.

Thus was fair Bessy matched to the knight,  
And then made a lady in others' despite:  
A fairer lady there never was seen,  
Than the blind beggar's daughter of Bednall-green.

But of their sumptuous marriage and feast,  
What brave lords and knights thither were prest,  
The second fitt shall set forth to your sight  
With marvellous pleasure and wished delight.

## PART II

Of a blind beggar's daughter most bright,  
That late was betrothed unto a young knight;  
All the discourse thereof you did see:  
But now comes the wedding of pretty Bessee.

Within a gorgeous palace most brave,  
Adorned with all the cost they could have,  
This wedding was kept most sumptuouslie,  
And all for the credit of pretty Bessee.

All kind of dainties and delicates sweet  
Were bought for the banquet, as it was most meet;  
Partridge, and plover, and venison most free,  
Against the brave wedding of pretty Bessee.

This marriage through England was spread by report,  
So that a great number thereto did resort  
Of nobles and gentles in every degree;  
And all for the fame of pretty Bessee.

To church then went this gallant young knight;  
His bride followed after, an angel most bright,  
With troops of ladies, the like ne'er was seen,  
As went with sweet Bessy of Bednall-green.

This marriage being solemnized then,  
With musick performed by the skilfullest men,  
The nobles and gentles sat down at that tide,  
Each one admiring the beautiful bride.

Now, after the sumptuous dinner was done,  
To talk, and to reason a number begun:  
They talked of the blind beggar's daughter most bright,  
And what with his daughter he gave to the knight.

Then spake the nobles, 'Much marvel have we,  
This jolly blind beggar we cannot here see.'  
My lords, quoth the bride, my father's so base,  
He is loth with his presence these states to disgrace.

'The praise of a woman in question to bring  
Before her own face, were a flattering thing,  
But we think thy father's baseness,' quoth they,  
'Might by thy beauty be clean put away.'

They had no sooner these pleasant words spoke,  
But in comes the beggar clad in a silk cloak;  
A fair velvet cap, and a feather had he,  
And now a musician forsooth he would be.

He had a dainty lute under his arm,  
He touched the strings, which made such a charm,  
Says, Please you to hear any musick of me,  
I'll sing you a song of pretty Bessee.

With that his lute he twanged straightway,  
And thereon began most sweetly to play;  
And after that lessons were played two or three,  
He strain'd out this song most delicatelie.

'A poor beggar's daughter did dwell on a green,  
Who for her fairness might well be a queen:

A blithe bonny lass, and a dainty was she,  
And many one called her pretty Bessee.

'Her father he had no goods, nor no land,  
But begged for a penny all day with his hand;  
And yet to her marriage he gave thousands three,  
And still he hath somewhat for pretty Bessee.

'And if any one here her birth do disdain,  
Her father is ready, with might and with main,  
To prove she is come of noble degree:  
Therefore never flout at pretty Bessee.'

With that the lords and the company round  
With hearty laughter were ready to swoond;  
At last said the lords, Full well we may see,  
The bride and the beggar's beholden to thee.

On this the bride all blushing did rise,  
The pearly drops standing within her fair eyes,  
'O pardon my father, grave nobles, quoth she,  
That through blind affection thus doteth on me.'

'If this be thy father,' the nobles did say,  
'Well may he be proud of this happy day;  
Yet by his countenance well may we see,  
His birth and his fortune did never agree:

'And therefore, blind man, we pray thee bewray  
(And look that the truth thou to us do say)  
Thy birth and thy parentage, what it may be;  
For the love that thou bearest to pretty Bessee.'

'Then give me leave, nobles and gentles, each one,  
One song more to sing, and then I have done;  
And if that it may not win good report,  
Then do not give me a *groat* for my sport.

'Sir Simon de Montfort my subject shall be;  
Once chief of all the great barons was he,  
Yet fortune so cruel this lord did abase,  
Now lost and forgotten are he and his race.

'When the barons in arms did king Henry oppose,  
Sir Simon de Montfort their leader they chose;  
A leader of courage undaunted was he,  
And ofttimes he made their enemies flee.

'At length in the battle on Evesham plain,  
The barons were routed, and Montfort was slain;  
Most fatal that battle did prove unto thee,  
Though thou wast not born then, my pretty Bessee!

'Along with the nobles, that fell at that tide,  
His eldest son Henry, who fought by his side,  
Was felled by a blow he received in the fight;  
A blow that deprived him for ever of sight.

'Among the dead bodies all lifeless he lay,  
Till evening drew on of the following day,  
When by a young lady discovered was he;  
And this was thy mother, my pretty Bessee.

'A baron's fair daughter stept forth in the night  
To search for her father, who fell in the fight,

And seeing young Montfort, where gasping he lay,  
Was moved with pity, and brought him away.

'In secret she nurst him, and swaged his pain,  
While he through the realm was believed to be slain:  
At length his fair bride she consented to be,  
And made him glad father of pretty Bessee.

'And now, lest our foes our lives should betray,  
We clothed ourselves in beggars' array;  
Her jewels she sold, and hither came we:  
All our comfort and care was our pretty Bessee.

'And here have we lived in fortune's despite,  
Though poor, yet contented with humble delight:  
Full forty winters thus have I been  
A silly blind beggar of Bednall-green.

'And here, noble lords, is ended the song  
Of one, that once to your own rank did belong:  
And thus have you learned a secret from me,  
That ne'er had been known, but for pretty Bessee.'

Now when the fair company every one,  
Had heard the strange tale in the song he had shown,  
They all were amazed, as well they might be,  
Both at the blind beggar, and pretty Bessee.

With that the fair bride they all did embrace,  
Saying, Sure thou art come of an honourable race  
Thy father likewise is of noble degree,  
And thou art well worthy a lady to be.



Thus was the feast ended with joy and delight,  
A bridegroom most happy then was the knight,  
In joy and felicitie long lived he,  
All with his fair lady, the pretty Bessee.

## **THE BABES IN THE WOOD**

Now ponder well, you parents dear,  
These words, which I shall write;  
A doleful story you shall hear,  
In time brought forth to light.  
A gentleman of good account  
In Norfolk dwelt of late,  
Who did in honour far surmount  
Most men of his estate.

Sore sick he was, and like to die,  
No help his life could save;  
His wife by him as sick did lie,  
And both possest one grave.  
No love between these two was lost,  
Each was to other kind,  
In love they liv'd, in love they died,  
And left two babes behind:

The one a fine and pretty boy,  
Not passing three yeares old;  
The other a girl more young than he,  
And fram'd in beauty's mould.  
The father left his little son,  
As plainly doth appeare,

When he to perfect age should come,  
Three hundred pounds a yeare.

And to his little daughter Jane  
Five hundred pounds in gold,  
To be paid down on marriage-day,  
Which might not be controll'd:  
But if the children came to die,  
Ere they to age should come,  
Their uncle should possesse their wealth;  
For so the will did run.

Now, brother, said the dying man,  
Look to my children dear;  
Be good unto my boy and girl,  
No friends else have they here:  
To God and you I recommend  
My children dear this daye;  
But little while be sure we have  
Within this world to stay.

You must be father and mother both,  
And uncle all in one;  
God knows what will become of them,  
When I am dead and gone.  
With that bespake their mother dear,  
O brother kind, quoth she,  
You are the man must bring our babes  
To wealth or miserie:

And if you keep them carefully,  
Then God will you reward;

But if you otherwise should deal,  
God will your deeds regard.  
With lips as cold as any stone,  
They kist their children small:  
God bless you both, my children dear;  
With that the tears did fall.

These speeches then their brother spake  
To this sick couple there,  
The keeping of your little ones,  
Sweet sister, do not feare;  
God never prosper me nor mine,  
Nor aught else that I have,  
If I do wrong your children dear,  
Wheli you are laid in grave.

The parents being dead and gone,  
The children home he takes,  
And brings them straite unto his house,  
Where much of them he makes.  
He had not kept these pretty babes  
A twelvemonth and a day,  
But, for their wealth, he did devise  
To make them both away.

He bargain'd with two ruffians strong,  
Which were of furious mood,  
That they should take these children young,  
And slay them in a wood.  
He told his wife an artful tale,  
He would the children send

To be brought up in fair London,  
With one that was his friend.

Away then went those pretty babes,  
Rejoycing at that tide,  
Rejoycing with a merry mind,  
They should on cock-horse ride.  
They prate and prattle pleasantly,  
As they rode on the way,  
To those that should their butchers be,  
And work their lives' decay:

So that the pretty speech they had,  
Made Murder's heart relent;  
And they that undertook the deed,  
Full sore did now repent.  
Yet one of them, more hard of heart,  
Did vow to do his charge,  
Because the wretch, that hired him,  
Had paid him very large.

The other won't agree thereto,  
So here they fall to strife;  
With one another they did fight,  
About the children's life:  
And he that was of mildest mood,  
Did slay the other there,  
Within an unfrequented wood;  
The babes did quake for fear!

He took the children by the hand,  
Tears standing in their eye,

And bade them straightway follow him,  
And look they did not cry:  
And two long miles he led them on,  
While they for food complain:  
Stay here, quoth he, I'll bring you bread,  
When I come back again.

The pretty babes, with hand in hand,  
Went wandering up and down;  
But never more could see the man  
Approaching from the town;  
Their pretty lips with black-berries,  
Were all besmear'd and dyed,  
And when they saw the darksome night,  
They sat them down and cryed.

Thus wandered these poor innocents,  
Till death did end their grief,  
In one another's arms they died,  
As wanting due relief:  
No burial this pretty pair  
Of any man receives,  
Till Robin-redbreast piously  
Did cover them with leaves.

And now the heavy wrath of God  
Upon their uncle fell;  
Yea, fearful fiends did haunt his house,  
His conscience felt an hell:  
His barns were fir'd, his goods consum'd,  
His lands were barren made;

His cattle died within the field,  
And nothing with him stayd.

And in a voyage to Portugal  
Two of his sons did die;  
And to conclude, himself was brought  
To want and misery:  
He pawn'd and mortgaged all his land  
Ere seven years came about.  
And now at length this wicked act  
Did by this means come out:

The fellow, that did take in hand  
These children for to kill,  
Was for a robbery judg'd to die,  
Such was God's blessed will:  
Who did confess the very truth,  
As here hath been display'd:  
Their uncle having died in gaol,  
Where he for debt was laid.

You that executors be made, And overseers eke,  
Of children that be fatherless,  
And infants mild and meek;  
Take you example by this thing,  
And yield to each his right,  
Lest God with such like misery  
Your wicked minds requite.

## **ROBIN HOOD AND THE PINDER OF WAKEFIELD**

IN Wakefield there lives a jolly pinder,  
In Wakefield, all on a green;

'There is neither knight nor squire,' said the pinder,  
'Nor baron that is so bold,  
Dare make a trespass to the town of Wakefield,  
But his pledge goes to the pinfold.'

All this beheard three witty young men,  
'Twas Robin Hood, Scarlet, and John;  
With that they spied the jolly pinder,  
As he sate under a thorn.

'Now turn again, turn again,' said the pinder,  
'For a wrong way have you gone;  
For you have forsaken the king his highway,  
And made a path over the corn.'

'Oh, that were great shame,' said jolly Robin,  
'We being three, and thou but one':  
The pinder leapt back then thirty good foot,  
'Twas thirty good foot and one.

He leaned his back fast unto a thorn,  
And his foot unto a stone,  
And there he fought a long summer's day,  
A summer's day so long,  
Till that their swords, on their broad bucklers,  
Were broken fast unto their hands.

.....

'Hold thy hand, hold thy hand,' said Robin Hood,  
'And my merry men every one;  
For this is one of the best pinders  
That ever I try'd with sword.

'And wilt thou forsake thy pinder his craft,  
And live in the green wood with me?'

.....

'At Michaelmas next my covenant comes out,  
When every man gathers his fee;  
I'll take my blew blade all in my hand,  
And plod to the green wood with thee.'

'Hast thou either meat or drink,' said Robin Hood,  
'For my merry men and me?'

.....

'I have both bread and beef,' said the pinder,  
'And good ale of the best';  
'And that is meat good enough,'  
said Robin Hood, For such unbidden guest.

O wilt thou forsake the pinder his craft  
And go to the green wood with me?  
'Thou shalt have a livery twice in the year,  
The one green, the other brown shall be.'

'If Michaelmas day were once come and gone,  
And my master had paid me my fee,



Then would I set as little by him  
As my master doth set by me.'

### **THE NUT-BROWN MAID**

*He.* BE it right or wrong, these men among  
On women do complain;  
Affirming this, how that it is  
A labour spent in vain,  
To love them well; for never a deal  
They love a man again:  
For let a man do what he can,  
Their favour to attain,  
Yet, if a new do them pursue,  
Their first true lover then  
Laboureth for nought; for from their thought  
He is a banished man.

*She.* I say not nay, but that all day  
It is both written and said,  
That woman's faith is, as who saith,  
All utterly decayed;  
But, nevertheless, right good witness  
In this case might be laid,  
That they love true, and continue:  
Record the Nut-brown Maid:  
Which, when her love came, her to prove,  
To her to make his moan,  
Would not depart; for in her heart  
She loved but him alone.

*He.* Then between us let us discuss  
What was all the manner  
Between them two: we will also  
Tell all the pain, and fear,  
That she was in. Now I begin,  
So that ye me answer;  
Wherefore, all ye, that present be,  
I pray you give an ear.  
'I am the knight; I come by night,  
As secret as I can;  
Saying, alas! thus standeth the case,  
I am a banished man.'

*She.* And I your will for to fulfil  
In this will not refuse;  
Trusting to show, in words few,  
That men have an ill use  
(To their own shame) women to blame,  
And causeless them accuse;  
Therefore to you I answer now,  
All women to excuse,  
Mine own heart dear, with you what cheer  
I pray you, tell anon;  
For, in my mind, of all mankind  
I love but you alone.

*He.* It standeth so; a deed is done  
Whereof great harm shall grow:  
My destiny is for to die  
A shameful death, I trow;  
Or else to flee. The one must be;

None other way I know,  
But to withdraw as an outlaw,  
And take me to my bow.  
Wherefore adieu, my own heart true!  
None other rede I can:  
For I must to the green-wood go,  
Alone, a banished man.

*She.* O Lord, what is this worldis bliss,  
That changeth as the moon!  
My summer's day in lusty May  
Is derked before the noon.  
I hear you say, farewell: Nay, nay,  
We depart not so soon,  
Why say ye so? whither will ye go?  
Alas! what have you done?  
All my welfare to sorrow and care  
Should change, if you were gone;  
For in my mind, of all mankind  
I love but you alone.

*He.* I can believe, it shall you grieve,  
And somewhat you distraint;  
But, afterward, your paines hard  
Within a day or twain  
Shall soon aslake; and ye shall take  
Comfort to you again.  
Why should ye ought? for to make thought,  
Your labour were in vain.  
And thus I do; and pray you to,  
As hartely, as I can;

For I must to the green-wood go,  
Alone, a banished man.

*She.* Now, sith that ye have showed to me  
The secret of your mind,  
I shall be plain to you again,  
Like as ye shall me find.  
Sith it is so, that ye will go,  
I will not live behind;  
Shall never be said, the Nut-brown Maid  
Was to her love unkind:  
Make you ready, for so am I,  
Although it were anone;  
For, in my mind, of all mankind,  
I love but you alone.

*He.* Yet I you rede to take good heed  
What men will think, and say:  
Of young and old it shall be told,  
That ye be gone away,  
Your wanton will for to fulfil,  
In green-wood you to play;  
And that ye might for your delight  
No longer make delay.  
Rather than ye should thus for me  
Be called an ill woman,  
Yet would I to the green-wood go,  
Alone, a banished man.

*She.* Though it be sung of old and young,  
That I should be to blame,

Theirs be the charge, that speak so large  
In hurting of my name:  
For I will prove that faithful love  
It is devoid of shame;  
In your distress, and heaviness,  
To part with you, the same:  
And sure all those, that do not so,  
True lovers are they none;  
For, in my mind, of all mankind,  
I love but you alone.

*He.* I counsel you, Remember how,  
It is no maiden's law,  
Nothing to doubt, but to run out  
To wood with an outlaw:  
For ye must there in your hand bear  
A bow, ready to draw,  
And, as a thief, thus must you live,  
Ever in dread and awe;  
Whereby to you great harm might grow:  
Yet had I liever than,  
That I did to the green-wood go,  
Alone, a banished man.

*She.* I think not nay, but as ye say,  
It is no maiden's lore:  
But love may make me for your sake,  
As I have said before,  
To come on foot, to hunt, and shoot  
To get us meat in store;  
For so that I your company

May have, I ask no more:  
From which to part, it maketh my heart  
As cold as any stone;  
For, in my mind, of all mankind  
I love but you alone.

*He.* For an outlaw this is the law,  
That men him take and bind;  
Without pitie, hanged to be,  
And waver with the wind.  
If I had need (as God forbid!)  
What socours could ye find?  
Forsooth, I trow, ye and your bow  
For fear would draw behind:  
And no marvel; for little avail  
Were in your counsel then:  
Wherefore I will to the green-wood go,  
Alone, a banished man.

*She.* Right well know ye that woman be  
But feeble for to fight;  
No womanhede it is indeed  
To be bold as a knight:  
Yet, in such fear if that ye were  
With enemies day or night,  
I would withstand, with bow in hand,  
To grieve them as I might,  
And you to save; as women have  
From death men many one;  
For, in my mind, of all mankind  
I love but you alone.

*He.* Yet take good heed; for ever I dread  
That ye could not sustain  
The thorny ways, the deep valleys,  
The snow, the frost, the rain,  
The cold, the heat: for dry, or wet,  
We must lodge on the plain;  
And, us above, no other roof  
But a brake bush, or twain:  
Which soon should grieve you, I believe,  
And ye would gladly than  
That I had to the green-wood go,  
Alone, a banished man.

*She.* Sith I have here been partynere  
With you of joy and bliss,  
I must also part of your woe  
Endure, as reason is:  
Yet am I sure of one pleasure;  
And shortly, it is this:  
That, where ye be, me seemeth, parde,  
I could not fare amiss.  
Without more speech, I you beseech  
That we were soon agone;  
For, in my mind, of all mankind I love but you alone.

*He.* If you go thyder, ye must consider,  
When ye have lust to dine,  
There shall no meat be for you gete,  
Neither beer, ale, nor wine;  
No slakes clean, to lie between,  
Made of thread and twine;

None other house but leaves and boughs,  
To cover your head and mine,  
Lo, mine heart sweet, this evil diete  
Should make you pale and wan;  
Wherefore I will to the green-wood go,  
Alone, a banished man.

*She.* Among the wild deer, such an archere  
As men say that ye be,  
Ne may not fail of good vitayle,  
Where is so great plente:  
And water clear of the rivere  
Shall be full sweet to me;  
With which in hele I shall right wele  
Endure, as ye shall see;  
And, or we go, a bed or two  
I can provide anone;  
For, in my mind, of all mankind I love but you alone.

*He.* Lo yet, before, ye must do more,  
If ye will go with me:  
As cut your hair up by your ear,  
Your kirtle by the knee;  
With bow in hand, for to withstand  
Your enemies, if need be:  
And this same night before daylight.  
To woodward will I flee.  
If that ye will all this fulfil,  
Do it shortly as ye can:  
Else will I to the green-wood go,  
Alone, a banished man.



*She.* I shall as now do more for you  
Than 'longeth to womanhede;  
To shote my hair, a bow to bear,  
To shoot in time of need.  
O my sweet mother, before all other  
For you I have most dread!  
But now, adieu! I must ensue,  
Where fortune doth me lead.  
All this make ye: Now let us flee;  
The day cometh fast upon;  
For, in my mind, of all mankind  
I love but you alone.

*He.* Nay, nay, not so; ye shall not go,  
And I shall tell you why,  
Your appetite is to be light  
Of love, I well espy:  
For, like as ye have said to me,  
In likewise hardily  
Ye would answere whosoever it were,  
In way of company.  
It is said of old, Soon hot, soon cold;  
And so is a woman.  
Wherefore I to the wood will go,  
Alone, a banished man.

*She.* If ye take heed, it is no need  
Such words to say by me;  
For oft ye prayed, and long assayed,  
Or I loved you, parde  
And though that I of ancestry

A baron's daughter be,  
Yet have you proved how I you loved,  
A squire of low degree;  
And ever shall, whatso befall;  
To die therefore anone;  
For, in my mind, of all mankind  
I love but you alone.

*He.* A baron's child to be beguil'd!  
It were a cursed deed;  
To be felawe with an outlaw!  
Almighty God forbid!  
Yet better were the poor squyere  
Alone to forest yede,  
Than ye shall say another day,  
That, by my cursed rede,  
Ye were betrayed: Wherefore, good maid,  
The best rede that I can,  
Is, that I to the green-wood go,  
Alone, a banished man.

*She.* Whatever befall, I never shall  
Of this thing be upbraid:  
But if ye go, and leave me so,  
Then have ye me betrayed.  
Remember you well, how that ye deal;  
For, if ye, as ye said,  
Be so unkind, to leave behind,  
Your love, the Nut-brown Maid,  
Trust me truly, that I shall die  
Soon after ye be gone;

For, in my mind, of all mankind  
I love but you alone.

*He.* If that ye went, ye should repent;  
For in the forest now  
I have purvayed me of a maid,  
Whom I love more than you;  
Another more fair than ever ye were,  
I dare it well avow;  
And of you both each should be wroth  
With other, as I trow:  
It were mine ease to live in peace;  
So will I, if I can;  
Wherefore I to the wood will go,  
Alone, a banished man.

*She.* Though in the wood I understood  
Ye had a paramour,  
All this may nought remove my thought,  
But that I will be yours:  
And she shall find me soft and kind,  
And courteous every hour;  
Glad to fulfil all that she will  
Command me to my power:  
For had ye, lo, an hundred mo,  
Yet would I be that one,  
For, in my mind, of all mankind  
I love but you alone.

*He.* Mine own dear love, I see the prove  
That ye be kind and true;

Of maid, and wife, in all my life,  
The best that ever I knew.  
Be merry and glad, be no more sad,  
The case is changed new;  
For it were ruth, that, for your truth,  
Ye should have cause to rue.  
Be not dismayed; whatsoever I said  
To you when I began;  
I will not to the green-wood go; I am no banished man.

*She.* These tidings be more glad to me,  
Than to be made a queen,  
If I were sure they should endure;  
But it is often seen,  
When men will break promise, they speak  
The wordis on the spleen.  
Ye shape some wile me to beguile,  
And steal from me, I ween:  
Then were the case worse than it was,  
And I more wobegone;  
For, in my mind, of all mankind  
I love but you alone.

*He.* Ye shall not need further to dread;  
I will not disparage  
You (God defend), sith ye descend  
Of so great lineage.  
Now understand; to Westmoreland,  
Which is my heritage,  
I will you bring; and with a ring,  
By way of marriage

I will you take, and lady make,  
As shortly as I can.  
Thus have you won an Erle's son,  
And not a banished man.

*Here may ye see, that woman be  
In love, meek, kind, and stable:  
Let never man reprove them than,  
Or call them variable;  
But rather pray God that we may  
To them be comfortable;  
Which sometimes proveth such, as He loveth,  
If they be charitable.  
For sith men would that women should  
Be meek to them each one;  
Much more ought they to God obey,  
And serve but Him alone.*

## **SIR HUGH OF LINCOLN**

FOUR and twenty bonny boys  
Were playing at the ba';  
Then up and started sweet Sir Hugh,  
The flower amang them a'.

He hit the ba' a kick wi's fit,  
And kept it wi' his knee,  
That up into the Jew's window  
He gart the bonny ba' flee.

'Cast doun the ba' to me, fair maid,  
Cast doun the ba' to me '  
'O ne'er a bit o' the ba' ye get  
Till ye cum up to me.

'Cum up, sweet Hugh, cum up, dear Hugh,  
Cum up and get the ba";  
'I canna cum, I darna cum,  
Without my playferes twa.'

'Cum up, sweet Hugh, cum up, dear Hugh,  
Cum up and play wi' me';  
I canna cum, I darna cum,  
Without my playferes three.'

She's gane into the Jew's garden,  
Where the grass grew lang and green;  
She pow'd an apple red and white,  
To wyle the young thing in.

She wyl'd him into ae chamber,  
She wyl'd him into twa;  
She wyl'd him to her ain chamber,  
The fairest o' them a'.

She laid him on a dressing-board  
Where she did sometimes dine;  
She put a penknife in his heart  
And dressed him like a swine.

Then out and cam the thick, thick blude,  
Then out and cam the thin;

Then out and cam the bonny heart's blude,  
Where a' the life lay in.

She row'd him in a cake of lead,  
Bad him lie still and sleep;  
She cast him into the Jew's draw-well,  
Was fifty fathom deep.

She's tane her mantle about her head,  
Her pike-staff in her hand;  
And prayed Heaven to be her guide  
Unto some uncouth land.

His mither she cam to the Jew's castle,  
And there ran thryse about:  
'O sweet Sir Hugh, gif ye be here,  
I pray ye to me speak.'

She cam into the Jew's garden,  
And there ran thryse about:  
'O sweet Sir Hugh, gif ye be here,  
I pray ye to me speak.'

She cam unto the Jew's draw-well,  
And there ran thryse about:  
'O sweet Sir Hugh, gif ye be here,  
I pray ye to me speak.'

'How can I speak, how dare I speak,  
How can I speak to thee?  
The Jew's penknife sticks in my heart,  
I canna speak to thee.

'Gang hame, gang hame, O mither dear,  
And shape my winding-sheet,  
And at the birks of Mirryland town  
There you and I shall meet.'

When bells were rung and Mass was sung,  
And a' men bound for bed,  
Every mither had her son,  
But sweet Sir Hugh was dead.

### **THE GYPSY COUNTESS**

THERE come seven gypsies on a day,  
Oh, but they sang bonny, O!  
And they sang so sweet, and they sang so clear,  
Down cam the earl's ladie, O.

They gave to her the nutmeg,  
And they gave to her the ginger;  
But she gave to them a far better thing,  
The seven gold rings off her fingers.

When the earl he did come home,  
Enquiring for his ladie,  
One of the servants made this reply,  
'She's awa with the gypsie laddie.'

'Come saddle for me the brown,' he said,  
'For the black was ne'er so speedy,  
And I will travel night and day  
Till I find out my ladie.'



'Will you come home, my dear?' he said,  
Oh will you come home, my honey?  
And by the point of my broad sword,  
A hand I'll ne'er lay on you.'

'Last night I lay on a good feather-bed,  
And my own wedded lord beside me,  
And to-night I'll lie in the ash-corner,  
With the gypsies all around me.

'They took off my high-heeled shoes,  
That were made of Spanish leather,  
And I have put on coarse Lowland brogues,  
To trip it o'er the heather.'

'The Earl of Cashan is lying sick;  
Not one hair I'm sorry;  
I'd rather have a kiss from his fair lady's lips  
Than all his gold and his money.'

### **THERE WERE THREE LADIES**

THERE were three ladies play'd at the ba',  
With a hey, hey, an' a lilly gay.

Bye cam three lords an' woo'd them a',  
Whan the roses smelled sae sweetly.

The first o' them was clad in yellow:  
'O fair May, will ye be my marrow?'  
Whan the roses smelled sae sweetly.

The niest o' them was clad i' ried:  
O fair May, will ye be my bride?'

The thrid o' them was clad i' green:  
He said, 'O fair May, will ye be my queen?'

## **THE HEIR OF LINNE**

### **PART I**

LITHE and listen, gentlemen,  
To sing a song I will begin:  
It is of a lord of faire Scotland,  
Which was the unthrifty heir of Linne.

His father was a right good lord,  
His mother a lady of high degree;  
But they, alas! were dead, him froe,  
And he lov'd keeping companie.

To spend the day with merry cheer,  
To drinke and revell every night,  
To card and dice from eve to morne,  
It was, I weep, his heart's delight.

To ride, to run, to rant, to roar,  
To alwaye spend and never spare,  
I wot, an' it were the king himself,  
Of gold and fee he mote be bare.

So fares the unthrifty lord of Linne  
Till all his gold is gone and spent;

And he maun sell his lands so broad,  
His house, and lands, and all his rent.

His father had a keen stewarde,  
And John o' the Scales was called he:  
But John is become a gentel-man,  
And John has got both gold and fee.

Says, Welcome, welcome, lord of Linne,  
Let nought disturb thy merry cheer;  
If thou wilt sell thy lands soe broad,  
Good store of gold I 'll give thee here.

My gold is gone, my money is spent;  
My land now take it unto thee:  
Give me the gold, good John o' the Scales,  
And thine for aye my land shall be.

Then John he did him to record draw,  
And John he cast him a gods-pennie;  
But for every pound that John agreed,  
The land, I wis, was well worth three.

He told him the gold upon the bord,  
He was right glad his land to win:  
The gold is thine, the land is mine,  
And now I'll be the lord of Linne.

Thus he bath sold his land so broad,  
Both hill and holt, and moore and fenne,  
All but a poor and lonesome lodge,  
That stood far off in a lonely glen.

For so he to his father hight.  
My son, when I am gone, said he,  
Then thou wilt spend thy land so broad,  
And thou wilt spend thy gold so free:

But swear me now upon the roode,  
That lonesome lodge thou'lt never spend;  
For when all the world doth frown on thee,  
Thou there shalt find a faithful friend.

The heir of Linne is full of gold:  
And come with me, my friends, said he,  
Let 's drinke, and rant, and merry make,  
And he that spares, ne'er mote he thee.

They ranted, drank, and merry made,  
Till all his gold it waxed thin;  
And then his friends they slunk away;  
They left the unthrifty heir of Linne.

He had never a penny left in his purse,  
Never a penny left but three,  
And one was brass, another was lead,  
And another it was white money.

'Now well-aday,' said the heir of Linne,  
'Now well-aday, and woe is me,  
For when I was the lord of Linne,  
I never wanted gold nor fee.

'But many a trusty friend have I,  
And why should I feel dole or care?

I'll borrow of them all by turns,  
So need I not be never bare.'

But one, I wis, was not at home;  
Anther had payd his gold away;  
Another call'd him thriftless loon,  
And bade him sharply wend his way.

Now well-aday, said the heir of Linne,  
Now well-aday, and woe is me!  
For when I had my lands so broad,  
On me they liv'd right merrilee.

To beg my bread from door to door  
I wis, it were a burning shame:  
To rob and steal it were a sin:  
To work my limbs I cannot frame.

Now I'll away to that lonesome lodge,  
For there my father bade me wend;  
When all the world should frown on me,  
I there shold find a trusty friend.

## **PART II**

Away then hied the heir of Linne  
O'er hill and holt and moor and fen,  
Untill he came to the lonesome lodge,  
That stud so lowe in a lonely glenne.

He looked up, he looked down,  
In hope some comfort for to win:

But bare and lothly were the walls.  
Here's sorry cheer, quo' the heir of Linne.

The little window dim and dark  
Was hung with ivy, brere, and yew;  
No shimmering sun here ever shone;  
No wholesome breeze here ever blew.

Nor chair, nor table he mote spy,  
No cheerful hearth, no welcome bed,  
Nought save a rope with a running noose,  
That dangling hung up o'er his head.

And over it in broad letters,  
These words were written so plain to see:  
'Ah! graceless wretch, hast spent thine all,  
And brought thyself to penurie?

'And this my boding mind misgave  
I therefore left this trusty friend  
Let it now shield thy foule disgrace,  
And all thy shame and sorrows end.'

Sorely shent wi' this rebuke,  
Sorely shent was the heir of Lime;  
His heart, I wis, was near to burst  
With guilt and sorrow, shame and sin.

Never a word spake the heir of Lime,  
Never a word he spake but three:  
'This is a trusty friend indeed,  
And is right welcome unto me'

Then round his neck the cord he drew,  
And sprang aloft with his bodie:  
When lo! the ceiling burst in twaine,  
And to the ground came tumbing he.

Astonished lay the heir of Linne  
Nor knewe if he were live or dead:  
At length he looked, and saw a bill,  
And in it a key of gold so redd.

He took the bill, and lookt it on,  
Strait good comfort found he there:  
It told him of a hole in the wall,  
In which there stood three chests in-fere.

Two were full of the beaten gold,  
The third was full of white money;  
And over them in broad letters  
These words were written so plain to see:

'Once more, my son, I set thee clear;  
Amend thy life and follies past;  
For but thou amend thee of thy life,  
That rope must be thy end at last.'

And let it be,' said the heir of Linne;  
'And let it be, but if I amend:  
For here I will make mine avow,  
This read shall guide me to the end.'

Away then went with a merry cheer,  
Away then went the heir of Linne;

I wis, he neither ceas'd nor stayed,  
Till John o' the Scales' house he did win.

And when he came to John o' the Scales,  
Up at the window then looked he:  
There sate three lords upon a row,  
Were drinking of the wine so free.

And John himself sate at the bord-head,  
Because now lord of Linne was he.  
'I pray thee,' he said, 'good John o' the Scales,  
One forty pence for to lend me.'

'Away, away, thou thriftless loone;  
Away, away, this may not be:  
For a curse upon my head he said,  
If ever I trust thee one pennie.'

Then bespake the heir of Linne,  
To John o' the Scales' wife then spake he:  
'Madame, some alms on me bestow,  
I pray for sweet saint Charitie.'

'Away, away, thou thriftless loone,  
I swear thou gettest no alms of me;  
For if we shold hang any losel here,  
The first we would begin with thee.'

Then bespake a good fellowe,  
Which sat at John o' the Scales his bord;  
Sayd, 'Turn again, thou heir of Linne;  
Some time thou wast a well good Lord:



'Some time a good fellow thou hast been,  
And sparedst not thy gold and fee:  
Therefore I'll lend thee forty pence,  
And other forty if need be.

'And ever, I pray thee, John o' the Scales,  
To let him sit in thy companie:  
For well I wot thou hadst his land,  
And a good bargain it was to thee.'

Up then spake him John o' the Scales,  
All hot he answered him againe:  
'Now a curse upon my head, he said,  
But I did lose by that bargaine.

'And here I proffer thee, heir of Linne,  
Before these lords so fair and free,  
Thou shalt have it back again better cheap,  
By a hundred markes, than I had it of thee.

'I draw you to record, lords, he said.  
With that he cast him a god's pennie:  
Now by my fay, sayd the heir of Linne,  
And here, good John, is thy money.'

And he pull'd forth three bags of gold,  
And layd them down upon the board:  
All woebegone was John o' the Scales,  
Soe sheet he could say never a word.

He told him forth the good red gold,  
He told it forth with mickle dinne,

The gold is thine, the land is mine,  
And now I'm again the lord of Linne.

Sayes, 'Have thou here, thou good fellowe,  
Forty pence thou didst lend me:  
Now I am again the lord of Linne,  
And forty pounds I will give thee.

'I'll make thee keeper of my forest,  
Both of the wild deere and the tame;  
For unless I reward thy bounteous heart,  
I wis, good fellowe, I were to blame.'

'Now well-aday!' sayth John o' the Scales:  
'Now well-aday! and woe is my life!'  
'Yesterday I was lady of Linne,  
Now I'm but John o' the Scales his wife.'

'Now fare thee well, said the heir of Linne;  
Farewell now, John o' the Scales, said he.  
A curse light on me, if ever again  
I bring my lands in jeopardy.'

## **THE OLD AND YOUNG COURTIER**

AN old song made by an aged old pate,  
Of an old worshipful gentleman, who had a greats estate,  
That kept a brave old house at a bountiful rate,  
And an old porter to relieve the poor at his gate;  
Like an old courtier of the queen's  
And the queen's old courtier.

With an old lady, whose anger one word assuages;  
They every quarter paid their old servants their wages,  
And never knew what belong'd to coachman, footmen, nor pages,  
But kept twenty old fellows with blue coats and badges;  
Like an old courtier...

With an old study fill'd full of learned old books,  
With an old reverend chaplain, you might know him by his looks.  
With an old buttery hatch worn quite off the hooks,  
And an old kitchen, that maintain'd half a dozen old cooks:  
Like an old courtier...

With an old hall, hung about with pikes, guns and bows,  
With old swords, and bucklers, that had borne many shrewde blows,  
And an old frize coat to cover his worship's trunk hose,  
And a cup of old sherry, to comfort his copper nose;  
Like an old courtier...

With a good old fashion, when Christmasse was come,  
To call in all his old neighbours with bagpipe and drum,  
With good chear enough to furnish every old room,  
And old liquor able to make a cat speak, and man dumb,  
Like an old courtier...

With an old falconer, huntsman, and a kennel of hounds,  
That never hawked, nor hunted, but in his own grounds,  
Who, like a wise man, kept himself within his own bounds,  
And when he dyed gave every child a thousand good pounds;  
Like an old courtier...

But to his eldest son his house and land he assign'd,  
Charging him in his will to keep the old bountifull mind,

To be good to his old tenants, and to his neighbours be kind:  
But in the ensuing ditty you shall hear how he was inclin'd;  
Like a young courtier of the king's  
And the king's young courtier.

Like a flourishing young gallant, newly come to his land,  
Who keeps a brace of painted madams at his command,  
And takes up a thousand pound upon his father's land,  
And gets drunk in a tavern, till he can neither go nor stand;  
Like a young courtier...

With a new-fangled lady, that is dainty, nice, and spare,  
Who never knew what belong'd to good housekeeping, or care,  
Who buyes gaudy-color'd fans to play with wanton air,  
And seven or eight different dressings of other women's hair;  
Like a young courtier...

With a new-fashion'd hall, built where the old one stood,  
Hung round with new pictures, that do the poor no good,  
With a fine marble chimney, wherein burns neither coal nor wood,  
And a new smooth shovelboard, whereon no victuals ne'er stood;  
Like a young courtier...

With a new study, stuf't full of pamphlets, and plays,  
And a new chaplain, that swears faster than he prays,  
With a new buttery hatch, that opens once in four or five days,  
And a new French cook, to devise fine kickshaws, and toys;  
Like a young courtier...

With a new fashion, when Christmas is drawing on,  
On a new journey to London straight we all must begone,  
And leave none to keep house, but our new porter John,

Who relieves the poor with a thump on the back with a stone;  
Like a young courtier...

With a new gentleman-usher, whose carriage is compleat,  
With a new coachman, footmen, and pages to carry up the meat,  
With a waiting-gentlewoman, whose dressing is very neat,  
Who when her lady has din'd, lets the servants not eat;  
Like a young courtier...

With new titles of honour bought with his father's old gold,  
For which sundry of his ancestors' old manors are sold;  
And this is the course most of our new gallants hold,  
Which makes that good house-keeping is now grown so cold,  
Among the young courtiers of the king,  
Among the king's young courtiers.

## **THE WINNING OF CALES**

LONG the proud Spaniards had vaunted to conquer us,  
Threatning our country with fyer and sword;  
Often preparing their navy most sumptuous  
With as great plenty as Spain could afford.  
Dub a dub, dub a dub, thus strike their drums;  
Tantara, tantara, the Englishman comes.

To the seas presentlye went our lord admiral,  
With knights couragious and captains full good;  
The brave Earl of Essex, a prosperous general,  
With him prepared to pass the salt flood.

At Plymouth speedilye, took they ship valiantlye,  
Braver ships never were seen under sayle,  
With their fair colours spread, and streamers o'er their head.  
Now bragging Spaniards, take heed of your tayle.

Unto Cales cunninglye, came we most speedilye,  
Where the kinges navy securelye did ryde;  
Being upon their backs, piercing their butts of sacks,  
Ere any Spaniards our coming descryde.

Great was the crying, the running and ryding,  
Which at that season was made in that place;  
The beacons were fyred, as need then required;  
To hyde their great treasure they had little space.

There you might see their ships, how they were fyred fast,  
And how their men drowned themselves in the sea;  
There you might hear them cry, wayle and weep piteously,  
When they saw no shift to 'scape thence away.

The great St. Philip, the pryde of the Spaniards,  
Was burnt to the bottom, and sunk in the sea;  
But the St. Andrew, and eke the St. Matthew,  
Wee took in fight manfullye and brought away.

The Earl of Essex, most valiant and hardye,  
With horsemen and footmen march'd up to the town;  
The Spanyards, which saw them, were greatly alarmed,  
Did fly for their savegard, and durst not come down.

Now, quoth the noble Earl, courage my soldiers all,  
Fight and be valiant, the spoil you shall have;

And be well rewarded all from the great to the small;  
But look that the women and children you save.

The Spaniards at that sight, thinking it vain to fight,  
Hung up flags of truce and yielded the towne;  
Wee marched in presentlye, decking the walls on hye,  
With English colours which purchas'd renowne.

Entering the houses then, of the most richest men,  
For gold and treasure we searched eche day;  
In some places we did find, pyes baking left behind,  
Meate at fire roasting, and folkes run away.

Full of rich merchandize, every shop catch'd our eyes,  
Damasks and sattens and velvets full fayre:  
Which soldiers measur'd out by the length of their swords;  
Of all commodities eche had a share.

Thus Cales was taken, and our brave general  
March'd to the market-place, where he did stand:  
There many prisoners fell to our several shares,  
Many crav'd mercye, and mercye they fannd.

When our brave general saw they delayed all,  
And would not ransom their towne as they said,  
With their fair wanscots, their presses and bedsteds,  
Their joint-stools and tables a fire we made;  
And when the town burned all in a flame,  
With tara, tantara, away we all came.

## **THE BAILIFF'S DAUGHTER OF ISLINGTON**

THERE was a youth, a well-beloved youth,  
And he was a squire's son;  
He loved the bayliffe's daughter dear,  
That lived in Islington.

Yet she was coy and would not believe  
That he did love her so,  
No nor at any time would she  
Any countenance to him show.

But when his friends did understand  
His fond and foolish mind,  
They sent him up to faire London  
An apprentice for to bind.

And when he had been seven long years,  
And never his love could see:  
Many a tear have I shed for her sake,  
When she little thought of me.

Then all the maids of Islington  
Went forth to sport and play,  
All but the bayliffe's daughter dear;  
She secretly stole away.

She pulled off her gown of green,  
And put on ragged attire,  
And to faire London she would go  
Her true love to enquire.

And as she went along the high road,  
The weather being hot and dry,



She sat her down upon a green bank,  
And her true love came riding bye.

She started up, with a colour so redd,  
Catching hold of his bridle-reine;  
One penny, one penny, kind sir, she said,  
Will ease me of much pain.

Before I give you one penny, sweet-heart,  
Pray tell me where you were born.  
At Islington, kind sir, said she,  
Where I have had many a scorn.

I prythe, sweet-heart, then tell to me,  
O tell me, whether you know,  
The bayliffe's daughter of Islington.  
She is dead, sir, long ago.

If she be dead, then take my horse,  
My saddle and bridle also;  
For I will unto some far country,  
Where no man shall me know.

O stay, O stay, thou goodly youth,  
She standeth by thy side;  
She is here alive, she is not dead,  
And ready to be thy bride.

O farewell grief, and welcome joy,  
Ten thousand times therefore;  
For now I have found mine own true love.  
Whom I thought I should never see more.

# CHEVY CHASE

## PART I

GOD prosper long our noble King,  
Our lives and safeties all!  
A woeful Hunting once there did  
In Chevy Chase befall.

To drive the deer, with hound and horn,  
Earl Percy took the way;  
The child may rue, that is unborn,  
The hunting of that day!

The stout Earl of Northumberland  
A vow to God did make,  
His pleasure in the Scottish woods,  
Three summer days to take;

The chiefest harts in Chevy Chase,  
To kill and bear away.  
These tidings to Earl Douglas came  
In Scotland, where he lay.

Who sent Earl Percy present word,  
He would prevent his sport.  
The English Earl, not fearing that,  
Did to the woods resort

With fifteen hundred bowmen bold,  
All chosen men of might,  
Who knew full well, in time of need,  
To aim their shafts aright.

The gallant greyhounds swiftly ran,  
To chase the fallow deer.  
On Monday, they began to hunt,  
Ere daylight did appear;

And long before high noon they had  
A hundred fat bucks slain:  
Then, having dined, the drovers went  
To rouse the deer again.

The hounds ran swiftly through the woods,  
The nimble deer to take,  
That with their cries the hills and dales  
An echo shrill did make.

Lord Percy, to the quarry went,  
To view the slaughtered deer,  
Quoth he, 'Earl Douglas promised  
This day to meet me here:

'But if I thought he would not come,  
No longer would I stay!'  
With that, a brave young gentleman,  
Thus to the Earl did say:

'Lo! yonder doth Earl Douglas come!  
His men in armour bright!  
Full twenty hundred Scottish spears  
All marching in our sight!

'All pleasant men of Tividale,  
Fast by the river Tweed.'

'O, cease your sports!' Earl Percy said,  
And take your bows with speed;

'And now with me, my countrymen,  
Your courage forth advance;  
For there was never champion yet,  
In Scotland, nor in France,

'That ever did on horseback come;  
And, if my hap it were,  
I durst encounter man for man,  
With him to break a spear!'

Earl Douglas, on his milk-white steed,  
Most like a baron bold,  
Rode foremost of his company,  
Whose armour shone like gold.

'Show me,' said he, whose men you be,  
That hunt so boldly here?  
That, without my consent, do chase  
And kill my fallow deer?'

The first man that did answer make,  
Was noble Percy he,  
Who said, 'We list not to declare,  
Nor show, whose men we be:

'Yet we will spend our dearest blood  
Thy chiefest harts to slay.'  
Then Douglas swore a solemn oath,  
And thus in rage did say:

'Ere thus I will outbraved be,  
One of us two shall die:  
I know thee well! An earl thou art,  
Lord Percy. So am I.

'But, trust me, Percy, pity it were,  
And great offence, to kill  
Any of these, our guiltless men!  
For they have done no ill.

'Let thou and I, the battle try;  
And set our men aside.'  
'Accursed be he,' Earl Percy said,  
'By whom it is denied!'

Then stepped a gallant squire forth,  
Witherington was his name,  
Who said, 'I would not have it told  
To Henry our king, for shame,

'That e'er my Captain fought on foot,  
And I stood looking on.  
You be two earls,' quoth Witherington,  
'And I a squire alone.

'I'll do the best that do I may,  
While I have power to stand:  
While I have power to wield my sword,  
I'll fight with heart and hand.'

Our English archers bent their bows,  
Their hearts were good and true.

At the first flight of arrows sent,  
Full fourscore Scots they slew.

'To drive the deer with hound and horn!'  
Douglas bade on the bent.  
Two captains moved, with mickle might,  
Their spears to shivers went.

They closed full fast on every side;  
No slackness there was found:  
But many a gallant gentleman  
Lay gasping on the ground.

O, Christ! it was a grief to see,  
And likewise for to hear,  
The cries of men lying in their gore,  
And scattered here and there.

At last, these two stout earls did meet.  
Like captains of great might,  
Like lions wood, they laid on load,  
And made a cruel fight:

They fought, until they both did sweat,  
With swords of tempered steel,  
Till blood adown their cheeks, like rain,  
They trickling down did feel.

'Yield thee, O Percy,' Douglas said,  
'In faith! I will thee bring,  
Where thou shalt high advanced be,  
By James, our Scottish King!

'Thy ransom I will freely give!  
And this report of thee,  
"Thou art the most courageous knight  
That ever I did see!"

'No, Douglas,' quoth Earl Percy then,  
Thy proffer I do scorn;  
I will not yield to any Scot  
That ever yet was born!'

With that, there came an arrow keen  
Out of an English bow,  
Which struck Earl Douglas to the heart,  
A deep and deadly blow.

Who never said more words than these,  
'Fight on, my merry men all!  
For why? My life is at an end,  
Lord Percy sees my fall!'

Then leaving life, Earl Percy took  
The dead man by the hand,  
Who said, 'Earl Douglas, for thy sake,  
Would I had lost my land!

'O, Christ! my very heart doth bleed  
For sorrow, for thy sake,  
For, sure, a more redoubted knight  
Mischance could never take!'

A knight, amongst the Scots there was,  
Which saw Earl Douglas die;

Who straight in heart did vow revenge  
Upon the Lord Percy.

## **PART II**

Sir Hugh Montgomery was he called;  
Who, with a spear most bright,  
Well mounted on a gallant steed,  
Ran fiercely through the fight.

And passed the English archers all,  
Without or dread or fear;  
And through Earl Percy's body then  
He thrust his hateful spear.

With such a vehement force and might,  
He did his body gore:  
The staff ran through the other side,  
A large cloth-yard and more.

Thus did both those nobles die,  
Whose courage none could stain.  
An English archer then perceived  
The noble earl was slain.

He had a good bow in his hand,  
Made of a trusty tree.  
An arrow of a cloth-yard long,  
Up to the head drew he.

Against Sir Hugh Montgomery,  
So right the shaft he set;



The grey-goose wing that was thereon,  
In his heart's blood was wet.

This fight did last from break of day  
Till setting of the sun:  
For when they rang the evening bell,  
The battle scarce was done.

With stout Earl Percy there were slain  
Sir John of Egerton,  
Sir Robert Ratcliff, and Sir John,  
Sir James, that bold Baron.

And with Sir George and stout Sir James,  
Both Knights of good account,  
Good Sir Ralph Raby there was slain,  
Whose prowess did surmount.

For Witherington needs must I wail,  
As one in doleful dumps,  
For when his legs were smitten off,  
He fought upon his stumps.

And with Earl Douglas there were slain  
Sir Hugh Montgomery;  
And Sir Charles Murray, that from field  
One foot would never flee.

Sir Charles Murray of Ratcliff, too,  
His sister's son was he:  
Sir David Lamb, so well esteemed,  
But saved he could not be.

And the Lord Maxwell, in like case,  
Did with Earl Douglas die.  
Of twenty hundred Scottish spears  
Scarce fifty-five did fly.

Of fifteen hundred Englishmen,  
Went home but fifty-three;  
The rest in Chevy Chase were slain,  
Under the greenwood tree.

Next day did many widows come  
Their husbands to bewail:  
They washed their wounds in brinish tears;  
But all would not prevail!

Their bodies, bathed in purple blood,  
They bore with them away.  
They kissed them, dead, a thousand times,  
Ere they were clad in clay.

The news was brought to Edinborough,  
Where Scotland's King did reign,  
That brave Earl Douglas suddenly  
Was with an arrow slain.

'O, heavy news!' King James did say,  
Scotland may witness be,  
I have not any captain more  
Of such account as he!

Like tidings to King Henry came,  
Within as short a space,

That Percy of Northumberland,  
Was slain in Chevy Chase.

'Now, God be with him!' said our king,  
Sith it will no better be;  
I trust I have, within my realm,  
Five hundred as good as he!

'Yet shall not Scots, nor Scotland, say  
But I will vengeance take;  
And be revenged on them all,  
For brave Earl Percy's sake.'

This vow the king did well perform  
After, on Humbledown,  
In one day fifty knights were slain,  
With lords of great renown;

And of the rest, of small account,  
Did many thousands die.  
Thus endeth the hunting in Chevy Chase,  
Made by the Earl Percy.

God save our king; and bless this land  
With plenty, joy, and peace!  
And grant henceforth, that foul debate  
'Twixt noblemen may cease!

*MICHAEL DRAYTON*

## THE BATTLE OF AGINCOURT

FAIR stood the wind for France  
When we our sails advance,  
Nor now to prove our chance  
Longer will tarry;  
But putting to the main,  
At Kaux, the mouth of Seine,  
With all his martial train,  
Landed King Harry.

And taking many a fort,  
Furnish'd in warlike sort  
March'd towards Agincourt  
In happy hour;  
Skirmishing day by day  
With those that stopp'd his way,  
Where the French gen'ral lay  
With all his power.

Which in his height of pride,  
King Henry to deride,  
His ransom to provide  
To the King sending;  
Which he neglects the while,  
As from a nation vile  
Yet with an angry smile,  
Their fall portending.

And turning to his men,  
Quoth our brave Henry then,

Though they to one be ten,  
Be not amazed.  
Yet, have we well begun,  
Battles so bravely won  
Have ever to the sun  
By fame been raised.

And for myself, quoth he,  
This my full rest shall be,  
England ne'er mourn for me,  
Nor more esteem me.  
Victor I will remain,  
Or on this earth lie slain,  
Never shall she sustain  
Loss to redeem me.

Poictiers and Cressy tell,  
When most their pride did swell,  
Under our swords they fell,  
No less our skill is,  
Than when our grandsire great,  
Claiming the regal seat,  
By many a warlike feat,  
Lop'd the French lilies.

The Duke of York so dread,  
The eager vanward led;  
With the main Henry sped,  
Amongst his henchmen.  
Excester had the rear,  
A braver man not there,

O Lord, how hot they were  
On the false Frenchmen!

They now to fight are gone,  
Armour on armour shone,  
Drum now to drum did groan,  
To hear, was wonder;  
That with cries they make,  
The very earth did shake,  
Trumpet to trumpet spake,  
Thunder to thunder.

Well it thine age became,  
O noble Erpingham,  
Which did the signal aim  
To our hid forces:  
When from a meadow by,  
Like a storm suddenly,  
The English archery  
Stuck the French horses.

With Spanish yew so strong,  
Arrows a cloth-yard long,  
That like to serpents stung  
Piercing the weather;  
None from his fellow starts,  
But playing manly parts,  
And like true English hearts,  
Stuck close together.

When down their bows they threw,  
And forth their bilbows drew,

And on the French they flew,  
Not one was tardy;  
Arms were from shoulders sent,  
Scalps to the teeth were rent,  
Down the French peasants went,  
Our men were hardy.

This while our noble king,  
His broad sword brandishing,  
Down the French host did ding,  
As to o'erwhelm it;  
And many a deep wound lent,  
His arms with blood besprent,  
And many a cruel dent  
Bruised his helmet.

Glo'ster, that duke so good,  
Next of the royal blood,  
For famous England stood,  
With his brave brother;  
Clarence, in steel so bright,  
Though but a maiden knight,  
Yet in that furious fight  
Scarce such another.

Warwick in blood did wade,  
Oxford the foe invade,  
And cruel slaughter made,  
Still as they ran up;  
Suffolk his axe did ply,  
Beaumont and Willoughby

Bare them right doughtily,  
Ferrers and Fanhope.

Upon Saint Crispin's day  
Fought was this noble fray,  
Which fame did not delay  
To England to carry;  
O when shall Englishmen  
With such acts fill a pen,  
Or England breed again  
Such a King Harry?

## *ANONYMOUS*

### **SONG OF THE ENGLISH BOWMEN**

AGINCOURT, Agincourt!  
Know ye not Agincourt,  
Where English slew and hurt  
All their French foemen?  
With their pikes and bills brown,  
How the French were beat down,  
Shot by our Bowmen?

Agincourt, Agincourt!  
Know ye not Agincourt,  
Never to be forgot,  
Or known to no men?  
Where English cloth-yard arrows



Killed the French like tame sparrows,  
Slain by our Bowmen?

Agincourt, Agincourt!  
Know ye not Agincourt?  
English of every sort,  
High men and low men,  
Fought that day wondrous well,  
All our old stories tell,  
Thanks to our Bowmen!

Agincourt, Agincourt!  
Know ye not Agincourt?  
Where our fifth Harry taught  
Frenchmen to know men:  
And, when the day was done,  
Thousands there fell to one  
Good English Bowman!

Agincourt, Agincourt!  
Know ye not Agincourt?  
Dear was the vict'ry bought  
By fifty yeomen.  
Ask any English wench,  
They were worth all the French,  
Rare English Bowmen!

*WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE*

**WINTER**

WHEN icicles hang by the wall,  
And Dick the shepherd blows his nail,  
And Tom bears logs into the hall,  
And milk comes frozen home in pail;  
When blood is nipt, and ways be foul,  
Then nightly sings the staring owl  
Tu-whit!  
Tu-who! A merry note!  
While greasy Joan doth keel the pot.

When all about the wind doth blow,  
And coughing drowns the parson's saw,  
And birds sit brooding in the snow,  
And Marian's nose looks red and raw;  
When roasted crabs hiss in the bowl,  
Then nightly sings the staring owl  
Tu-whit!  
Tu-who! A merry note!  
While greasy Joan doth keel the pot.

## **INGRATITUDE**

Brow, blow, thou winter wind,  
Thou art not so unkind  
As man's ingratitude;  
Thy tooth is not so keen,  
Because thou art not seen,  
Although thy breath be rude.  
Heigh, ho! sing heigh ho! unto the green holly:  
Most friendship is feigning, most loving mere folly:

Then heigh, ho, the holly!  
This life is most jolly.

Freeze, freeze, thou bitter sky,  
That dost not bite so nigh  
As benefits forgot:  
Though thou the waters warp,  
Thy sting is not so sharp  
As friend remember'd not.  
Heigh, ho! sing heigh ho! unto the green holly:  
Most friendship is feigning, most loving mere folly:  
Then heigh, ho, the holly!  
This life is most jolly.

## **FIDELE**

FEAR no more the heat o' the sun  
Nor the furious winter's rages;  
Thou thy worldly task hast done,  
Home art gone and ta'en thy wages;  
Golden lads and girls all must,  
As chimney-sweepers, come to dust.

Fear no more the frown o' the great,  
Thou art past the tyrant's stroke;  
Care no more to clothe and eat;  
To thee the reed is as the oak:  
The sceptre, learning, physic, must  
All follow this, and come to dust.

Fear no more the lightning-flash  
Nor the all-dreaded thunder-stone;  
Fear not slander, censure rash;  
Thou hast finish'd joy and moan:  
All lovers young, all lovers must  
Consign to thee, and come to dust.

### **UNDER THE GREENWOOD TREE**

UNDER the greenwood tree  
Who loves to lie with me,  
And tune his merry note  
Unto the sweet bird's throat,  
Come hither, come hither, come hither;  
Here shall he see  
No enemy,  
But winter and rough weather.

Who doth ambition shun,  
And loves to lie i' the sun,  
Seeking the food he eats,  
And pleas'd with what he gets,  
Come hither, come hither, come hither;  
Here shall he see  
No enemy,  
But winter and rough weather.

### **SYLVIA**

WHO is Sylvia? what is she,  
That all our swains commend her?  
Holy, fair, and wise is she;  
The heaven such grace did lend her,  
That she might admired be.

Is she kind as she is fair?  
For beauty lives with kindness,  
Love doth to her eyes repair,  
To help him of his blindness,  
And, being help'd, inhabits there.

Then to Sylvia let us sing,  
That Sylvia is excelling;  
She excels each mortal thing  
Upon the dull earth dwelling:  
To her let us garlands bring.

## **SONG**

COME away, come away, death,  
And in sad cypress let me be laid;  
Fly away, fly away, breath;  
I am slain by a fair cruel maid.  
My shroud of white, stuck all with yew,  
O, prepare it;  
My part of death no one so true  
Did share it.

Not a flower, not a flower sweet,  
On my black coffin let there be strown;

Not a friend, not a friend greet  
My poor corpse, where my bones shall be thrown.  
A thousand thousand sighs to save,  
Lay me, O, where  
Sad true lover ne'er find my grave  
To weep there.

### **A SEA DIRGE**

FULL fathom five thy father lies:  
Of his bones are coral made;  
Those are pearls that were his eyes:  
Nothing of him that doth fade,  
But doth suffer a sea-change  
Into something rich and strange.  
Sea-nymphs hourly ring his knell:  
Hark! now I hear them,—  
Ding, dong, bell.

### **OPHELIA'S SONG**

How should I your true love know  
From another one?  
By his cockle hat and staff,  
And his sandal shoon.

He is dead and gone, lady,  
He is dead and gone;  
At his head a grass-green turf,  
At his heels a stone.

White his shroud as the mountain snow,  
Larded with sweet flowers;  
Which bewept to the grave did go  
With true-love showers.

And will he not come again?  
And will he not come again?  
No, no, he is dead:  
Go to thy death-bed:  
He never will come again.

His beard was as white as snow,  
All flaxen was his poll:  
He is gone, he is gone,  
And we cast away moan:  
God ha' mercy on his soul!

### **WHEN DAISIES PIED**

WHEN daisies pied and violets blue,  
And lady-smocks all silver-white,  
And cuckoo-buds of yellow hue  
Do paint the meadows with delight,  
The cuckoo then, on every tree,  
Mocks married men; for thus sings he,  
Cuckoo;  
Cuckoo, cuckoo: O word of fear,  
Unpleasing to a married ear!

When shepherds pipe on oaten straws,  
And merry larks are ploughmen's clocks,

When turtles tread, and rooks, and daws,  
And maidens bleach their summer smocks,  
The cuckoo then, on every tree,  
Mocks married men; for thus sings he,  
Cuckob;  
Cuckoo, cuckoo: O word of fear,  
Unpleasing to a married ear!

### **IT WAS A LOVER**

IT was a lover and his lass,  
With a hey, and a ho, and a hey nonino,  
That o'er the green cornfield did pass  
In the spring time, the only pretty ring time,  
When birds do sing, hey ding a ding, ding:  
Sweet lovers love the spring.

Between the acres of the rye,  
With a hey, and a ho, and a hey nonino,  
These pretty country folks would lie,  
In spring time, etc.

This carol they began that hour,  
With a hey, and a ho, and a hey nonino,  
How that a life was but a flower  
In spring time, etc.

And therefore take the present time,  
With a hey, and a ho, and a hey nonino;  
For love is crowned with the prime  
In spring time, etc.



## **SWEET AND TWENTY**

O MISTRESS mine, where are you roaming?  
O, stay and hear; your true love 's coming,  
That can sing both high and low:  
Trip no further, pretty sweetening;  
Journeys end in lovers meeting,  
Every wise man's son doth know.

What is love? 'tis not hereafter;  
Present mirth hath present laughter;  
What's to come is still unsure:  
In delay there lies no plenty;  
Then come kiss me, sweet and twenty,  
Youth's a stuff will not endure.

## **MUSIC**

ORPHEUS with his lute made trees,  
And the mountain tops that freeze,  
Bow themselves when he did sing:  
To his music plants and flowers  
Ever sprung; as sun and showers  
There had made a lasting spring.

Every thing that heard him play,  
Even the billows of the sea,  
Hung their heads, and then lay by.  
In sweet music is such art,  
Killing-care and grief-of-heart  
Fall asleep, or hearing, die.

## **THE PEDLAR**

LAWN as white as driven snow;  
Cypress black as e'er was crow;  
Gloves as sweet as damask roses;  
Masks for faces and for noses;  
Bugle bracelet, necklace amber,  
Perfume for a lady's chamber;  
Golden quoifs and stomachers,  
For my lads to give their dears:  
Pins and poking-sticks of steel,  
What maids lack from head to heel:  
Come buy of me, come; come buy, come buy;  
Buy, lads, or else your lasses cry:  
Come buy.

## **SOLDIER'S SONG**

AND let me the canakin clink, clink;  
And let me the canakin clink:  
A soldier's a man;  
A life's but a span;  
Why, then, let a soldier drink.

King Stephen was a worthy peer,  
His breeches cost him but a crown;  
He held them sixpence all too dear,  
With that he call'd the tailor lown.

He was a wight of high renown,  
And thou art but of low degree:

'Tis pride that pulls the country down;  
Then take thine auld cloak about thee.

### **DOUBT NOT**

DOUBT thou the stars are fire;  
Doubt that the sun doth move;  
Doubt truth to be a liar;  
But never doubt I love.

### **ARIEL**

WHERE the bee sucks, there lurk I;  
In a cowslip's bell I lie;  
There I couch when owls do cry.  
On the bat's back I do fly  
After summer merrily.  
Merrily, merrily shall I live now  
Under the blossom that hangs on the bough.

### **SIGH NO MORE, LADIES**

SIGH no more, ladies, sigh no more;  
Men were deceivers ever;  
One foot in sea, and one on shore;  
To one thing constant never;  
Then sigh not so,  
But let them go,  
And be you blithe and bonny;

Converting all your sounds of woe  
Into, Hey nonny, nonny.

Sing no more ditties, sing no mo  
Of dumps so dull and heavy;  
The fraud of men was ever so,  
Since summer first was leavy,  
Then sigh not so,  
But let them go,  
And be you blithe and bonny;  
Converting all your sounds of woe,  
Into, Hey nonny, nonny.

### **THE SWEET O' THE YEAR**

WHEN daffodils begin to peer,  
With heigh! the doxy over the dale,  
Why, then comes in the sweet o' the year;  
For the red blood reigns in the winter's pale.

The white sheet bleaching on the hedge,  
With heigh! the sweet birds, O, how they sing!  
Doth set my pugging tooth on edge;  
For a quart of ale is a dish for a king.

The lark, that tirra-lyra chants,  
With heigh! with heigh! the thrush and the jay,  
Are summer songs for me and my aunts,  
While we lie tumbling in the hay.

But shall I go mourn for that, my dear?  
The pale moon shines by night:  
And when I wander here and there,  
I then do most go right.

If tinkers may have leave to live,  
And bear the sow-skin budget,  
Then my account I well may give,  
And in the stocks avouch it.

### **HARK! HARK! THE LARK!**

HARK! hark! the lark at heaven's gate sings,  
And Phoebus 'gins arise,  
His steeds to water at those springs,  
On chalic'd flowers that lies;

And winking Mary-buds begin  
To ope their golden eyes;  
With every thing that pretty bin;  
My lady sweet, arise.

### **OVER HILL, OVER DALE**

OVER hill, over dale,  
Thorough bush, thorough brier,  
Over park, over pale,  
Thorough flood, thorough fire,  
I do wander everywhere,  
Swifter than the moon's sphere;  
And I serve the fairy queen,

To dew her orbs upon the green.  
The cowslips tall her pensioners be:  
In their gold coats spots you see;  
Those be rubies, fairy favours,  
In those freckles live their savours;  
I must go seek some dewdrops here,  
And hang a pearl in every cowslip's ear.

### **ONE IN TEN**

WAS this fair face the cause, quoth she,  
Why the Grecians sacked Troy?  
Fond done, done fond,  
Was this King Priam's joy?  
With that she sighed as she stood,  
With that she sighed as she stood,  
And gave this sentence then;  
Among nine bad if one be good,  
Among nine bad if one be good,  
There's yet one good in ten.

### **PUCK**

Now the hungry lion roars,  
And the wolf behowls the moon;  
Whilst the heavy ploughman snores,  
All with weary task fordone.  
Now the wasted brands do glow,  
While the screech-owl, screeching loud,  
Puts the wretch, that lies in woe,

In remembrance of a shroud.  
Now it is the time of night  
That the graves, all gaping wide,  
Every one lets forth his sprite,  
In the church-way paths to glide;  
And we fairies, that do run  
By the triple Hecate's team,  
From the presence of the sun,  
Following darkness like a dream,  
Now are frolic; not a mouse  
Shall disturb this hallow'd house:  
I am sent with broom before,  
To sweep the dust behind the door.  
Through the house give glimmering light,  
By the dead and drowsy fire:  
Every elf and fairy sprite  
Hop as light as bird from brier;  
And this ditty, after me,  
Sing, and dance it trippingly.  
First, rehearse your song by rote,  
To each word a warbling note:  
Hand in hand, with fairy grace,  
Will we sing, and bless this place.

## **LULLABY**

You spotted snakes with double tongue,  
Thorny hedgehogs, be not seen;  
Newts and blind-worms, do no wrong,  
Come not near our fairy queen.

Philomel, with melody  
Sing in our sweet lullaby;  
Lulla, lulla, lullaby; lulla, lulla, lullaby.  
Never harm,  
Nor spell nor charm,  
Come our lovely lady nigh;  
So, good-night, with lullaby.

Weaving Spiders, come not here;  
Hence, you long-legg'd spinners, hence!  
Beetles black, approach not near;  
Worm nor snail, do no offence.

Philomel, with melody  
Sing in our sweet lullaby;  
Lulla, lulla, lullaby; lulla, lulla, lullaby.  
Never harm,  
Nor spell nor charm,  
Come our lovely lady nigh;  
So, good-night, with lullaby.

## **SONG**

TELL me where is fancy bred,  
Or in the heart or in the head  
How begot, how nourished?  
Reply, reply.  
It is engender'd in the eyes,  
With gazing fed: and fancy dies  
In the cradle where it lies.  
Let us all ring fancy's knell:



I'll begin it,—Ding, dong, bell.  
Ding, dong, bell.

*THOMAS CAMPION*

**CHERRY-RIPE**

THERE is a garden in her face,  
Where roses and white lilies grow;  
A heavenly paradise is that place,  
Wherein all pleasant fruits do grow;  
There cherries grow that none may buy  
Till 'Cherry-ripe' themselves do cry.

Those cherries fairly do enclose  
Of orient pearl a double row,  
Which, when her lovely laughter shows,  
They look like rosebuds fill'd with snow;  
Yet them no peer nor prince may buy  
Till 'Cherry-ripe' themselves do cry.

Her eyes like angels watch them still,  
Her brows like bended bows do stand,  
Threat'ning with piercing frowns to kill  
All that approach with eye or hand  
These sacred cherries to come nigh,  
Till Cherry-ripe' themselves do cry.

**LAURA**

ROSE-CHEEKED Laura, come;  
Sing thou smoothly with thy beauty's  
Silent music, either other  
Sweetly gracing.  
Lovely forms do flow  
From consent divinely framed;  
Heaven is music, and thy beauty's  
Birth is heavenly.

These dull notes we sing  
Discords need for helps to grace them,  
Only beauty purely loving  
Knows no discord,  
But still moves delight,  
Like clear springs renewed by flowing,  
Ever perfect, ever in them-  
Selves eternal.

### **COME, CHEERFUL DAY**

COME, cheerful day, part of my life to me;  
For while thou view'st me with thy fading light  
Part of my life doth still depart with thee,  
And I still onward haste to my last night:  
Time's fatal wings do ever forward fly  
So every day we live, a day we die.

But O ye nights, ordain'd for barren rest,  
How are my days deprived of life in you  
When heavy sleep my soul hath dispossessed,  
By feigned death life sweetly to renew;

Part of my life, in that, you life deny:  
So every day we live, a day we die.

### **FOLLOW THY FAIR SUN**

FOLLOW thy fair sun, unhappy shadow!  
Though thou be black as night  
And she made all of light,  
Yet follow thy fair sun, unhappy shadow!

Follow her, whose light thy light depriveth!  
Though here thou liv'st disgraced,  
And she in heaven is placed,  
Yet follow her whose light the world reviveth!

Follow those pure beams, whose beauty burneth,  
That so have scorched thee  
As thou still black must be  
Till her kind beams thy black to brightness turneth.

Follow her, while yet her glory shineth!  
There comes a luckless night  
That will dim all her light;  
—And this the black unhappy shade divineth.

Follow still, since so thy fates ordained!  
The sun must have his shade,  
Till both at once do fade,  
The sun still proved, the shadow still disdained.

*BEN JONSON*

**TO CELIA**

DRINK to me only with thine eyes,  
And I will pledge with mine,  
Or leave a kiss but in the cup  
And I'll not look for wine.  
The thirst that from the soul doth rise  
Doth ask a drink divine;  
But might I of Jove's nectar sup,  
I would not change for thine.

I sent thee late a rosy wreath,  
Not so much honouring thee  
As giving it a hope that there  
It could not wither'd be;  
But thou thereon didst only breathe  
And sent'st it back to me;  
Since when it grows, and smells, I swear,  
Not of itself, but thee!

**SONG FROM 'CYNTHIA'S REVELS'**

QUEEN and huntress, chaste and fair,  
Now the sun is laid to sleep,  
Seated in thy silver chair,  
State in wonted manner keep.  
Hesperus entreats thy light,  
Goddess excellently bright!

Earth, let not thy envious shade  
Dare itself to interpose;  
Cynthia's shining orb was made  
Heaven to clear, when day did close.  
Bless us then with wished sight,  
Goddess excellently bright!

Lay thy bow of pearl apart,  
And thy crystal-shining quiver,  
Give unto the flying hart  
Space to breathe how short soever;  
Thou that mak'st a day of night,  
Goddess excellently bright!

### **THE SWEET NEGLECT**

STILL to be neat, still to be drest,  
As you were going to a feast:  
Still to be poud'red, still perfum'd:  
Lady, it is to be presum'd,  
Though art's hid causes are not found,  
All is not sweet, all is not sound.

Give me a looke, give me a face,  
That makes simplicitie a grace;  
Robes loosely flowing, haire as free:  
Such sweet neglect more taketh me,  
Than all th' adulteries of art,  
That strike mine eyes, but not my heart.

*ANONYMOUS*

**THE WEAVER'S SONG**

WREN Hercules did use to spin,  
And Pallas wrought upon the loom,  
Our trade to flourish did begin,  
While conscience went not selling broom;  
Then love and friendship did agree  
To keep the bands of amity.

When princes' sons kept sheep in field,  
And queens made cakes of wheated flour,  
The men to lucre did not yield,  
Which brought good cheer in every bower;  
Then love and friendship...

But when the Gyants huge and high,  
Did fight with spears like weavers' beams,  
Then they in iron beds did lye,  
And brought poor men to hard extreams;  
Yet love and friendship...

Then David took his sling and stone,  
Not fearing great Goliah's strength,  
He pierc't his brains, and broke the bone,  
Though he were fifty foot of length;  
For love and friendship...

But while the Greeks besieged Troy,  
Penelope apace did spin;

And weavers wrought with mickle joy,  
Though little gains were coming in;  
For love and friendship...

Had Helen then sate carding wooll,  
(Whose beauteous face did breed such strife),  
She had not been Sir Paris' trull,  
Nor caused so many to lose their life;  
Yet we by love did still agree  
To hold the bands of amity.

Or had King Priam's wanton son  
Been making quills with sweet content,  
He had not then his friends undone,  
When he to Greece a-gadding went;  
For love and friendship...

The cedar-trees endure more storms  
Then little shrubs that sprout on high;  
The weavers live more void of harms  
Then princes of great dignity;  
While love and friendship doth agree...

The shepherd sitting in the field  
Doth tune his pipe with heart's delight;  
When princes watch with spear and shield,  
The poor man soundly sleeps all night;  
While love and friendship doth agree...

Yet this by proof is daily try'd,  
For God's good gifts we are ingrate,  
And no man through the world so wide

Lives well contented with his state;  
No love and friendship we can see  
To hold the bands of amity.

## **THE HONEST FELLOW**

HANG fear, cast away care,  
The parish is bound to find us  
Thou and I, and all must die,  
And leave this world behind us.

The bells shall ring, the clerk shall sing,  
And the good old wife shall winds us;  
And the sexton shall lay our bodies in the clay,  
Where nobody shall find us.

## **ROBIN GOODFELLOW**

FROM Oberon, in fairy land,  
The king of ghosts and shadows there,  
Mad Robin I, at his command,  
Am sent to view the night-sports here.  
What revel rout  
Is kept about,  
In every corner where I go,  
I will o'ersee,  
And merry be,  
And make good sport, with ho, ho, ho!

More swift than lightning can I fly  
About this airy welkin soon,



And, in a minute's space, descry  
Each thing that's done below the moon.  
There's not a hag  
Or host shall wag,  
Or cry, ware goblins! where I go;  
But Robin I  
Their feats will spy,  
And send them home with ho, ho, ho!

Whene'er such wanderers I meet,  
As from their night-sports they trudge home,  
With counterfeiting voice I greet,  
And call them on with me to roam:  
Through woods, through lakes;  
Through bogs, through brakes;  
Or else, unseen, with them I go,  
All in the nick,  
To play some trick,  
And frolic it, with ho, ho, ho!

Sometimes I meet them like a man,  
Sometimes an ox, sometimes a hound;  
And to a horse I turn me can,  
To trip and trot about them round.  
But if to ride  
My back they stride,  
More swift than wind away I go,  
O'er hedge and lands,  
Through pools and ponds,  
I hurry, laughing, ho, ho, ho!

When lads and lasses merry be,  
With possets and with junkets fine;  
Unseen of all the company,  
I eat their cakes and sip their wine!  
And, to make sport,  
I puff and snort:  
And out the candles I do blow:  
The maids I kiss,  
They shriek—Who's this?  
I answer nought but ho, ho, ho!

Yet now and then, the maids to please,  
At midnight I card up their wool;  
And, while they sleep and take their ease,  
With wheel to threads their flax I pull.  
I grind at mill  
Their malt up still;  
I dress their hemp; I spin their tow;  
If any wake,  
And would me take,  
I wend me, laughing, ho, ho, ho!

When any need to borrow aught,  
We lend them what they do require:  
And, for the use demand we nought;  
Our own is all we do desire.  
If to repay  
They do delay,  
Abroad amongst them then I go,  
And night by night,

I them affright,  
With pinchings, dreams, and ho, ho, ho!

When lazy queans have nought to do,  
But study how to cog and lie:  
To make debate and mischief too,  
'Twixt one another secretly:  
I mark their gloze,  
And it disclose  
To them whom they have wronged so:  
When I have done,  
I get me gone,  
And leave them scolding, ho, ho, ho!

When men do traps and engines set  
In loop-holes, where the vermin creep,  
Who from their folds and houses get  
Their ducks and geese, and lambs and sheep;  
I spy the gin,  
And enter in,  
And seem a vermin taken so;  
But when they there  
Approach me near,  
I leap out laughing, ho, ho, ho!

By wells and rills, in meadows green,  
We nightly dance our heyday guise;  
And to our fairy king and queen,  
We chant our moonlight minstrelsies.  
When larks 'gin sing,  
Away we fling;

And babes new born steal as we go;  
And elf in bed  
We leave in stead,  
And wend us laughing, ho, ho, ho!

From hag-bred Merlin's time, have I  
Thus nightly revelled to and fro;  
And for my pranks men call me by  
The name of Robin Good-fellow.  
Fiends, ghosts, and sprites,  
Who haunt the nights,  
The hags and goblins do me know  
And beldames old  
My feats have told,  
So vale, vale; ho, ho, ho!

### **TIME'S ALTERATION**

WHEN this old cap was new,  
'Tis since two hundred year  
No malice then we knew,  
But all things plenty were:  
All friendship now decays  
(Believe me, this is true);  
Which was not in those days,  
When this old cap was new.

The nobles of our land  
Were much delighted then,  
To have at their command  
A crew of lusty men,

Which by their coats were known,  
Of tawny, red, or blue,  
With crests on their sleeves shewn,  
When this old cap was new.

Now pride hath banished all,  
Unto our land's reproach,  
When he whose means is small,  
Maintains both horse and coach:  
Instead of a hundred men,  
The coach allows but two;  
This was not thought on then,  
When this old cap was new.

Good hospitality  
Was cherished then of many  
Now poor men starve and die,  
And are not helped by any:  
For charity waxeth cold,  
And love is found in few;  
This was not in time of old,  
When this old cap was new.

Where'er you travelled then,  
You might meet on the way  
Brave knights and gentlemen,  
Clad in their country gray;  
That courteous would appear,  
And kindly welcome you;  
No puritans then were,  
When this old cap was new.

Our ladies in those days  
In civil habit went;  
Broad cloth was then worth praise,  
And gave the best content:  
French fashions then were scorned;  
Fond fangles then none knew;  
Then modesty women adorned,  
When this old cap was new.

A man might then behold,  
At Christmas, in each hall,  
Good fires to curb the cold,  
And meat for great and small:  
The neighbours were friendly bidden,  
And all had welcome true;  
The poor from the gates were not chidden  
When this old cap was new.

Black jacks to every man  
Were filled with wine and beer;  
No pewter pot nor can  
In those days did appear:  
Good cheer in a nobleman's house  
Was counted a seemly show;  
We wanted no brawn nor souse,  
When this old cap was new.

We took not such delight  
In cups of silver fine;  
None under the degree of a knight  
In plate drank beer or wine:

Now each mechanical man  
Hath a cupboard of plate for a show;  
Which was a rare thing then,  
When this old cap was new.

Then bribery was unborn,  
No simony men did use;  
Christians did usury scorn,  
Devised among the Jews.  
The lawyers to be fee'd  
At that time hardly knew;  
For man with man agreed,  
When this old cap was new.

No captain then caroused,  
Nor spent poor soldiers' pay;  
They were not so abused  
As they are at this day:  
Of seven days they make eight,  
To keep from them their due;  
Poor soldiers had their right,  
When this old cap was new.

Which made them forward still  
To go, although not prest;  
And going with good-will,  
Their fortunes were the best.  
Our English then in fight  
Did foreign foes subdue,  
And forced them all to flight,  
When this old cap was new.

God save our gracious king,  
And send him long to live:  
Lord, mischief on them bring  
That will not their alms give,  
But seek to rob the poor  
Of that which is their due:  
This was not in time of yore,  
When this old cap was new.

*GEORGE WITHER*

**SHALL I, WASTING IN DESPAIR**

SHALL I, wasting in despair,  
Die because a woman's fair?  
Or make pale my cheeks with care  
'Cause another's rosy are?  
Be she fairer than the day,  
Or the flow'ry meads in May,  
If she be not so to me,  
What care I how fair she be?

Should my heart be griev'd or pin'd  
'Cause I see a woman kind?  
Or a well-disposed nature  
Joined with a lovely feature?  
Be she meeker, kinder than  
Turtle-dove or pelican,



If she be not so to me,  
What care I how kind she be?

Shall a woman's virtues move  
Me to perish for her love?  
Or her well-deservings, known,  
Make me quite forget my own?  
Be she with that goodness blest  
Which may gain her name of best,  
If she be not such to me,  
What care I how good she be?

'Cause her fortune seems too high,  
Shall I play the fool and die?  
Those that bear a noble mind,  
Where they want of riches find  
Think what with them they would do  
That without them dare to woo;  
And unless that mind I see,  
What care I how great she be?

Great, or good, or kind, or fair,  
I will ne'er the more despair;  
If she love me, this believe,  
I will die ere she shall grieve:  
If she slight me when I woo,  
I can scorn and let her go;  
For if she be not for me,  
What care I for whom she be?

**I LOVED A LASS, A FAIR ONE**

I LOV'D a lass, a fair one,  
As fair as e'er was seen;  
She was indeed a rare one,  
Another Sheba Queen.  
But, fool as then I was,  
I thought she lov'd me too:  
But now, alas! she's left me,  
Falero, lero, loo.

Her hair like gold did glister,  
Each eye was like a star,  
She did surpass her sister,  
Which pass'd all others far;  
She would me honey call,  
She'd, oh—she'd kiss me too:  
But now, alas! she's left me,  
Falero, lero, loo.

Many a merry meeting  
My love and I have had;  
She was my only sweetening,  
She made my heart full glad;  
The tears stood in her eyes,  
Like to the morning dew:  
But now, alas! she's left me,  
Falero, lero, loo.

Her cheeks were like the cherry,  
Her skin as white as snow;  
When she was blythe and merry,  
She angel-like did show;

Her waist exceeding small,  
The fives did fit her shoe:  
But now, alas! she's left me,  
Falero, lero, loo.

In summer time or winter  
She had her heart's desire;  
I still did scorn to stint her  
From sugar, sack, or fire;  
The world went round about,  
No cares we ever knew:  
But now, alas! she's left me,  
Falero, lero, loo.

To maidens' vows and swearing  
Henceforth no credit give;  
You may give them the hearing,  
But never them believe;  
They are as false as fair,  
Unconstant, frail, untrue:  
For mine, alas! hath left me,  
Falero, lero, loo.

## **CHRISTMAS**

So now is come our joyfulest part;  
Let every man be jolly;  
Each room with ivy-leaves is dressed,  
And every post with holly.  
Though some churls at our mirth repine,  
Round your foreheads garlands twine,

Drown sorrow in a cup of wine,  
And let us all be merry!

Now all our neighbours' chimneys smoke,  
And Christmas-blocks are burning;  
Their ovens they with baked meat choke,  
And all their spits are turning.  
Without the door let sorrow lie;  
And, if for cold it hap to die,  
We'll bury it in a Christmas pie  
And evermore be merry!

Rank misers now do sparing shun;  
Their hall of music soundeth;  
And dogs thence with whole shoulders run;  
So all things there aboundeth.  
The country folks themselves advance  
With crowdy-muttons out of France;  
And Jack shall pipe, and Jill shall dance,  
And all the town be merry!

Good farmers in the country nurse  
The poor that else were undone;  
Some landlords spend their money worse,  
On lust and pride in London.  
There the roysters they do play,  
Drab and dice their lands away,  
Which may be ours another day,  
And therefore let's be merry!

The client now his suit forbears;  
The prisoner's heart is eased;

The debtor drinks away his cares,  
And for the time is pleased.  
Though other's purses be more fat,  
Why should we pine or grieve at that?  
Hang sorrow! care will kill a cat,  
And therefore let's be merry!

Hark! now the wags abroad do call  
Each other forth to rambling;  
Anon you'll see them in the hall,  
For nuts and apples scrambling.  
Hark! how the roofs with laughter sound;  
Anon they'll think the house goes round,  
For they the cellar's depth have found,  
And there they will be merry!

The wenches with their wassail bowls  
About the streets are singing;  
The boys are come to catch the owls;  
The wild mare in is bringing;  
Our kitchen-boy hath broke his box;  
And to the dealing of the ox  
Our honest neighbours come by flocks,  
And here they will be merry!

Now kings and queens poor sheep-cots have,  
And mate with everybody;  
The honest now may play the knave,  
And wise men play the noddy.  
Some youths will now a-mumming go,  
Some others play at Rowland-bo,

And twenty other game, boys, mo,  
Because they will be merry!

Then wherefore, in these merry days,  
Should we, I pray, be duller?  
No, let us sing some roundelays  
To make our mirth the fuller:  
And, while we thus inspired sing,  
Let all the streets with echoes ring;  
Woods, and hills, and everything,  
Bear witness we are merry!

*THOMAS CAREW*

### **ASK ME NO MORE**

ASK me no more where Jove bestows,  
When June is past, the fading rose;  
For in your beauties orient deep  
These flowers, as in their causes, sleep.

Ask me no more, whither do stray  
The golden atoms of the day;  
For, in pure love, heaven did prepare  
Those powders to enrich your hair.  
Ask me no more, whither doth haste  
The nightingale, when May is past;  
For in your sweet dividing throat  
She winters, and keeps warm her note.

Ask me no more, where those stars light,  
That downwards fall in dead of night;  
For in your eyes they sit, and there  
Fixed become, as in their sphere.

Ask me no more, if east or west,  
The phoenix builds her spicy nest;  
For unto you at last she flies,  
And in your fragrant bosom dies.

*ROBERT HERRICK*

### **NIGHT-PIECE TO JULIA**

HER eyes the glow-worm lend thee,  
The shooting stars attend thee;  
And the elves also,  
Whose little eyes glow  
Like the sparks of fire, befriend thee!

No Will-o'-the-wisp mislight thee,  
Nor snake or slow-worm bite thee!  
But on, on thy way,  
Not making a stay,  
Since ghost there is none to affright thee.

Let not the dark thee cumber;  
What though the moon does slumber?  
The stars of the night

Will lend thee their light,  
Like tapers clear without number.

Then Julia let me woo thee,  
Thus, thus to come unto me;  
And, when I shall meet  
Thy silvery feet,  
My soul I'll pour into thee.

### **THE MAD MAID'S SONG**

GOOD-MORROW to the day so fair,  
Good-morrow, sir, to you;  
Good-morrow to my own torn hair,  
Bedabbled all with dew.

Good-morrow to this primrose too;  
Good-morrow to each maid  
That will with flowers the tomb bestrew  
Wherein my love is laid.

Ah, woe is me; woe, woe is me;  
Alack and well-a-day!  
For pity, sir, find out that bee  
Which bore my love away.

I'll seek him in your bonnet brave;  
I'll seek him in your eyes;  
Nay, now I think they've made his grave  
In the bed of strawberries.



I'll seek him there, I know ere this  
The cold, cold earth doth shake him;  
But I will go, or send a kiss  
By you, sir, to awake him.

Pray hurt him not; though he be dead,  
He knows well who do love him,  
And who with green turfs rear his head,  
And who so rudely move him.

He's soft and tender, pray take heed;  
With bands of cowslips bind him,  
And bring him home; but 'tis decreed  
That I shall never find him.

## **TO BLOSSOMS**

FAIR pledges of a fruitful tree,  
Why do you fall so fast?  
Your date is not so past,  
But you may stay yet here awhile,  
To blush and gently smile,  
And go at last.

What! were ye born to be  
An hour or half's delight,  
And so to bid good-night?  
'Tis pity nature brought ye forth  
Merely to show your worth,  
And lose you quite.

But you are lovely leaves, where we  
May read how soon things have  
Their end, though ne'er so brave:  
And after they have shown their pride,  
Like you awhile, they glide  
Into the grave.

## **TO DAFFODILS**

FAIR daffodils, we weep to see  
You haste away so soon;  
As yet the early-rising sun  
Has not attained his noon:  
Stay, stay,  
Until the hast'ning day  
Has run  
But to the even-song;  
And having prayed together, we  
Will go with you along!

We have short time to stay as you;  
We have as short a spring;  
As quick a growth to meet decay,  
As you or any thing:  
We die,  
As your hours do; and dry  
Away  
Like to the summer's rain,  
Or as the pearls of morning-dew,  
Ne'er to be found again.

## **JULIA**

SOME asked me where the rubies grew,  
And nothing did I say,  
But with my finger pointed to  
The lips of Julia.

Some asked how pearls did grow, and where,  
Then spake I to my girl,  
To part her lips, and show me there  
The quarelets of pearl.

One asked me where the roses grew,  
I bade him not go seek;  
But forthwith bade my Julia shew  
A bud in either cheek.

## **TO THE VIRGINS, TO MAKE MUCH OF THEIR TIME**

GATHER the rose-buds while ye may,  
Old Time is still a-flying,  
And this same flower that smiles to-day,  
To-morrow will be dying.

The glorious lamp of heaven, the Sun,  
The higher he s a-getting,  
The sooner will his race be run,  
And nearer he's to setting.

That age is best which is the first,  
When youth and blood are warmer;

But, being spent, the worse, and worst  
Time shall succeed the former.

Then be not coy, but use your time,  
And while you may, go marry;  
For, having lost but once your prime,  
You may for ever tarry.

## **TWELFTH NIGHT, OR KING AND QUEEN**

Now, now the mirth comes,  
With the cake full of plums,  
Where bean's the king of the sport here;  
Beside, we must know,  
The pea also  
Must revel as queen in the court here.

Begin then to choose,  
This night, as ye use,  
Who shall for the present delight here;  
Be a king by the lot,  
And who shall not  
Be Twelfth-day queen for the night here.

Which known, let us make  
Joy-sops with the cake;  
And let not a man then be seen here,  
Who unurged will not drink,  
To the base from the brink,  
A health to the king and the queen here.

Next crown the bowl full  
With gentle lamb's-wool;  
Add sugar, nutmeg, and ginger,  
With store of ale, too;  
And thus ye must do  
To make the wassail a swinger.

Give them to the king  
And queen wassailing;  
And though with ale ye be wet here;  
Yet part ye from hence,  
As free from offence,  
As when ye innocent met here.

### **THE BAG OF THE BEE**

ABOUT the sweet bag of a bee,  
Two Cupids fell at odds;  
And whose the pretty prize should be,  
They vowed to ask the gods.

Which Venus hearing, thither came,  
And for their boldness stript them;  
And taking thence from each his flame,  
With rods of myrtle whipt them.

Which done, to still their wanton cries,  
When quiet grown she'ad seen them,  
She kissed and wiped their dove-like eyes  
And gave the bag between them.

## A THANKSGIVING FOR HIS HOUSE

LORD, Thou hast given me a cell  
Wherein to dwell;  
A little house, whose humble roof  
Is weatherproof;  
Under the spars of which I lie  
Both soft and dry.  
Where Thou, my chamber for to ward,  
Hast set a guard  
Of harmless thoughts, to watch and keep  
Me while I sleep.  
Low is my porch, as is my fate,  
Both void of state;  
And yet the threshold of my door  
Is worn by the poor,  
Who hither come, and freely get  
Good words or meat.  
Like as my parlour, so my hall,  
And kitchen small;  
A little buttery, and therein  
A little bin,  
Which keeps my little loaf of bread  
Unchipt, unflead.  
Some brittle sticks of thorn or brier  
Make me a fire,  
Close by whose living coal I sit,  
And glow like it.  
Lord, I confess, too, when I dine  
The pulse is Thine,  
And all those other bits that be

There placed by Thee.  
The worts, the purslain, and the mess  
Of water-cress,  
Which of Thy kindness Thou hast sent:  
And my content  
Makes those, and my beloved beet,  
To be more sweet.  
'Tis Thou that crown'st my glittering hearth  
With guiltless mirth;  
And giv'st me wassail bowls to drink,  
Spiced to the brink.  
Lord, 'tis Thy plenty-dropping hand  
That sows my land:  
All this, and better, dost Thou send  
Me for this end:  
That I should render for my part  
A thankful heart,  
Which, fired with incense, I resign  
As wholly Thine:  
But the acceptance—that must be,  
O Lord, by Thee.

### **TO PRIMROSES, FILLED WITH MORNING DEW**

WHY do ye weep, sweet babes? Can tears  
Speak grief in you,  
Who were but born  
Just as the modest morn  
Teemed her refreshing dew?  
Alas! you have not known that shower

That mars a flower,  
Nor felt the unkind  
Breath of a blasting wind;  
Nor are ye worn with years,  
Or warped as we,  
Who think it strange to see  
Such pretty flowers, like to orphans young,  
Speaking by tears before ye have a tongue.

Speak, whim'ring younglings, and make known  
The reason why  
Ye droop and weep;  
Is it for want of sleep,  
Or childish lullaby?  
Or that ye have not seen as yet  
The violet?  
Or brought a kiss  
From that sweet heart to this?  
No, no; this sorrow shown  
By your tears shed,  
Would have this lecture read—  
'That things of greatest, so of meanest worth,  
Conceived with grief are, and with tears brought forth.'

## **DELIGHT IN DISORDER**

A SWEET disorder in the dress  
[A happy kind of carelessness;]  
A lawn about the shoulders thrown  
Into a fine distraction;



An erring lace, which here and there  
Enthralls the crimson stomacher;  
A cuff neglectful, and thereby  
Ribands that flow confusedly;  
A winning wave, deserving note  
In the tempestuous petticoat;  
A careless shoe-string, in whose tie  
I see a wild civility;  
Do more bewitch me, than when art  
Is too precise in every part.

### **CHERRY RIPE**

CHERRY ripe, ripe, ripe, I cry,  
Full and fair ones—come and buy;  
If so be you ask me where  
They do grow?—I answer: There,  
Where my Julia's lips do smile—  
There's the land, or cherry-isle;  
Whose plantations fully show  
All the year where cherries grow.

*GEORGE HERBERT*

### **VIRTUE**

SWEET day! so cool, so calm, so bright  
The bridal of the earth and sky;

The dews shall weep thy fall to-night;  
For thou must die.

Sweet rose! whose hue, angry and brave,  
Bids the rash gazer wipe his eye;  
Thy root is ever in its grave;  
And thou must die.

Sweet spring! full of sweet days and roses;  
A box where sweets compacted lie;  
Thy music shows ye have your closes;  
And all must die.

Only a sweet and virtuous soul,  
Like seasoned timber never gives;  
But, though the whole world turn to coal,  
Then chiefly lives.

*ANONYMOUS*

### **THE SPANISH ARMADO**

SOME years of late, in eighty-eight,  
As I do well remember,  
It was, some say, the middle of May,  
And some say in September,  
And some say in September.

The Spanish train launch'd forth amain,  
With many a fine bravado,

Their (as they thought, but it prov'd not)  
Invincible Armado,  
Invincible Armado.

There was a man that dwelt in Spain  
Who shot well with a gun a,  
Don Pedro hight, as black a wight  
As the Knight of the Sun a,  
As the Knight of the Sun a.

King Philip made him Admiral,  
And bid him not to stay a,  
But to destroy both man and boy  
And so to come away a,  
And so to come away a.

Their navy was well victualled  
With bisket, pease, and bacon,  
They brought two ships, well fraught with whips,  
But I think they were mistaken,  
But I think they were mistaken.

Their men were young, munition strong,  
And to do us more harm a,  
They thought it meet to joyn their fleet  
All with the Prince of Parma,  
All with the Prince of Parma.

They coasted round about our land,  
And so came in by Dover:  
But we had men set on 'em then,

And threw the rascals over,  
And threw the rascals over.

The Queen was then at Tilbury,  
What could we more desire a?  
Sir Francis Drake for her sweet sake  
Did set them all on fire a,  
Did set them all on fire a.

Then straight they fled by sea and land,  
That one man kill'd threescore a,  
And had not they all run away,  
In truth he had kill'd more a,  
In truth he had kill'd more a.

Then let them neither bray nor boast,  
But if they come again a,  
Let them take heed they do not speed  
As they did you know when a,  
As they did you know when a.

*SIR JOHN SUCKLING*

### **A BALLAD UPON A WEDDING**

I TELL thee, Dick, where I have been;  
Where I the rarest things have seen;  
Oh, things without compare!  
Such sights again can not be found

In any place on English ground,  
Be it at wake or faer.

At Charing Cross, hard by the way  
Where we (thou know'st) do sell our hay,  
There is a house with stairs;  
And there did I see coming down  
Such folks as are not in our town;  
Vorty at least, in pairs.

Amongst the rest one pest'lent fine  
(His beard no bigger tho' than thine)  
Walk'd on before the rest;  
Our landlord looks like nothing to him;  
The King (God bless him),'twould undo him,  
Should he go still so drest.

At Course-a-park, without all doubt,  
He should have first been taken out  
By all the maids i' the town:  
Though lusty Roger there had been,  
Or little George upon the green,  
Or Vincent of the crown.

But wot you what? The youth was going  
To make an end of all his wooing:  
The parson for him staid:  
Yet by his leave, for all his haste,  
He did not so much wish all past,  
Perchance as did the maid.

The maid (and thereby hangs a tale)  
For such a maid no Whitson-ale  
Could ever yet produce;  
No grape that's kindly ripe could be  
So round, so plump, so soft as she,  
Nor half so full of juyce.

Her finger was so small, the ring  
Would not stay on which they did bring;  
It was too wide a peck:  
And, to say truth (for out it must),  
It look'd like the great collar (just)  
About our young colt's neck.

Her feet beneath her petticoat,  
Like little mice stole in and out,  
As if they fear'd the light:  
But oh! she dances such a way;  
No sun upon an Easter day  
Is half as fine a sight.

Her cheeks so rare, a white was on,  
No daisie make comparison  
(Who sees them is undone);  
For streaks of red were mingled there,  
Such as are on a Kath'rine pear,  
The side that's next the sun.

Her lips were red; and one was thin,  
Compared to what was next her chin  
(Some bee had stung it newly);  
But, Dick, her eyes so guard her face,

I durst no more upon them gaze,  
Than on a sun in July.

Her mouth so small, when she does speak,  
Thou'dst swear her teeth her words did break  
That they might passage get;  
But she so handled still the matter,  
They came as good as ours, or better,  
And are not spent a whit.

Passion, oh me! how I run on!  
There's that that would be thought upon,  
I trow, beside the bride.  
The business of the kitchen's great;  
For it is fit that men should eat,  
Nor was it there denied.

Just in the nick the cook knocked thrice,  
And all the waiters in a trice  
His summons did obey;  
Each serving man, with dish in hand,  
March'd boldly up like our train'd band,  
Presented, and away.

When all the meat was on the table,  
What man of knife, or teeth, was able  
To stay to be entreated?  
And this the very reason was,  
Before the parson could say grace  
The company was seated.

Now hats fly off, and youths carouse;  
Healts first go round, and then the house,  
The bride's came thick and thick;  
And when 'twas named another's health,  
Perhaps he made it her's by stealth,  
(And who could help it, Dick?)

O' th' sudden up they rise and dance;  
Then sit again, and sigh, and glance:  
Then dance again, and kiss:  
Thus several ways the time did pass,  
Till ev'ry woman wish'd her place,  
And ev'ry man wish'd his.

By this time all were stolen aside  
To counsel and undress the bride;  
But that he must not know:  
But yet 'twas thought he guess'd her mind,  
And did not mean to stay behind  
Above an hour or so.

### **WHY SO PALE AND WAN?**

WHY so pale and wan, fond lover?  
Prithee, why so pale?  
Will, when looking well can't move her,  
Looking ill prevail?  
Prithee, why so pale?

Why so dull and mute, young sinner?  
Prithee, why so mute?



Will, when speaking well can't win her,  
Saying nothing do't?  
Prithee, why so mute?

Quit, quit, for shame, this will not move,  
This cannot take her;  
If of herself she will not love,  
Nothing can make her.  
The devil take her!

*EDMUND WALLER*

**GO, LOVELY ROSE!**

Go, lovely Rose!  
Tell her, that wastes her time and me,  
That now she knows,  
When I resemble her to thee  
How sweet and fair she seems to be.

Tell her that's young,  
And shuns to have her graces spied,  
That hadst thou sprung  
In deserts, where no men abide,  
Thou must have uncommended died.

Small is the worth  
Of beauty from the light retired:  
Bid her come forth,

Suffer herself to be desired,  
And not blush so to be admired.

Then die! that she  
The common fate of all things rare  
May read in thee:  
How small a part of time they share  
That are so wondrous sweet and fair!

*ANONYMOUS*

### **THE FROG HE WOULD A-WOOING RIDE**

IT was the frog in the well,  
Humble dum, humble dum,  
And the merry mouse in the mill,  
Tweedle, tweedle, twino.

The frog would a-wooing ride,  
Humble dum, humble dum,  
Sword and buckler by his side,  
Tweedle, tweedle, twino.

When upon his high horse set,  
Humble dum, humble dum,  
His boots they shone as black as jet,  
Tweedle, tweedle, twino.

When he came to the merry mill pin,  
Lady Mouse beene you within?

Then came out the dusty mouse,  
I am lady of this house;

Hast thou any mind of me?  
I have e'en great mind of thee.  
Who shall this marriage make?  
Our lord, which is the rat.

What shall we have to our supper?  
Three beans in a pound of butter.  
But, when supper they were at,  
The frog, the mouse, and e'en the rat,

Then came in Tib, our cat,  
And caught the mouse e'en by the back,  
Then did they separate  
The frog leapt on the floor so flat;

Then came in Dick, our drake,  
And drew the frog e'en to the lake,  
The rat he ran up the wall,  
And so the company parted all.

*RICHARD LOVELACE*

**TO ALTHEA, FROM PRISON**

WHEN love with unconfined wings  
Hovers within my gates,  
And my divine Althea brings

To whisper at my grates;  
When I lie tangled in her hair,  
And fetter'd to her eye,  
The birds that wanton in the air  
Know no such liberty.

When flowing cups run swiftly round,  
With no allaying Thames,  
Our careless heads with roses bound,  
Our hearts with loyal flames;  
When thirsty grief in wine we steep,  
When healths and draughts are free,—  
Fishes that tinkle in the deep  
Know no such liberty.

When linnet-like confined, I  
With shriller throat shall sing  
The sweetness, mercy, majesty,  
And glories of my king:  
When I shall voice aloud how good  
He is, how great should be,—  
Enlarged winds that curl the flood  
Know no such liberty.

Stone walls do not a prison make,  
Nor iron bars a cage;  
Minds innocent and quiet take  
That for a hermitage:  
If I have freedom in my love,  
And in my soul am free,—

Angels alone that soar above  
Enjoy such liberty.

### **TO LUCASTA, ON GOING TO THE WARS**

TELL me not, sweet, I am unkind,—  
That from the nunnery  
Of thy chaste breast and quiet mind  
To war and arms I fly.

True, a new mistress now I chase,  
The first foe in the field;  
And with a stronger faith embrace  
A sword, a horse, a shield.

Yet this inconstancy is such  
As you, too, shall adore;  
I could not love thee, dear, so much,  
Loved I not honour more.

*MARTIN PARKER*

### **YE GENTLEMEN OF ENGLAND**

YE gentlemen of England  
That live at home at ease,  
Ah! little do ye think upon  
The dangers of the seas.  
Give ear unto the mariners,

And they will plainly show  
All the cares and the fears  
When the stormy winds do blow.  
When the stormy winds do blow.

If enemies oppose us  
When England is at war  
With any foreign nation,  
We fear not wound or scar;  
Our roaring guns shall teach 'em  
Our valour for to know,  
Whilst they reel on the keel,  
And the stormy winds do blow.  
And the stormy winds do blow.

Then courage, all brave mariners,  
And never be dismay'd;  
While we have bold adventurers,  
We ne'er shall want a trade:  
Our merchants will employ us  
To fetch them wealth, we know;  
Then be bold—work for gold,  
When the stormy winds do blow.  
When the stormy winds do blow.

*ANONYMOUS*

**THE FAIRY QUEEN**

COME follow, follow me,  
You, fairy elves that be:  
Which circle on the greene,  
Come follow Mab your queene.  
Hand in hand let's dance around,  
For this place is fairye ground.

When mortals are at rest,  
And snoring in their nest;  
Unheard, and unespy'd,  
Through key-holes we do glide;  
Over tables, stools, and shelves,  
We trip it with our fairy elves.

And, if the house be foul  
With platter, dish, or bowl,  
Upstairs we nimbly creep,  
And find the sluts asleep;  
There we pinch their armes and thighes;  
None escapes, nor none espies.

But if the house be swept,  
And from uncleanness kept,  
We praise the houshold maid,  
And duely she is paid:  
For we use before we goe  
To drop a tester in her shoe.

Upon a mushroome's head  
Our table-cloth we spread;  
A grain of rye, or wheat,

Is manchet, which we eat;  
Pearly drops of dew we drink  
In acorn cups fill'd to the brink.

The brains of nightingales,  
With unctuous fat of snails,  
Between two cockles stew'd,  
Is meat that's easily chew'd;  
Tails of wormes, and marrow of mice,  
Do make a dish that's wondrous nice.  
The grasshopper, gnat, and fly,  
Serve for our minstrelsie;  
Grace said, we dance a while,  
And so the time beguile:  
And if the moon doth hide her head,  
The glowe-worm lights us home to bed.

On tops of dewie grasse  
So nimbly do we passe;  
The young and tender stalk  
Ne'er bends when we do walk:  
Yet in the morning may be seen  
Where we the night before have been.

*JOHN CHALKHILL*

**THE PRAISE OF A COUNTRYMAN'S LIFE**



OH, the sweet contentment  
The countryman doth find,  
High trolollie, lollie, lol; high trolollie, lee;  
That quiet contemplation  
Possesseth all my mind:  
Then care away, and wend along with me.

For courts are full of flattery,  
As hath too oft been tried,  
High trolollie, lollie, lol; high trolollie, lee;  
The city full of wantonness,  
And both are full of pride;  
Then care away, and wend along with me.

But, oh! the honest countryman  
Speaks truly from his heart,  
High trolollie, lollie, lol; high trolollie, lee;  
His pride is in his tillage,  
His horses and his cart:  
Then care away, and wend along with me.

Our clothing is good sheep-skins,  
Grey russet for our wives,  
High trolollie, lollie, lol; high trolollie, lee;  
'Tis warmth and not gay clothing  
That doth prolong our lives:  
Then care away, and wend along with me.

The ploughman, though he labour hard,  
Yet on the holy day,  
High trolollie, lollie, lol; high trolollie, lee;  
No emperor so merrily

Does pass his time away:  
Then care away, and wend along with me.

To recompense our tillage  
The heavens afford us showers,  
High trolollie, lollie, lol; high trolollie, lee;  
And for our sweet refreshments  
The earth affords us bowers;  
Then care away, and wend along with me.

The cuckoo and the nightingale  
Full merrily do sing,  
High trolollie, lollie, lol; high trolollie, lee;  
And with their pleasant roundelays  
Bid welcome to the spring:  
Then care away, and wend along with me.

This is not half the happiness  
The countryman enjoys,  
High trolollie, lollie, lol; high trolollie, lee;  
Though others think they have as much,  
Yet he that says so lies:  
Then care away, and wend along with me.

*ANONYMOUS*

**HERE'S A HEALTH**

HERE'S a health unto His Majesty, *With a fa, la, la, la, la, la!* Confusion  
to his enemies, *With a fa, la, la, la, la, la!* And he that will not drink his  
health, I wish him neither wit nor wealth, Nor yet a rope to hang himself,  
*With a fa, la, la, la, la, la!*

*JOHN GAY*

**BLACK-EYED SUSAN**

ALL in the Downs the fleet was moor'd,  
The streamers waving in the wind,  
When black-eyed Susan came on board,  
Oh, where shall I my true-love find?  
Tell me, ye jovial sailors, tell me true,  
Does my sweet William sail among your crew?'

William, who high upon the yard  
Rock'd by the billows to and fro,  
Soon as the well-known voice he heard,  
He sigh'd and cast his eyes below;  
The cord flies swiftly through his glowing hands,  
And quick as lightning on the deck he stands.

'O Susan, Susan, lovely dear,  
My vows shall always true remain,  
Let me kiss off that falling tear,—  
We only part to meet again;  
Change as ye list, ye winds, my heart shall be  
The faithful compass that still points to thee.

Believe not what the landsmen say,  
Who tempt with doubts thy constant mind;  
They tell thee sailors, when away,  
In every port a mistress find;  
Yes, yes, believe them when they tell you so,  
For thou art present wheresoe'er I go.'

The boatswain gave the dreadful word,  
The sails their swelling bosom spread;  
No longer she must stay on board,  
They kiss'd, she sigh'd, he hung his head:  
Her lessening boat unwilling rows to land,  
'Adieu!' she cried, and wav'd her lily hand.

*ANONYMOUS*

**ANNIE LAURIE**

MAXWELLTON braes are bonnie,  
Where early fa's the dew,  
And 'twas there that Annie Laurie  
Gied me her promise true;

Gied me her promise true,  
Which ne'er forgot shall be,  
And for bonnie Annie Laurie,  
I'd lay me doon and dee.

Her brow is like the snaw-flake,  
Her neck is like the swan,  
Her face it is the fairest  
That e'er the sun shone on;  
That e'er the sun shone on,  
And dark blue is her e'e;  
And for bonnie Annie Laurie  
I'd lay me doon and dee.

Like dew on the gowan lying,  
Is the fa' of her fairy feet;  
And like winds in summer sighing,  
Her voice is low and sweet;  
Her voice is low and sweet,  
And she's a' the world to me;  
And for bonnie Annie Laurie  
I'd lay me doon and dee.

JAMES THOMSON

### **RULE BRITANNIA**

WHEN Britain first at Heaven's command  
Arose from out the azure main,

This was the charter of her land,  
And guardian angels sang the strain:

Rule Britannia! Britannia rules the waves!  
Britons never shall be slaves!

The nations not so blest as thee  
Must in their turn to tyrants fall,  
Whilst thou shalt flourish great and free—  
The dread and envy of them all!

Still more majestic shalt thou rise,  
More dreadful from each foreign stroke;  
As the last blast which tears the skies  
Serves but to root thy native oak.

Thee haughty tyrants ne'er shall tame;  
All their attempts to bend thee down  
Will but arouse thy generous flame,  
And work their woe and thy renown.

To thee belongs the rural reign;  
Thy cities shall with commerce shine;  
All thine shall be the subject main,  
And every shore it circles thine.

The Muses, still with Freedom found,  
Shall to thy happy coast repair;  
Blest Isle, with matchless beauty crown'd,  
And manly hearts to guard the fair:—

Rule Britannia! Britannia rules the waves!  
Britons never shall be slaves!

## *ANONYMOUS*

### **WALY, WALY, BUT LOVE BE BONNY**

O WALY, waly up the bank,  
And waly, waly down the brae,  
And waly, waly yon burn-side,  
Where I and my love wont to gae.  
I lean'd my back unto an aik,  
And thought it was a trusty tree,  
But first it bow'd, and syne it brak,  
Sae my true love did lightly me.

O waly, waly, but love is bonny,  
A little time while it is new,  
But when 'tis auld, it waxeth cauld,  
And fades away like morning dew.  
Oh! wherefore should I busk my head?  
Or wherefore should I kame my hair?  
For my true love has me forsook,  
And says he'll never love me mair.

Now Arthur Seat shall be my bed,  
The sheets shall ne'er be fil'd by me,  
Saint Anton's well shall be my drink,  
Since my true love's forsaken me.  
Martinmas wind, when wilt thou blaw,

And shake the green leaves off the tree?  
Oh, gentle death! when wilt thou come?  
For of my life I am weary.

'Tis not the frost that freezes fell,  
Nor blowing snow's inclemency;  
'Tis not sic cauld that makes me cry,  
But my love's heart grown cauld to me.  
When we came in by Glasgow town,  
We were a comely sight to see;  
My love was clad in the black velvet,  
And I mysel' in cramasie.

But had I wist before I kiss'd  
That love had been so ill to win,  
I'd lock'd my heart in a case of gold,  
And pinn'd it with a silver pin.  
And oh! if my young babe were born,  
And set upon the nurse's knee,  
And I mysel' were dead and gane,  
Wi' the green grass growin' over me!

*HENRY CAREY*

### **SALLY IN OUR ALLEY**

OF all the girls that are so smart,  
There's none like pretty Sally;  
She is the darling of my heart,



And lives in our alley.  
There's ne'er a lady in the land  
Is half so sweet as Sally;  
She is the darling of my heart,  
And lives in our alley.

Her father he makes cabbage nets,  
And through the streets doth cry them;  
Her mother she sells laces long  
To such as please to buy them:  
But sure such folk can have no part  
In such a girl as Sally;  
She is the darling of my heart,  
And lives in our alley.

When she is by, I leave my work,  
I love her so sincerely;  
My master comes, like any Turk,  
And bangs me most severely:  
But let him bang, long as he will,  
I'll bear it all for Sally;  
She is the darling of my heart,  
And lives in our alley.

Of all the days are in the week,  
I dearly love but one day,  
And that's the day that comes betwixt  
A Saturday and Monday;  
For then I'm dress'd, in all my best,  
To walk abroad with Sally;

She is the darling of my heart,  
And lives in our alley.

My master carries me to church,  
And often I am blamed,  
Because I leave him in the lurch,  
Soon as the text is named:  
I leave the church in sermon time,  
And slink away to Sally;  
She is the darling of my heart,  
And lives in our alley.

When Christmas comes about again,  
O then I shall have money;  
I'll hoard it up and, box and all,  
I'll give unto my honey:  
I would it were ten thousand pounds,  
I'd give it all to Sally;  
She is the darling of my heart,  
And lives in our alley.

My master and the neighbours all,  
Make game of me and Sally,  
And but for she I'd better be  
A slave, and row a galley:  
But when my seven long years are out,  
O then I'll marry Sally,  
And then how happily we'll live—  
But not in our alley.

*WILLIAM HAMILTON*

**THE BRAES OF YARROW**

BUSK ye, busk ye, my bonny bonny bride,  
Busk ye, busk ye, my winsome marrow,  
Busk ye, busk ye, my bonny bonny bride,  
And think nae mair on the Braes of Yarrow.

Where gat ye that bonny bonny bride?  
Where gat ye that winsome marrow?  
I gat her where I daurna weel be seen,  
Pu'ing the birks on the Braes of Yarrow.

Weep not, weep not, my bonny bonny bride,  
Weep not, weep not, my winsome marrow;  
Nor let thy heart lament to leive  
Pu'ing the birks on the Braes of Yarrow.

Why does she weep, thy bonny bonny bride?  
Why does she weep, thy winsome marrow?  
And why daur ye nae mair weel be seen  
Pu'ing the birks on the Braes of Yarrow?

Lang mann she weep, lang maun she, maun she weep,  
Lang maun she weep with dule and sorrow,  
And lang maun I nae mair weel be seen  
Pu'ing the birks on the Braes of Yarrow.

For she has tint her luvver, luvver dear,  
Her luvver dear, the cause of sorrow;

And I hae slain the comliest swain  
That eir pu'd birks on the Braes of Yarrow.

Why rins thy stream, O Yarrow, Yarrow, reid?  
Why on thy braes heard the voice of sorrow?  
And why yon melancholious weids  
Hung on the bonny birks of Yarrow?

What's yonder floats on the rueful rueful flude?  
What's yonder floats? O dule and sorrow!  
O 'tis he the comely swain I slew  
Upon the duleful Braes of Yarrow.

Wash, O wash his wounds, his wounds in tears,  
His wounds in tears with dule and sorrow;  
And wrap his limbs in mourning weids,  
And lay him on the Braes of Yarrow.

Then build, then build, ye sisters, sisters sad,  
Ye sisters sad, his tomb with sorrow;  
And weep around in waeful wise  
His hapless fate on the Braes of Yarrow!

Curse ye, curse ye, his useless, useless shield,  
My arm that wrought the deed of sorrow,  
The fatal spear that pierc'd his breast,  
His comely breast, on the Braes of Yarrow.

Did I not warn thee, not to, not to luve?  
And warn from fight? but to my sorrow  
Too rashly bauld a stronger arm  
Thou mett'st, and fell on the Braes of Yarrow.

Sweet smells the birk, green grows, green grows the grass,  
Yellow on Yarrow's bank the gowan;  
Fair hangs the apple frae the rock,  
Sweet the wave of Yarrow flowin'!

Flows Yarrow sweet? as sweet, as sweet flows Tweed,  
As green its grass, its gowan as yellow,  
As sweet smells on its braes the birk,  
The apple frae its rocks as mellow.

Fair was thy luve, fair fair indeed thy luve,  
In flow'ry bands thou didst him fetter;  
Tho' he was fair, and weel beluv'd again  
Than me he never luv'd thee better.

Busk ye, then busk, my bonny bonny bride,  
Busk ye, busk ye, my winsome marrow,  
Busk ye, and luve me on the banks of Tweed,  
And think nae mair on the Braes of Yarrow.

How can I busk a bonny bonny bride?  
How can I busk a winsome marrow?  
How luve him on the banks of Tweed,  
That slew my luve on the Braes of Yarrow?

O Yarrow fields, may never never rain,  
Nor dew thy tender blossoms cover,  
For there was basely slain my luve,  
My luve, as he had not been a lover.

The boy put on his robes, his robes of green,  
His purple vest—'twas my awn sewing:

Ah! wretched me! I little, little kenn'd  
He was in these to meet his ruin.

The boy took out his milk-white, milk-white steed,  
Unheedful of my dule and sorrow:  
But ere the toofall of the night  
He lay a corpse on the Braes of Yarrow.

Much I rejoyc'd that waeful waeful day;  
I sang, my voice the woods returning:  
But lang ere night the spear was flown,  
That slew my luvie, and left me mourning.

What can my barbarous barbarous father do,  
But with his cruel rage pursue me?  
My luvie's blood is on thy spear  
How canst thou, barbarous man, then woo me?

My happy sisters may be, may be proud  
With cruel and ungentle scoffin',  
May bid me seek on Yarrow Braes  
My luvie nailed in his coffin.

My brother Douglas may upbraid, upbraid,  
And strive with threatning words to muve me:  
My luvie's blood is on thy spear  
How canst thou ever bid me luvie thee?

Yes, yes, prepare the bed, the bed of luvie,  
With bridal sheets my body cover,  
Unbar, ye bridal maids, the door!  
Let in the expected husband-lover.

But who the expected husband husband is?  
His hands, methinks, are bath'd in slaughter.  
Ah me! what ghastly spectre's yon  
Comes, in his pale shroud, bleeding after?

Pale as he is, here lay him, lay him down,  
O lay his cold head on my pillow!  
Take aff, take aff these bridal weids,  
And crown my careful head with willow.

Pale tho' thou art, yet best, yet best beluv'd,  
O could my warmth to life restore thee!  
Ye'd lye all night between my breasts—  
No youth lay ever there before thee!

Pale, pale indeed, O lovely lovely youth,  
Forgive, forgive so foul a slaughter,  
And lye all night between my breasts,  
No youth shall ever lye there after.

A. Return, return, O mournful, mournful bride  
Return and dry thy useless sorrow!  
Thy lover heeds none of thy sighs,  
He lyes a corpse on the Braes of Yarrow.

*WILLIAM SHENSTONE*

**THE SHEPHERD'S HOME**

MY banks they are furnished with bees,  
Whose murmur invites one to sleep;  
My grottoes are shaded with trees,  
And my hills are white over with sheep.  
I seldom have met with a loss,  
Such health do my fountains bestow;  
My fountains all bordered with moss,  
Where the harebells and violets blow.

Not a pine in the grove is there seen,  
But with tendrils of woodbine is bound;  
Not a beech's more beautiful green,  
But a sweet-briar entwines it around.  
Not my fields in the prime of the year,  
More charms than my cattle unfold;  
Not a brook that is limpid and clear,  
But it glitters with fishes of gold.

I have found out a gift for my fair,  
I have found where the wood-pigeons breed;  
But let me such plunder forbear,  
She will say 'twas a barbarous deed;  
For he ne'er could be true, she averred,  
Who would rob a poor bird of its young;  
And I loved her the more when I heard  
Such tenderness fall from her tongue.

*WILLIAM COWPER*

**THE DIVERTING HISTORY OF JOHN GILPIN**



JOHN GILPIN was a citizen  
Of credit and renown,  
A train-band captain eke was he  
Of famous London town.

John Gilpin's spouse said to her dear:  
'Though wedded we have been  
These twice ten tedious years, yet we  
No holiday have seen.

'To-morrow is our wedding-day,  
And we will then repair  
Unto the Bell at Edmonton  
All in a chaise and pair.

'My sister, and my sister's child,  
Myself and children three,  
Will fill the chaise; so you must ride  
On horseback after we.'

He soon replied: 'I do admire  
Of womankind but one,  
And you are she, my dearest dear;  
Therefore, it shall be done.

'I am a linen-draper bold,  
As all the world doth know,  
And my good friend the calender  
Will lend his horse to go.'

Quoth Mrs. Gilpin: 'That's well said;  
And for that wine is dear,

We will be furnished with our own,  
Which is both bright and clear.'

John Gilpin kissed his loving wife;  
O'erjoyed was he to find  
That, though on pleasure she was bent,  
She had a frugal mind.

The morning came, the chaise was brought,  
But yet was not allowed  
To drive up to the door, lest all  
Should say that she was proud.

So three doors off the chaise was stayed,  
Where they did all get in;  
Six precious souls, and all agog  
To dash through thick and thin.

Smack went the whip, round went the wheels,  
Were never folk so glad;  
The stones did rattle underneath,  
As if Cheapside were mad.

John Gilpin at his horse's side  
Seized fast the flowing mane,  
And up he got, in haste to ride,  
But soon came down again;

For saddle-tree scarce reached had he,  
His journey to begin,  
When, turning round his head, he saw  
Three customers come in.

So down he came; for loss of time,  
Although it grieved him sore,  
Yet loss of pence, full well he knew,  
Would trouble him much more.

'Twas long before the customers  
Were suited to their mind,  
When Betty screaming came down stairs:  
The wine is left behind!'

'Good lack!' quoth he—'et bring it me,  
My leathern belt likewise,  
In which I bear my trusty sword  
When I do exercise.'

Now Mrs. Gilpin—careful soul!—  
Had two stone-bottles found,  
To hold the liquor that she loved,  
And keep it safe and sound.

Each bottle had a curling ear,  
Through which the belt he drew,  
And hung a bottle on each side,  
To make his balance true.

Then over all, that he might be  
Equipped from top to toe,  
His long red cloak, well brushed and neat,  
He manfully did throw.  
Now see him mounted once again  
Upon his nimble steed,

Full slowly pacing o'er the stones  
With caution and good heed.

But finding soon a smother road  
Beneath his well-shod feet,  
The snorting beast began to trot,  
Which galled him in his seat.

So, 'Fair and softly,' John he cried,  
But John he cried in vain;  
That trot became a gallop soon,  
In spite of curb and rein.

So stooping down, as needs he must  
Who cannot sit upright,  
He grasped the mane with both his hands,  
And eke with all his might.

His horse, which never in that sort  
Had handled been before,  
What thing upon his back had got  
Did wonder more and more.

Away went Gilpin, neck or nought;  
Away went hat and wig;  
He little dreamt when he set out  
Of running such a rig.

The wind did blow, the cloak did fly,  
Like streamer long and gay,  
Till, loop and button failing both,  
At last it flew away.

Then might all people well discern  
The bottles he had slung;  
A bottle swinging at each side,  
As hath been said or sung.

The dogs did bark, the children screamed,  
Up flew the windows all;  
And every soul cried out: 'Well done!'  
As loud as he could bawl.

Away went Gilpin—who but he?  
His fame soon spread around;  
He carries weight! he rides a race!  
'Tis for a thousand pound!

And still, as fast as he drew near,  
'Twas wonderful to view  
How in a trice the turnpike-men  
Their gates wide open threw.

And now, as he went bowing down  
His reeking head full low,  
The bottles twain behind his back  
Were shattered at a blow.

Down ran the wine into the road,  
Most piteous to be seen,  
Which made his horse's flanks to smoke  
As they had basted been.

But still he seemed to carry weight,  
With leathern girdle braced;

For all might see the bottle necks  
Still dangling at his waist.

Thus all through merry Islington  
These gambols he did play,  
Until he came unto the Wash  
Of Edmonton so gay;

And there he threw the wash about  
On both sides of the way,  
Just like unto a trundling mop,  
Or a wild goose at play.

At Edmonton his loving wife  
From the balcony spied  
Her tender husband, wondering much  
To see how he did ride.

'Stop, stop, John Gilpin!—Here's the house'—  
They all aloud did cry;  
The dinner waits, and we are tired!  
Said Gilpin: So am I!

But yet his horse was not a whit  
Inclined to tarry there;  
For why? his owner had a house  
Full ten miles off, at Ware.

So like an arrow swift he flew,  
Shot by an archer strong;  
So did he fly—which brings me to  
The middle of my song.

Away went Gilpin out of breath,  
And sore against his will,  
Till at his friend the calender's  
His horse at last stood still.

The calender, amazed to see  
His neighbour in such trim,  
Laid down his pipe, flew to the gate,  
And thus accosted him:

'What news? what news? your tidings tell—  
Tell me you must and shall  
Say why bareheaded you are come,  
Or why you come at all?'

Now Gilpin had a pleasant wit,  
And loved a timely joke;  
And thus unto the calendar  
In merry guise he spoke:

'I came because your horse would come;  
And, if I well forebode,  
My hat and wig will soon be here—  
They are upon the road.'

The calender, right glad to find  
His friend in merry pin,  
Returned him not a single word,  
But to the house went in;

Whence straight he came with hat and wig;  
A wig that flowed behind,

A hat not much the worse for wear,  
Each comely in its kind.

He held them up, and in his turn  
Thus showed his ready wit:  
'My head is twice as big as yours,  
They therefore needs must fit.

But let me scrape the dirt away  
That hangs upon your face:  
And stop and eat, for well you may  
Be in a hungry case.'

Said John: 'It is my wedding-day,  
And all the world would stare  
If wife should dine at Edmonton,  
And I should dine at Ware.'

So turning to his horse, he said:  
'I am in haste to dine;  
'Twas for your pleasure you came here,  
You shall go back for mine.'

Ah, luckless speech, and bootless boast!  
For which he paid full dear;  
For, while he spake, a braying ass  
Did sing most loud and clear;

Whereat his horse did snort, as he  
Had heard a lion roar,  
And galloped off with all his might,  
As he had done before.



Away went Gilpin, and away  
Went Gilpin's hat and wig;  
He lost them sooner than at first;  
For why?—they were too big.

Now Mrs. Gilpin, when she saw  
Her husband posting down  
Into the country far away,  
She pulled out half-a-crown;

And thus unto the youth she said  
That drove them to the Bell:  
'This shall be yours when you bring back  
My husband safe and well.'

The youth did ride, and soon did meet  
John coming back amain;  
Whom in a trice he tried to stop,  
By catching at his rein;

But not performing what he meant,  
And gladly would have done,  
The frightened steed he frightened more,  
And made him faster run.

Away went Gilpin, and away  
Went post-boy at his heels,  
The post-boy's horse right glad to miss  
The lumbering of the wheels.

Six gentlemen upon the road  
Thus seeing Gilpin fly,

With post-boy scampering in the rear,  
They raised the hue and cry:

Stop thief! stop thief!—a highwayman  
Not one of them was mute;  
And all and each that passed that way  
Did join in the pursuit.

And now the turnpike gates again  
Flew open in short space;  
The tollmen thinking as before  
That Gilpin rode a race.  
And so he did, and won it too,  
For he got first to town;  
Nor stopped till where he had got up  
He did again get down.

Now let us sing, long live the king,  
And Gilpin, long live he;  
And, when he next doth ride abroad,  
May I be there to see!

### **THE ' ROYAL GEORGE '**

TOLL for the Brave!  
The brave that are no more!  
All sunk beneath the wave  
Fast by their native shore!

Eight hundred of the brave,  
Whose courage well was tried,

Had made the vessel heel  
And laid her on her side.

A land-breeze shook the shrouds,  
And she was overset;  
Down went the *Royal George*  
With all her crew complete.

Toll for the brave!  
Brave Kempenfelt is gone;  
His last sea-fight is fought,  
His work of glory done.

It was not in the battle;  
No tempest gave the shock,  
She sprang no fatal leak,  
She ran upon no rock.

His sword was in its sheath,  
His fingers held the pen,  
When Kempenfelt went down  
With twice four hundred men.

Weigh the vessel up,  
Once dreaded by our foes!  
And mingle with our cup  
The tear that England owes.

Her timbers yet are sound,  
And she may float again  
Full charged with England's thunders  
And plough the distant main:

But Kempenfelt is gone,  
His victories are o'er;  
And he and his eight hundred  
Shall plough the wave no more.

## **BOADICEA**

WHEN the British warrior queen,  
Bleeding from the Roman rods,  
Sought, with an indignant mien,  
Counsel of her country's gods,

Sage beneath the spreading oak  
Sat the Druid, hoary chief;  
Every burning word he spoke  
Full of rage, and full of grief.

'Princess, if our aged eyes  
Weep upon thy matchless wrongs,  
'Tis because resentment ties  
All the terrors of our tongues.

'Rome shall perish—write that word  
In the blood that she has spilt;  
Perish, hopeless and abhorr'd,  
Deep in ruin as in guilt.

'Rome, for empire far renown'd,  
Tramples on a thousand states;  
Soon her pride shall kiss the ground—  
Hark! the Gaul is at her gates!

'Other Romans shall arise,  
Heedless of a soldier's name;  
Sounds, not arms, shall win the prize,  
Harmony the path to fame.

'Then the progeny that springs  
From the forests of our land,  
Arm'd with thunder, clad with wings,  
Shall a wider world command.

'Regions Caesar never knew  
Thy posterity shall sway;  
Where his eagles never flew,  
None invincible as they.'

Such the bard's prophetic words,  
Pregnant with celestial fire,  
Bending as he swept the chords  
Of his sweet but awful lyre.

She, with all a monarch's pride,  
Felt them in her bosom glow;  
Rush'd to battle, fought, and died;  
Dying hurl'd them at the foe.

'Ruffians, pitiless as proud,  
Heaven awards the vengeance due  
Empire is on us bestow'd,  
Shame and ruin wait for you.'

*DAVID GARRICK*

## **HEARTS OF OAK**

Come, cheer up, my lads, 'tis to glory we steer,  
To add something more to this wonderful year,  
To honour we call you not press you like slaves,  
For who are so free as the sons of the waves?  
Hearts of oak are our ships, hearts of oak are our men,  
We always are ready,  
Steady, boys, steady,  
We'll fight and we'll conquer again and again.

We ne'er see our foes but we wish them to stay,  
They never see us but they wish us away;  
If they run, why, we follow, and run them ashore,  
For if they won't fight us, we cannot do more.  
Hearts of oak are our ships, hearts of oak are our men,  
We always are ready,  
Steady, boys, steady,  
We'll fight and we'll conquer again and again.

Still Britain shall triumph, her ships plough the sea,  
Her standard be justice, her watchword 'Be free';  
Then, cheer up, my lads, with one heart let us sing  
Our soldiers, our sailors, our statesmen, our king.  
Hearts of oak are our ships, hearts of oak are our men,  
We always are ready,  
Steady, boys, steady,  
We'll fight and we'll conquer again and again.

*OLIVER GOLDSMITH*

**AN ELEGY ON THE DEATH OF A MAD DOG**

GOOD people all, of every sort,  
Give ear unto my song;  
And if you find it wondrous short,  
It cannot hold you long.

In Islington there was a man,  
Of whom the world might say,  
That still a godly race he ran  
Whene'er he went to pray.

A kind and gentle heart he had,  
To comfort friends and foes;  
The naked every day he clad,  
When he put on his clothes.

And in that town a dog was found,  
As many dogs there be,  
Both mongrel, puppy, whelp, and hound,  
And curs of low degree.

This dog and man at first were friends;  
But when a pique began,  
The dog, to gain his private ends,  
Went mad, and bit the man.

Around from all the neighbouring streets  
The wondering neighbours ran,

And swore the dog had lost his wits,  
To bite so good a man.

The wound it seem'd both sore and sad  
To every Christian eye:  
And while they swore the dog was mad,  
They swore the man would die.

But soon a wonder came to light,  
That show'd the rogues they lied,  
The man recover'd of the bite,  
The dog it was that died.

### **EDWIN AND ANGELINA**

'TURN, gentle hermit of the dale,  
And guide my lonely way,  
To where yon taper cheers the vale  
With hospitable ray.

'For here forlorn and lost I tread,  
With fainting steps and slow;  
Where wilds immeasurably spread,  
Seem lengthening as I go.'

'Forbear, my son,' the hermit cries,  
'To tempt the dangerous gloom;  
For yonder phantom only flies  
To lure thee to thy doom.

'Here, to the houseless child of want,  
My door is open still:



And though my portion is but scant,  
I give it with goodwill.

'Then turn to-night, and freely share  
Whate'er my cell bestows;  
My rushy couch and frugal fare,  
My blessing and repose.

'No flocks that range the valley free,  
To slaughter I condemn;  
Taught by that power that pities me,  
I learn to pity them.

But from the mountain's grassy side,  
A guiltless feast I bring;  
A script, with herbs and fruits supplied,  
And water from the spring.

Then, Pilgrim, turn, thy cares forego;  
All earth-born cares are wrong:  
Man wants but little here below,  
Nor wants that little long.'

Soft as the dew from heaven descends,  
His gentle accents fell;  
The modest stranger lowly bends,  
And follows to the cell.

Far in a wilderness obscure,  
The lonely mansion lay;  
A refuge to the neighbouring poor,  
And strangers led astray.

No stores beneath its humble thatch  
Required a master's care;  
The wicket, opening with a latch,  
Received the harmless pair.

And now, when busy crowds retire,  
To take their evening rest,  
The hermit trimmed his little fire,  
And cheered his pensive guest;

And spread his vegetable store,  
And gaily pressed and smiled;  
And, skilled in legendary lore,  
The lingering hours beguiled.

Around, in sympathetic mirth,  
Its tricks the kitten tries;  
The cricket chirrups in the hearth,  
The crackling fagot flies.

But nothing could a charm impart,  
To soothe the stranger's woe;  
For grief was heavy at his heart,  
And tears began to flow.

His rising cares the hermit spied,  
With answering care opprest:  
'And whence, unhappy youth,' he cried,  
'The sorrows of thy breast?

'From better habitations spurned,  
Reluctant dost thou rove?

Or grieve for friendship unreturned,  
Or unregarded love?

'Alas! the joys that fortune brings  
Are trifling, and decay;  
And those who prize the paltry things  
More trifling still than they.

'And what is friendship but a name:  
A charm that lulls to sleep!  
A shade that follows wealth or fame,  
And leaves the wretch to weep!

'And love is still an emptier sound,  
The modern fair-one's jest;  
On earth unseen, or only found  
To warm the turtle's nest.

'For shame, fond youth, thy sorrows hush,  
And spurn the sex,' he said:  
But while he spoke, a rising blush  
His love-lorn guest betrayed.

Surprised he sees new beauties rise,  
Swift mantling to the view,  
Like colours o'er the morning skies,  
As bright, as transient too.

The bashful look, the rising breast,  
Alternate spread alarms;  
The lovely stranger stands confest  
A maid in all her charms.

'And ah! forgive a stranger rude,  
A wretch forlorn,' she cried,  
Whose feet unhallowed thus intrude  
Where heaven and you reside.

'But let a maid thy pity share,  
Whom love has taught to stray:  
Who seeks for rest, but finds despair  
Companion of her way.

'My father lived beside the Tyne,  
A wealthy lord was he;  
And all his wealth was marked as mine  
He had but only me.

'To win me from his tender arms,  
Unnumbered suitors came;  
Who praised me for imputed charms,  
And felt, or feigned, a flame.

Each hour a mercenary crowd  
With richest proffers strove;  
Amongst the rest young Edwin bowed,  
But never talked of love.

'In humblest, simplest habit clad,  
No wealth nor power had he;  
Wisdom and worth were all he had;  
But these were all to me.

'The blossom opening to the day,  
The dews of heaven refined,

Could nought of purity display,  
To emulate his mind.

'The dew, the blossoms of the tree,  
With charms inconstant shine;  
Their charms were his; but, woe to me,  
Their constancy was mine.

'For still I tried each fickle art,  
Importunate and vain;  
And while his passion touched my heart,  
I triumphed in his pain.

'Till quite dejected with my scorn,  
He left me to my pride;  
And sought a solitude forlorn,  
In secret, where he died!

'But mine the sorrow, mine the fault,  
And well my life shall pay:  
I'll seek the solitude he sought,  
And stretch me where he lay.

'And there, forlorn, despairing, hid,  
I'll lay me down and die:  
'Twas so for me that Edwin did,  
And so for him will I.'

Forbid it, Heaven!' the hermit cried,  
And clasped her to his breast:  
The wondering fair one turned to chide  
'Twas Edwin's self that prest!

'Turn, Angelina, ever dear,  
My charmer, turn to see  
Thy own, thy long-lost Edwin here,  
Restored to love and thee.

Thus let me hold thee to my heart,  
And every care resign;  
And shall we never, never part,  
My life—my all that's mine?

'No, never from this hour to part,  
We'll live and love so true;  
The sigh that rends thy constant heart,  
Shall break thy Edwin's too.'

*LADY ANNE BARNARD*

### **AULD ROBIN GRAY**

WHEN the sheep are in the fauld, when the kye's come hame,  
And a' the weary warld to rest are gane,  
The waes o' my heart fa' in showers frae my e'e,  
Unkent by my gudeman, wha sleeps sound by me.

Young Jamie lo'ed me weel, and sought me for his bride,  
But saving ae crown-piece he had naething beside;  
To make the crown a pound my Jamie gaed to sea,  
And the crown and the pound—they were baith for me.

He hadna been gane a twelvemonth and a day,  
When my father brake his arm and the cow was stown away;  
My mither she fell sick—my Jamie was at sea,  
And Auld Robin Gray came a courting me.

My father couldna work—my mither couldna spin—  
I toiled day and night, but their bread I couldna win;  
Auld Rob maintained them baith, and, wi' tears in his e'e,  
Said: 'Jeanie, O for their sakes, will ye no marry me?'

My heart it said na, and I looked for Jamie back,  
But hard blew the winds, and his ship was a wrack,  
His ship was a wrack—why didna Jamie die,  
Or why am I spared to cry wae is me?

My father urged me sair—my mither didna speak,  
But she looked in my face till my heart was like to break;  
They gied him my hand—my heart was in the sea—  
And so Robin Gray he was gudeman to me.

I hadna been his wife a week but only four,  
When, mournfu' as I sat on the stane at my door,  
I saw my Jamie's ghaist, for I couldna think it he  
Till he said: 'I'm come hame, love, to marry thee!'

Oh, sair sair did we greet, and mickle say of a',  
I gied him ae kiss, and bade him gang awa'—  
I wish that I were dead, but I'm na like to die,  
For, though my heart is broken, I'm but young, wae is me!

I gang like a ghaist, and I carena much to spin,  
I darena think o' Jamie, for that wad be a sin,

But I'll do my best a gude wife to be,  
For, oh! Robin Gray, he is kind to me.

*ALEXANDER ROSS*

**WOO'D, AND MARRIED, AND A'.**

THE bride cam' out o' the byre,  
And, oh, as she dighted her cheeks:  
'Sirs, I'm to be married the night,  
And have neither blankets nor sheets;

Have neither blankets nor sheets,  
Nor scarce a coverlet too;  
The bride that has a' thing to borrow,  
Has e'en right muckle ado.'  
Woo'd, and married, and a',  
Married, and woo'd, and a'!  
And was she nae very weel off,  
That was woo'd, and married, and a'?

Out spake the bride's father,  
As he cam' in frae the pleugh:  
'Oh, haud your tongue, my dochter,  
And ye'se get gear eneugh;  
The stirk stands i' the tether,  
And our braw bawsint yaud,  
Will carry ye hame your corn—  
What wad ye be at, ye jaud?'



Out spake the bride's mither:  
What deil needs a' this pride?  
I hadna a plack in my pouch  
That night I was a bride;  
My gown was linsey-woolsey,  
And ne'er a sark ava;  
And ye hae ribbons and buskins,  
Mae than ane or twa.'

Out spake the bride's brither,  
As he cam' in wi' the kye:  
'Poor Willie wad ne'er hae ta'en ye,  
Had he kent ye as weel as I;  
For ye're baith proud and saucy,  
And no for a poor man's wife;  
Gin I canna get a better,  
I'se ne'er tak ane i' my life.'

## *ANONYMOUS*

### **THE BRITISH GRENADIERS**

SOME talk of Alexander, and some of Hercules,  
Of Hector and Lysander, and such great names as these,  
But of all the world's great heroes, there's none that can compare,  
With a tow, row, row, row, row, row, to the British Grenadier!

Those heroes of antiquity ne'er saw a cannon ball,  
Or knew the force of powder to slay their foes withal;

But our brave boys do know it, and banish all their fears,  
Sing tow, row, row, row, row, row, for the British Grenadiers!

Whene'er we are commanded to storm the palisades,  
Our leaders march with fuses, and we with hand grenades,  
We throw them from the glacis, about the enemies' ears,  
Sing tow, row, row, row, row, row, the British Grenadiers!

And when the siege is over, we to the town repair,  
The townsmen cry, Hurrah, boys, here comes a Grenadier!  
Here come the Grenadiers, my boys, who know no doubts or fears!  
Then sing, tow, row, row, row, row, row, the British Grenadiers!

Then let us fill a bumper, and drink a health to those  
Who carry caps and pouches, and wear the loupéd clothes,  
May they and their commanders live happy all their years,  
With a tow, row, row, row, row, row, for the British Grenadiers!

## *ANONYMOUS*

### **HERE 'S TO THE MAIDEN**

HERE 's to the maiden of bashful fifteen;  
Now to the widow of fifty;  
Here's to the flaunting extravagant quean  
And here's to the housewife that 's thrifty.  
Let the toast pass,  
Drink to the lass,  
I'll warrant she'll prove  
An excuse for the glass.

Here's to the charmer whose dimples we prize,  
Now to the damsel with none, Sir,  
Here's to the girl with a pair of blue eyes,  
And now to the nymph with but one, Sir.

Here's to the maid with a bosom of snow,  
Now to her that's as brown as a berry,  
Here's to the wife with a face full of woe,  
And now to the damsel that's merry.

For let her be clumsy, or let her be slim,  
Young or ancient, I care not a feather,  
So fill up a bumper, nay, fill to the brim,  
And let us e'en toast 'em together,  
Let the toast pass,  
Drink to the lass,  
I'll warrant she'll prove  
An excuse for the glass.

*THOMAS CHATTERTON*

### **BRISTOW TRAGEDY**

THE feathered songster chanticleer  
Had wound his bugle-horn,  
And told the early villager  
The coming of the morn:

King Edward saw the ruddy streaks  
Of light eclipse the gray,

And heard the raven's croaking throat,  
Proclaim the fated day.

'Thou'rt right,' quoth he, for by the God  
That sits enthroned on high!  
Charles Bawdin, and his fellows twain,  
To-day shall surely die.'

Then with a jug of nappy ale  
His knights did on him wait;  
'Go tell the traitor, that to-day  
He leaves this mortal state.'

Sir Canterlone then bended low,  
With heart brimful of woe;  
He journeyed to the castle-gate,  
And to Sir Charles did go.

But when he came, his children twain,  
And eke his loving wife,  
With briny tears did wet the floor,  
For good Sir Charles's life.

'O good Sir Charles,' said Canterlone,  
'Bad tidings I do bring.'  
'Speak boldly, man,' said brave Sir Charles  
'What says the traitor-king?'

'I grieve to tell: before yon sun  
Does from the welkin fly,  
He hath upon his honour sworn,  
That thou shalt surely die.'

'We all must die,' said brave Sir Charles,  
Of that I'm not afraid;  
What boots to live a little space?  
Thank Jesus, I'm prepared.

'But tell thy king, for mine he's not,  
I'd sooner die to-day,  
Than live his slave, as many are,  
Though I should live for aye.'

Then Canterlone he did go out,  
To tell the mayor straight  
To get all things in readiness  
For good Sir Charles's fate.

Then Mr. Canynge sought the king,  
And fell down on his knee;  
'I'm come,' quoth he, unto your grace,  
To move your clemency.'

'Then,' quoth the king, your tale speak out,  
You have been much our friend:  
Whatever your request may be,  
We will to it attend.'

My noble liege, all my request  
Is for a noble knight,  
Who, though mayhap he has done wrong,  
He thought it still was right.

He has a spouse and children twain;  
All ruined are for aye,

If that you are resolved to let  
Charles Bawdin die to-day.'

'Speak not of such a traitor vile,'  
The king in fury said;  
'Before the evening-star doth shine,  
Bawdin shall lose his head:

'Justice does loudly for him call,  
And he shall have his meed:  
Speak, Mr. Canynge, what thing else  
At present do you need?'

'My noble liege,' good Canynge said,  
Leave justice to our God,  
And lay the iron rule aside;  
Be thine the olive rod.

'Was God to search our hearts and reins,  
The best were sinners great;  
Christ's vicar only knows no sin,  
In all this mortal state.

Let mercy rule thine infant reign,  
'Twill fix thy crown full sure;  
From race to race thy family  
All sovereigns shall endure.

But if with blood and slaughter thou  
Begin thy infant reign,  
Thy crown upon thy children's brows  
Will never long remain.'

'Canynge, away! this traitor vile  
Has scorned my power and me;  
How canst thou, then, for such a man  
Entreat my clemency?'

'My noble liege, the truly brave  
Will valorous actions prize:  
Respect a brave and noble mind,  
Although in enemies.'

'Canynge, away! By God in heaven  
That did me being give,  
I will not taste a bit of bread  
Whilst this Sir Charles doth live!

'By Mary, and all saints in heaven,  
This sun shall be his last!  
Then Canynge dropped a briny tear,  
And from the presence passed.

With heart brimful of gnawing grief,  
He to Sir Charles did go,  
And sat him down upon a stool,  
And tears began to flow.

'We all must die,' said brave Sir Charles;  
'What boots it how or when?  
Death is the sure, the certain fate,  
Of all we mortal men.

'Say why, my friend, thy honest soul  
Runs over at thine eye;

Is it for my most welcome doom  
That thou dost child-like cry?

Saith godly Canynge: 'I do weep,  
That thou so soon must die,  
And leave thy sons and helpless wife  
'Tis this that wets mine eye.'

'Then dry the tears that out thine eye  
From godly fountains spring;  
Death I despise, and all the power  
Of Edward, traitor-king.

'When through the tyrant's welcome means  
I shall resign my life,  
The God I serve will soon provide  
For both my sons and wife.

'Before I saw the lightsome sun,  
This was appointed me;  
Shall mortal man repine or grudge  
What God ordains to be?

'How oft in battle have I stood,  
When thousands died around;  
When smoking streams of crimson blood  
Imbrued the fattened ground?

'How did I know that every dart  
That cut the airy way,  
Might not find passage to my heart,  
And close mine eyes for aye?



'And shall I now, for fear of death,  
Look wan and be dismayed?  
No! from my heart fly childish fear;  
Be all the man displayed.

'Ah, godlike Henry, God forefend,  
And guard thee and thy son,  
If 'tis his will; but if 'tis not,  
Why, then his will be done.

'My honest friend, my fault has been  
To serve God and my prince;  
And that I no time-server am,  
My death will soon convince.

'In London city was I born,  
Of parents of great note;  
My father did a noble arms  
Emblazon on his coat:

'I make no doubt but he is gone  
Where soon I hope to go,  
Where we for ever shall be blest,  
From out the reach of woe.

'He taught me justice and the laws  
With pity to unite;  
And eke he taught me how to know  
The wrong cause from the right:

'He taught me with a prudent hand  
To feed the hungry poor,

Nor let my servants drive away  
The hungry from my door:

'And none can say but all my life  
I have his word is kept;  
And summed the actions of the day  
Each night before I slept.

'I have a spouse, go ask of her  
If I defiled her bed?  
I have a king, and none can lay  
Black treason on my head.

'In Lent, and on the holy eve,  
From flesh I did refrain;  
Why should I then appear dismayed  
To leave this world of pain?

'No, hapless Henry, I rejoice  
I shall not see thy death;  
Most willingly in thy just cause  
Do I resign my breath.

'Oh, fickle people! ruined land!  
Thou wilt ken peace no more;  
While Richard's sons exalt themselves,  
Thy brooks with blood will flow.

'Say, were ye tired of godly peace,  
And godly Henry's reign,  
That you did chop your easy days  
For those of blood and pain?

'What though I on a sledge be drawn,  
And mangled by a hind,  
I do defy the traitor's power;  
He cannot harm my mind:

'What though, uphoisted on a pole,  
My limbs shall rot in air,  
And no rich monument of brass  
Charles Bawdin's name shall bear;

'Yet in the holy book above,  
Which time can't eat away,  
There with the servants of the Lord  
My name shall live for aye.

'Then welcome death, for life eterne  
I leave this mortal life:  
Farewell, vain world, and all that's dear,  
My sons and loving wife!

'Now death as welcome to me comes  
As e'er the month of May;  
Now would I even wish to live,  
With my dear wife to stay.

Saith Canynge 'Tis a goodly thing  
To be prepared to die;  
And from this world of pain and grief  
To God in heaven to fly.'

And now the bell began to toll,  
And clarions to sound;

Sir Charles he heard the horses' feet  
A-prancing on the ground.

And just before the officers,  
His loving wife came in,  
Weeping unfeigned tears of woe  
With loud and dismal din.

'Sweet Florence, now I pray forbear,  
In quiet let me die;  
Pray God that every Christian soul  
May look on death as I.

'Sweet Florence, why these briny tears?  
They wash my soul away,  
And almost make me wish for life,  
With thee, sweet dame, to stay.

"Tis but a journey I shall go  
Unto the land of bliss;  
Now, as a proof of husband's love  
Receive this holy kiss.'

Then Florence, faltering in her say,  
Trembling these words spoke:  
'Ah, cruel Edward! bloody king!  
My heart is well-nigh broke.

'Ah, sweet Sir Charles, why wilt thou go  
Without thy loving wife?  
The cruel axe that cuts thy neck,'  
It eke shall end my life.'

And now the officers came in  
To bring Sir Charles away,  
Who turned to his loving wife,  
And thus to her did say:

'I go to life, and not to death;  
Trust thou in God above,  
And teach thy sons to fear the Lord,  
And in their hearts Him love.

'Teach them to run the noble race  
That I their father run.  
Florence, should death thee take—adieu!  
Ye officers, lead on.'

Then Florence raved as any mad,  
And did her tresses tear;  
'O stay, my husband, lord, and life!'  
Sir Charles then dropped a tear.

Till tired out with raving loud,  
She fell upon the floor;  
Sir Charles exerted all his might,  
And marched from out the door.

Upon a sledge he mounted then,  
With looks full brave and sweet;  
Looks that enshone no more concern  
Than any in the street.

Before him went the council-men,  
In scarlet robes and gold,

And tassels spangling in the sun,  
Much glorious to behold:

The friars of Saint Augustine next  
Appeared to the sight,  
All clad in homely russet weeds,  
Of godly monkish plight:

In different parts a godly psalm  
Most sweetly they did chant;  
Behind their back six minstrels came,  
Who tuned the strange bataunt.

Then five-and-twenty archers came;  
Each one the bow did bend,  
From rescue of King Henry's friends  
Sir Charles for to defend.

Bold as a lion came Sir Charles,  
Drawn on a cloth-laid sledde,  
By two black steeds in trappings white,  
With plumes upon their head.

Behind him five-and-twenty more  
Of archers strong and stout,  
With bended bow each one in hand,  
Marched in goodly rout.

Saint James's friars marched next,  
Each one his part did chant;  
Behind their backs six minstrels came,  
Who tuned the strange bataunt.

Then came the mayor and aldermen,  
In cloth of scarlet decked;  
And their attending men each one,  
Like eastern princes tricked.

And after them a multitude  
Of citizens did throng;  
The windows were all full of heads,  
As he did pass along.

And when he came to the high cross,  
Sir Charles did turn and say:  
O Thou that savest man from sin,  
Wash my soul clean this day.'

At the great minster window sat  
The king in mickle state,  
To see Charles Bawdin go along  
To his most welcome fate.

Soon as the sledde drew nigh enough,  
That Edward he might hear,  
The brave Sir Charles he did stand up,  
And thus his words declare:

'Thou seest me, Edward! traitor vile!  
Exposed to infamy;  
But be assured, disloyal man,  
I'm greater now than thee.

By foul proceedings, murder, blood,  
Thou wearest now a crown;

And hast appointed me to die  
By power not thine own.

'Thou thinkest I shall die to-day;  
I have been dead till now,  
And soon shall live to wear a crown  
For aye upon my brow;

'Whilst thou, perhaps, for some few years,  
Shalt rule this fickle land,  
To let them know how wide the rule  
'Twixt king and tyrant hand.

'Thy power unjust, thou traitor slave!  
Shall fall on thy own head'—  
From out of hearing of the king  
Departed then the sledde.

King Edward's soul rushed to his face,  
He turned his head away,  
And to his brother Gloucester  
He thus did speak and say:

'To him that so-much-dreaded death  
No ghastly terrors bring;  
Behold the man! he spake the truth;  
He's greater than a king!'

'So let him die!' Duke Richard said;  
'And may each one our foes  
Bend down their necks to bloody axe,  
And feed the carrion crows.'



And now the horses gently drew  
Sir Charles up the high hill;  
The axe did glister in the sun,  
His precious blood to spill.

Sir Charles did up the scaffold go,  
As up a gilded car  
Of victory, by valorous chiefs  
Gained in the bloody war.

And to the people he did say:  
'Behold you see me die,  
For serving loyally my king,  
My king most rightfully.

'As long as Edward rules this land,  
No quiet you will know;  
Your sons and husbands shall be slain,  
And brooks with blood shall flow.

'You leave your good and lawful king  
When in adversity;  
Like me, unto the true cause stick,  
And for the true cause die.'

Then he, with priests, upon his knees,  
A prayer to God did make,  
Beseeching Him unto Himself  
His parting soul to take.

Then, kneeling down, he laid his head  
Most seemly on the block;

Which from his body fair at once  
The able headsman stroke:

And out the blood began to flow,  
And round the scaffold twine;  
And tears, enough to wash't away,  
Did flow from each man's eyne.

The bloody axe his body fair  
Into four partis cut;  
And every part, and eke his head,  
Upon a pole was put.

One part did rot on Kinwulph-hill,  
One on the minster-tower,  
And one from off the castle-gate  
The crowen did devour.

The other on Saint Paul's good gate,  
A dreary spectacle;  
His head was placed on the high cross,  
In high street most noble.

Thus was the end of Bawdin's fate:  
God prosper long our king,  
And grant he may, with Bawdin's soul,  
In heaven God s mercy sing!

## **MINSTREL'S SONG IN ELLA**

OH, sing unto my roundelay;  
Oh, drop the briny tear with me;

Dance no more at holiday,  
Like a running river be;  
My love is dead,  
Gone to his death-bed,  
All under the willow-tree.

Black his hair as the winter night,  
White his neck as summer snow,  
Ruddy his face as the morning light,  
Cold he lies in the grave below:  
My love is dead,  
Gone to his death-bed,  
All under the willow-tree.

Sweet his tongue as throstle's note,  
Quick in dance as thought was he;  
Deft his tabor, cudgel stout;  
Oh! he lies by the willow-tree.  
My love is dead,  
Gone to his death-bed,  
All under the willow-tree.

Hark! the raven flaps his wing,  
In the briered dell below;  
Hark! the death-owl loud doth sing,  
To the nightmares as they go.  
My love is dead,  
Gone to his death-bed,  
All under the willow-tree.

See! the white moon shines on high;  
Whiter is my true-love's shroud;

Whiter than the morning sky,  
Whiter than the evening cloud.  
My love is dead,  
Gone to his death-bed,  
All under the willow-tree.

Here, upon my true-love's grave,  
Shall the garish flowers be laid,  
Nor one holy saint to save  
All the sorrows of a maid.  
My love is dead,  
Gone to his death-bed,  
All under the willow-tree.

With my hands I'll bind the briers,  
Round his holy corse to gre;  
Elfin-fairy, light your fires,  
Here my body still shall be.  
My love is dead,  
Gone to his death-bed,  
All under the willow-tree.

Come with acorn cup and thorn,  
Drain my heart's blood all away;  
Life and all its good I scorn,  
Dance by night, or feast by day,  
My love is dead,  
Gone to his death-bed,  
All under the willow-tree.

Water-witches, crowned with reytes,  
Bear me to your deadly tide.

I die—I come—my true-love waits.  
Thus the damsel spake, and died.

*WILLIAM BLAKE*

### **THE PIPER**

PIPING down the valleys wild,  
Piping songs of pleasant glee,  
On a cloud I saw a child,  
And he, laughing, said to me,

'Pipe a song about a lamb,'  
So I piped with merry cheer;  
Piper, pipe that song again,'  
So I piped: he wept to hear.

Drop thy pipe, thy happy pipe,  
Sing thy songs of happy cheer.'  
So I sang the same again,  
While he wept with joy to hear.

'Piper, sit thee down and write  
In a book that all may read.'  
So he vanish'd from my sight:  
And I pluck'd a hollow reed,

And I made a rural pen,  
And I stain'd the water clear,

And I wrote my happy songs  
Every child may joy to hear.

## **THE TIGER**

TIGER, tiger, burning bright  
In the forests of the night,  
What immortal hand or eye  
Could frame thy fearful symmetry?

In what distant deeps or skies  
Burnt the ardour of thine eyes?  
On what wings dare he aspire—  
What the hand dare seize the fire?

And what shoulder, and what art  
Could twist the sinews of thy heart?  
And when thy heart began to beat,  
What dread hand form'd thy dread feet?

What the hammer, what the chain,  
In what furnace was thy brain?  
Did God smile his work to see?  
Did He who made the lamb make thee?

*ROBERT BURNS*

**SCOTS WHA HAE**

SCOTS, wha hae wi' Wallace bled,  
Scots, wham Bruce has aften led;  
Welcome to your gory bed,  
Or to victorie!

Now's the day, and now's the hour;  
See the front of battle lour;  
See approach proud Edward's power—  
Chains and slaverie!

Wha will be a traitor knave?  
Wha can fill a coward's grave?  
Wha sae base as be a slave?  
Let him turn and flee!

Wha for Scotland's King and Law  
Freedom's sword will strongly draw,  
Free-man stand, or free-man fa'?  
Let him follow me!

By Oppression's woes and pains!  
By your sons in servile chains!  
We will drain our dearest veins,  
But they shall be free!

Lay the proud usurpers low!  
Tyrants fall in every foe!  
Liberty's in every blow!  
Let us do, or die!

**FOR A' THAT**

IS there, for honest poverty,  
That hings his head, and a' that;  
The coward-slave, we pass him by,  
We dare be poor for a' that!  
For a' that, and a' that;  
Our toils obscure, and a' that;  
The rank is but the guinea's stamp:  
The man's the gowd for a' that.

What tho' on hamely fare we dine,  
Wear hoddin grey, and a' that;  
Gie fools their silks, and knaves their wine,  
A man's a man for a' that.  
For a' that, and a' that,  
Their tinsel show, and a' that;  
The honest man, tho' e'er sae poor,  
Is king o' men for a' that.

Ye see yon birkie, ca'd a lord,'  
Wha struts, and stares, and a' that;  
Tho' hundreds worship at his word,  
He's but a coof for a' that:  
For a' that, and a' that,  
His riband, star, an' a' that,  
The man of independent mind,  
He looks and laughs at a' that.

A prince can mak' a belted knight,  
A marquis, duke, an' a' that;  
But an honest man's aboon his might,  
Guid faith he mauna fa' that!



For a' that, an' a' that,  
Their dignities, and a' that,  
The pith o' sense an' pride o' worth,  
Are higher rank than a' that.

Then let us pray that come it may,  
As come it will for a' that;  
That sense and worth, o'er a' the earth,  
May bear the gree, an' a' that.  
For a' that, and a' that,  
It's comin' yet, for a' that,  
That man to man, the warld o'er,  
Shall brothers be for a' that.

### **A RED, RED ROSE**

O, MY luve 's like a red, red rose,  
That's newly sprung in June:  
O, my luve's like the melodie  
That's sweetly play'd in tune.

As fair art thou, my bonie lass,  
So deep in luve am I:  
And I will luve thee still, my dear,  
Till a' the seas gang dry.

Till a' the seas gang dry, my dear,  
And the rocks melt wi' the sun:  
I will luve thee still, my dear,  
While the sands o' life shall run.

And fare thee weel, my only luve,  
And fare thee weel awhile!  
And I will come again, my luve  
Tho' it were ten thousand mile!

### **COMIN' THRO' THE RYE**

O, JENNY'S a' weel, poor body,  
Jenny's seldom dry;  
She draigl't a' her petticoatie,  
Comin' thro' the rye.

Comin' thro' the rye, poor body,  
Comin' thro' the rye,  
She draigl't a' her petticoatie,  
Comin' thro' the rye!

Gin a body meet a body—  
Comin' thro' the rye;  
Gin a body kiss a body—  
Need a body cry?

Gin a body meet a body  
Comin' thro' the glen,  
Gin a body kiss a body  
Need the warld ken?

Jenny 's a' weel, poor body;  
Jenny 's seldom dry;  
She draigl't a' her petticoatie,  
Comin' thro' the rye.

## **PHILLIS THE FAIR**

WHILE larks with little wing  
Fann'd the pure air,  
Tasting the breathing spring,  
Forth I did fare:  
Gay the sun's golden eye  
Peep'd o'er the mountains high;  
'Such thy morn,' did I cry,  
'Phillis the fair!'

In each bird's careless song  
Glad did I share;  
While yon wild flowers among,  
Chance led me there:  
Sweet to the opening day,  
Rosebuds bent the dewy spray;  
'Such thy bloom,' did I say,  
'Phillis the fair!'

Down in a shady walk,  
Doves cooing were,  
I mark'd the cruel hawk  
Caught in a snare;  
So kind may Fortune be,  
Such make his destiny,  
He who would injure thee,  
Phillis the fair!

## **AE FOND KISS**

AE fond kiss, and then we sever;  
Ae fareweel, alas! for ever!  
Deep in heart-wrung tears I'll pledge thee,  
Warring sighs and groans I'll wage thee.  
Who shall say that fortune grieves him,  
While the star of hope she leaves him?  
Me, nae cheerfu' twinkle lights me;  
Dark despair around benights me.

I'll ne'er blame my partial fancy,  
Naething could resist my Nancy;  
But to see her was to love her;  
Love but her, and love for ever.  
Had we never loved sae kindly,  
Had we never loved sae blindly,  
Never met—or never parted,  
We had ne'er been broken-hearted.

Fare-thee-weel, thou first and fairest!  
Fare-thee-weel, thou best and dearest!  
Thine be ilka joy and treasure,  
Peace, enjoyment, love, and pleasure!  
Ae fond kiss, and then we sever;  
Ae fareweel, alas! for ever!  
Deep in heart-wrung tears I'll pledge thee,  
Warring sighs and groans I'll wage thee!

### **MY BONNY MARY**

GO fetch to me a pint o' wine,  
And fill it in a silver tassie;

That I may drink, before I go,  
A service to my bonny lassie;  
The boat rocks at the pier o' Leith,  
Fu' loud the wind blows frae the Ferry;  
The ship rides by the Berwick law,  
And I maun leave my bonny Mary.

The trumpets sound, the banners fly,  
The glittering spears are ranked ready;  
The shouts o' war are heard afar,  
The battle closes thick and bloody;  
But it's not the roar o' sea or shore  
Wad make me langer wish to tarry;  
Nor shouts o' war that's heard afar  
It's leaving thee, my bonny Mary.

## **AFTON WATER**

FLOW gently, sweet Afton, among thy green braes,  
Flow gently, I'll sing thee a song in thy praise;  
My Mary's asleep by thy murmuring stream,  
Flow gently, sweet Afton, disturb not her dream.

Thou stock-dove whose echo resounds thro' the glen,  
Ye wild whistling blackbirds in yon thorny den,  
Thou green-crested lapwing, thy screaming forbear,  
I charge you disturb not my slumbering fair.

How lofty, sweet Afton, thy neighbouring hills,  
Far mark'd with the courses of clear, winding rills;

There daily I wander as noon rises high,  
My flocks and my Mary's sweet cot in my eye.

How pleasant thy banks and green valleys below,  
Where wild in the woodlands the primroses blow;  
There oft as mild ev'ning weeps over the lea,  
The sweet-scented birk shades my Mary and me.

Thy crystal stream, Afton, how lovely it glides,  
And winds by the cot where my Mary resides;  
How wanton thy waters her snowy feet lave,  
As gathering sweet flow'rets she stems thy clear wave.

Flow gently, sweet Afton, among thy green braes,  
Flow gently, sweet river, the theme of my lays;  
My Mary 's asleep by thy murmuring stream,  
Flow gently, sweet Afton, disturb not her dream.

### **FOR THE SAKE OF SOMEBODY**

MY heart is sair, I daurna tell,  
My heart is sair for Somebody;  
I could wake a winter night,  
For the sake o' Somebody!  
Oh-hon! for Somebody!  
Oh-hey! for Somebody!  
I could range the world around,  
For the sake o' Somebody.

Ye powers that smile on virtuous love,  
O, sweetly smile on Somebody!

Frae ilka danger keep him free,  
And send me safe my Somebody.  
Oh-hon! for Somebody!  
Oh-hey! for Somebody!  
I wad do—what wad I not?  
For the sake o' Somebody!

### **WHISTLE, AND I 'LL COME TO YE, MY LAD**

O WHISTLE, and I'll come to ye, my lad;  
O whistle, and I'll come to ye, my lad:  
Tho' father and mither and a' should gae mad,  
O whistle, and I'll come to ye, my lad.

But warily tent, when ye come to court me,  
And come na unless the back-yett be a-jee;  
Syne up the back-stile, and let naebody see,  
And come as ye were na comin' to me.

At kirk, or at market, whene'er ye meet me,  
Gang by me as tho' that ye car'd na a flie  
But steal me a blink o' your bonie black ee,  
Yet look as ye were na lookin' at me.

Aye vow and protest that ye care na for me,  
And whiles ye may lightly my beauty a wee;  
But court na anither, tho jokin' ye be,  
For fear that she wyle your fancy frae me.

O whistle, and I'll come to ye, my lad;  
O whistle, and I 'll come to ye, my lad:

Tho' father and mither and a' should gae mad,  
O whistle, and I'll come to ye, my lad.

### **THE DE'IL'S AWA' WI' THE EXCISEMAN**

THE De'il cam fiddling thro' the town,  
And danc'd awa wi' the Exciseman;  
And ilka wife cry'd 'Auld Mahoun,  
We wish you luck o' your prize, man.

'We'll mak our maut, and brew our drink,  
We'll dance, and sing, and rejoice, man;  
And monie thanks to the muckle black De'il  
That danc'd awa wi' the Exciseman.

'There's threesome reels, and foursome reels,  
There's hornpipes and strathspeys, man;  
But the ae best dance that cam to our lan',  
Was—the De'il 's awa wi' the Exciseman.

We'll mak our maut, and brew our drink,  
We'll dance, and sing, and rejoice, man;  
And monie thanks to the muckle black De'il  
That danc'd awa wi' the Exciseman.'

### **LASSIE WI' THE LINT-WHITE LOCKS**

LASSIE wi' the lint-white locks,  
Bonie lassie, artless lassie,  
Wilt thou wi' me tent the flocks?  
Wilt thou be my dearie O?



Now nature cleeds the flowery lea,  
And a' is young and sweet like thee;  
O wilt thou share its joys wi' me,  
And say thou'lt be my dearie O?

Lassie wi' the lint-white locks . . .

And when the welcome simmer-shower  
Has cheer'd ilk drooping little flower,  
We'll to the breathing woodbine bower  
At sultry noon, my dearie O.  
Lassie wi' the lint-white locks . . .

When Cynthia lights, wi' silver ray,  
The weary shearer's hameward way,  
Thro' yellow waving fields we'll stray,  
And talk o' love, my dearie O.  
Lassie wi' the lint-white locks . . .

And when the howling wintry blast  
Disturbs my lassie's midnight rest;  
Enclasped to my faithfu' breast,  
I'll comfort thee, my dearie O.  
Lassie wi' the lint-white locks,  
Bonie lassie, artless lassie,  
Wilt thou wi' me tent the flocks?  
Wilt thou be my dearie O?

**I LOVE MY JEAN**

OF a' the airts the wind can blaw,  
I dearly like the west,  
For there the bonie lassie lives,  
The lassie I lo'e best:

There wild woods grow, and rivers row,  
And monie a hill between;  
But day and night my fancy's flight  
Is ever wi' my Jean.

I see her in the dewy flowers,  
I see her sweet and fair:  
I hear her in the tunefu' birds,  
I hear her charm the air:

There's not a bonie flower that springs  
By fountain, shaw, or green;  
There's not a bonie bird that sings,  
But, minds me o' my Jean.

### **THE HAPPY TRIO**

O, WILLIE brew'd a peck o' maut,  
And Rob and Allan cam to pree;  
Three blither hearts that lee-lang night,  
Ye wad na find in Christendie.

We are na fou, we're no that fou,  
But just a drappie in our ee:  
The cock may crawl, the day may daw,  
And aye we'll taste the barley bree.

Here are we met, three merry boys,  
Three merry boys, I trove, are we;  
And monie a night we've merry been,  
And monie mae we hope to be!

It is the moon, I ken her horn,  
That's blinkin' in the lift sae hie;  
She shines sae bright to wyle us hame,  
But by my sooth she'll wait a wee!

Wha first shall rise to gang awa,  
A cuckold, coward loun is he!  
Wha first beside his chair shall fa',  
He is the King amang us three!  
We are na fou, we're no that fou,  
But just a drappie in our ee:  
The cock may crawl, the day may daw,  
And aye we'll taste the barley bree.

### **JOHN ANDERSON MY JO**

JOHN ANDERSON my jo, John,  
When we were first acquent,  
Your locks were like the raven,  
Your bonie brow was brent;  
But now your brow is beld, John,  
Your locks are like the snaw;  
But blessings on your frosty pow,  
John Anderson my jo.

John Anderson my jo, John  
We clamb the hill thegither;  
And monie a canty day, John,  
We've had wi' ane anither:  
Now we maun totter down, John,  
But hand in hand we'll go,  
And sleep thegither at the foot,  
John Anderson my jo.

### **MY WIFE'S A WINSOME WEE THING**

SHE is a winsome wee thing,  
She is a handsome wee thing,  
She is a bonie wee thing,  
This sweet wee wife o' mine.

I never saw a fairer,  
I never lo'ed a dearer,  
And neist my heart I'll wear her,  
For fear my jewel tine.

She is a winsome wee thing,  
She is a handsome wee thing,  
She is a bonie wee thing,  
This sweet wee wife o' mine.

The world's wrack, we share o't,  
The warstle and the care o't;  
Wi' her I'll blythely bear it,  
And think my lot divine.

## DUNCAN GRAY

DUNCAN GRAY came here to woo,  
Ha, ha, the wooing o't,  
On blithe yule night when we were fou,  
Ha, ha, the wooing o't.  
Maggie coost her head fu' high,  
Look'd asklent and unco skeigh,  
Gart poor Duncan stand abeigh;  
Ha, ha, the wooing o't.

Duncan fleech'd, and Duncan pray'd;  
Ha, ha, the wooing o't, Meg was deaf as Ailsa Craig,  
Ha, ha, the wooing o't.  
Duncan sigh'd baith out and in,  
Grat his een baith bleer't and blin',  
Spak o' lowpin o'er a linn;  
Ha, ha, the wooing o't.

Time and chance are but a tide,  
Ha, ha, the wooing o't,  
Slighted love is sair to bide,  
Ha, ha, the wooing o't.  
Shall I, like a fool, quoth he, For a haughty hizzie die?  
She may gae to—France for me!  
Ha, ha, the wooing o't.

How it comes let doctors tell,  
Ha, ha, the wooing o't,  
Meg grew sick—as he grew well,  
Ha, ha, the wooing o't.

Something in her bosom wrings,  
For relief a sigh she brings;  
And O, her een, they spak sic things!  
Ha, ha, the wooing o't.

Duncan was a lad o' grace,  
Ha, ha, the wooing o't,  
Maggie's was a piteous case,  
Ha, ha, the wooing o't.  
Duncan couldna be her death,  
Swelling pity smoor'd his wrath;  
Now they 're crouse and cantie baith!  
Ha, ha, the wooing o't.

### **MY AIN KIND DEARIE O**

WHEN o'er the hill the eastern star  
Tells bughtin-time is near, my jo;  
And owsen frae the furrow'd field  
Return sae dowf and wearie O;  
Down by the burn, where scented birks  
Wi' dew are hanging clear, my jo,  
I 'll meet thee on the lea-rig,  
My ain kind dearie O.

In mirkest glen, at midnight hour,  
I'd rove, and ne'er be eerie O,  
If thro' that glen I gaed to thee,  
My ain kind dearie O.  
Altho' the night were ne'er sae wild,  
And I were ne'er sae wearie O,

I'd meet thee on the lea-rig,  
My ain kind dearie O.

The hunter lo'es the morning sun,  
To rouse the mountain deer, my jo;  
At noon the fisher seeks the glen,  
Along the burn to steer, my jo;  
Gie me the hour o' gloamin' grey,  
It maks my heart sae cheery O,  
To meet thee on the lea-rig,  
My ain kind dearie O.

## **THE THORN**

FROM the white blossom'd sloe my dear Chloe requested  
A sprig her fair breast to adorn,  
From the white blossom'd sloe my dear Chloe requested,  
A sprig her fair breast to adorn.  
No! By heav'n! I exclaimed, may I perish,  
If ever I plant in that bosom a thorn!

When I show'd her a ring, and implor'd her to marry,  
She blushed like the dawning of morn,  
When I show'd her a ring, and implor'd her to marry,  
She blushed like the dawning of morn.  
Yes! I'll consent, she replied, if you promise,  
That no jealous rival shall laugh me to scorn.

## **JOHN BARLEYCORN**

THERE was three kings into the East,  
Three kings both great and high,  
And they hae sworn a solemn oath,  
John Barleycorn should die.

They took a plough and plough'd him down,  
Put clods upon his head,  
And they hae sworn a solemn oath,  
John Barleycorn was dead.

But the cheerful Spring came kindly on,  
And showers began to fall;  
John Barleycorn got up again,  
And sore surpris'd them all.

The sultry suns of Summer came,  
And he grew thick and strong,  
His head well-armed wi' pointed spears,  
That no one should him wrong.

The sober Autumn enter'd mild,  
When he grew wan and pale;  
His bending joints and drooping head  
Show'd he began to fail.

His colour sicken'd more and more,  
He faded into age;  
And then his enemies began  
To show their deadly rage.

They 've ta'en a weapon long and sharp,  
And cut him by the knee;



And tied him fast upon the cart,  
Like a rogue for forgerie.

They laid him down upon his back,  
And cudgell'd him full sore;  
They hung him up before the storm,  
And turn'd him o'er and o'er.

They filled up a darksome pit  
With water to the brim,  
They heaved in John Barleycorn,  
There let him sink or swim.

They laid him out upon the floor,  
To work him further woe,  
And still as signs of life appear'd,  
They toss'd him to and fro.

They wasted, o'er a scorching flame,  
The marrow of his bones;  
But a miller used him worst of all,  
For he crush'd him between two stones.

And they hae ta'en his very heart's blood,  
And drank it round and round;  
And still the more and more they drank,  
Their joy did more abound.

John Barleycorn was a hero bold,  
Of noble enterprise;  
For if you do but taste his blood,  
'Twill make your courage rise.

'Twill make a man forget his woe;  
'Twill heighten all his joy;  
'Twill make the widow's heart to sing,  
Tho' the tear were in her eye.

Then let us toast John Barleycorn,  
Each man a glass in hand;  
And may his great prosperity  
Ne'er fail in old Scotland!

*ANONYMOUS*

### **THE BANKS OF ALLAN WATER**

ON the banks of Allan Water,  
When the sweet spring time did fall,  
Was the miller's lovely daughter,  
Fairest of them all.  
For his bride a soldier sought her,  
And a winning tongue had he,  
On the banks of Allan Water,  
None so gay as she.

On the banks of Allan Water,  
When brown autumn spread his store,  
There I saw the miller's daughter,  
But she smiled no more.  
For the summer grief had brought her,  
And the soldier false was he,

On the banks of Allan Water,  
None so sad as she.

On the banks of Allan Water,  
When the winter snow fell fast,  
Still was seen the miller's daughter,  
Chilling blew the blast.  
But the miller's lovely daughter,  
Both from cold and care was free,  
On the banks of Allan Water,  
There a corse lay she.

*SAMUEL ROGERS*

### **DEAR IS MY LITTLE NATIVE VALE**

DEAR is my little native vale,  
The ring-dove builds and murmurs there;  
Close by my cot she tells her tale  
To every passing villager;  
The squirrel leaps from tree to tree,  
And shells his nuts at liberty.

In orange-groves and myrtle-bowers,  
That breathe a gale of fragrance round,  
I charm the fairy-footed hours  
With my loved lute's romantic sound;  
Or crowns of living laurel weave  
For those that win the race at eve.

The shepherd's horn at break of day,  
The ballet danced in twilight glade,  
The canzonet and roundelay  
Sung in the silent greenwood shade:  
These simple joys, that never fail,  
Shall bind me to my native vale.

### **A WISH**

MINE be a cot beside the hill;  
A bee-hive's hum shall soothe my ear;  
A willowy brook, that turns a mill,  
With many a fall, shall linger near.

The swallow oft, beneath my thatch,  
Shall twitter near her clay-built nest;  
Oft shall the pilgrim lift the latch,  
And share my meal, a welcome guest.

Around my ivied porch shall spring  
Each fragrant flower that drinks the dew;  
And Lucy, at her wheel, shall sing,  
In russet gown and apron blue.

The village church beneath the trees,  
Where first our marriage-vows were given,  
With merry peals shall swell the breeze,  
And point with taper spire to heaven.

*ROBERT BLOOMFIELD*

## THE FAKENHAM GHOST

THE lawns were dry in Euston park;  
(Here Truth inspires my tale)  
The lonely footpath, still and dark,  
Led over hill and dale.

Benighted was an ancient dame,  
And fearful haste she made  
To gain the vale of Fakenham  
And hail its willow shade.

Her footsteps knew no idle stops,  
But followed faster still,  
And echoed to the darksome copse  
That whispered on the hill;

Where clamorous rooks, yet scarcely hushed,  
Bespoke a peopled shade,  
And many a wing the foliage brushed,  
And hovering circuits made.

The dappled herd of grazing deer,  
That sought the shades by day,  
Now started from her path with fear,  
And gave the stranger way.

Darker it grew; and darker fears  
Came o'er her troubled mind—  
When now a short quick step she hears  
Come patting close behind.

She turned; it stopped; nought could she see  
Upon the gloomy plain!  
But as she strove the sprite to flee,  
She heard the same again.

Now terror seized her quaking frame,  
For, where the path was bare,  
The trotting Ghost kept on the same  
She muttered many a prayer.

Yet once again, amidst her fright,  
She tried what sight could do;  
When through the cheating glooms of night  
A monster stood in view.

Regardless of whate'er she felt,  
It followed down the plain!  
She owned her sins, and down she knelt  
And said her prayers again.

Then on she sped; and hope grew strong,  
The white park gate in view;  
Which pushing hard, so long it swung  
That Ghost and all passed through.

Loud fell the gate against the post!  
Her heart-strings like to crack;  
For much she feared the grisly Ghost  
Would leap upon her back.

Still on, pat, pat, the goblin went,  
As it had done before;

Her strength and resolution spent,  
She fainted at the door.

Out came her husband, much surprised,  
Out came her daughter dear;  
Good-natured souls! all unadvised  
Of what they had to fear.

The candle's gleam pierced through the night,  
Some short space o'er the green;  
And there the little trotting sprite  
Distinctly might be seen.

An ass's foal had lost its dam  
Within the spacious park;  
And simple as the playful lamb  
Had followed in the dark.

No goblin he; no imp of sin;  
No crimes had ever known;  
They took the shaggy stranger in,  
And reared him as their own.

His little hoofs would rattle round  
Upon the cottage floor;  
The matron learned to love the sound  
That frightened her before.

A favourite the Ghost became,  
And 'twas his fate to thrive;  
And long he lived and spread his fame,  
And kept the joke alive.

For many a laugh went through the vale;  
And some conviction too:  
Each thought some other goblin tale,  
Perhaps, was just as true.

## *ANONYMOUS*

### **THE KEEL ROW**

As I came thro' Sandgate,  
Thro' Sandgate, thro' Sandgate,  
As I came thro' Sandgate  
I heard a lassie sing,  
O weel may the keel row,  
The keel row, the keel row,  
O weel may the keel row,  
That my laddie's in.

O wha 's like my Johnny,  
Sae leith, sae blythe, sae bonny?  
He's foremost among the mony  
Keel lads o' coaly Tyne:  
He'll set and row so tightly,  
Or in the dance—so sprightly—  
He'll cut and shuffle sightly;  
'Tis true,—were he not mine.

He wears a blue bonnet,  
Blue bonnet, blue bonnet;



He wears a blue bonnet,  
And a dimple in his chin:  
And weel may the keel row,  
The keel row, the keel row;  
And weel may the keel row,  
That my laddie's in.

## **THE BLUE BELL OF SCOTLAND**

OH where, and oh where, is your Highland laddie gone?  
He's gone to fight the French for King George upon the throne;  
And it's oh, in my heart, how I wish him safe at home!

Oh where, and oh where, does your Highland laddie dwell?  
He dwells in merry Scotland, at the sign of the Blue Bell;  
And it's oh, in my heart, that I love my laddie well.

In what clothes, in what clothes is your Highland laddie clad?  
His bonnet's of the Saxon green, his waistcoat's of the plaid;  
And it's oh, in my heart, that I love my Highland lad.

Suppose, oh, suppose that your Highland lad should die?  
The bagpipes shall play over him, and I'll lay me down and cry;  
And it's oh, in my heart, I wish he may not die.

## ***LADY NAIRNE***

## **THE LAIRD O' COCKPEN**

THE Laird o' Cockpen he's proud an' he's great,  
His mind is ta'en up wi' the things o' the State;  
He wanted a wife his braw house to keep,  
But favour wi' wooin' was fashious to seek.

Doon by the dyke-side a lady did dwell,  
At his table-head he thocht she 'd look well;  
M'Cleish's ae dochter, o' Clavers-ha' Lee,  
A penniless lass wi' a lang pedigree.

His wig was weel pouter'd, as gude as when new;  
His waistcoat was white, his coat it was blue;  
He put on a ring, a sword, an' cocked hat,  
An' wha could refuse the Laird wi' a' that?

He took the grey mare, he rade cannilie,  
An' rapped at the yett o' Clavers-ha' Lee;  
'Gae tell Mistress Jean to come speedily ben,—  
She's wanted to speak wi' the Laird o' Cockpen.'

Mistress Jean she was makin' the elder-flow'r wine;  
'An' what brings the Laird at sic a like time?'  
She put aff her apron, an' on her silk goon,  
Her mutch wi' red ribbons, an' gaed awa doon.

An' when she cam' ben he bowed fu' low,  
An' what was his errand he soon let her know;  
Amazed was the Laird when the lady said Na!  
An' wi' a laigh curtsie she turned awa'!

Dumfounder'd was he, but nae sigh did he gi'e,  
He mounted his mare an' he rade cannilie;

An' often he thocht, as he gaed through the glen,  
'She's daft to refuse the Laird o' Cockpen!'

### **CALLER HERRIN'**

WHA'LL buy my caller herrin'?  
They're bonnie fish and halesome farin';  
Wha'll buy my caller herrin',  
New drawn frae the Forth?

When ye were sleepin' on your pillows,  
Dreamed ye aught o' our puir fellows,  
Darkling as they faced the billows,  
A' to fill the woven willows?  
Buy my caller herrin',  
New drawn frae the Forth.

Wha'll buy my caller herrin'?  
They 're no brought here without brave darin';  
Buy my caller herrin',  
Hauled thro' wind and rain.  
Wha'll buy my caller herrin'? . . .

Wha'll buy my caller herrin'?  
Oh, ye may ca' them vulgar farin';  
Wives and mithers, maist despairin',  
Ca' them lives o' men.  
Wha ll buy my caller herrin'? . . .

When the creel o' herrin' passes,  
Ladies, clad in silks and laces,

Gather in their braw pelisses,  
Cast their heads, and screw their faces.  
Wha'll buy my caller herrin'? . . .

Caller herrin's no got lightlie,  
Ye can trip the spring fu' tightlie;  
Spite o' tauntin', flauntin', flingin',  
Gow has set you a' a-singin'  
Wha'll buy my caller herrin'? . . .

Neebour wives, now tent my tellin',  
When the bonnie fish ye're sellin',  
At ae word be in yer dealin'—  
Truth will stand when a' thing's failin'.  
Wha'll buy my caller herrin'?  
They 're bonnie fish and halesome farin'  
Wha 'll buy my caller herrin',  
New drawn frae the Forth?

*CHARLES DIBDIN*

### **TOM BOWLING**

HERE, a sheer hulk, lies poor Tom Bowling,  
The darling of our crew;  
No more he'll hear the tempest howling,  
For death has broach'd him to.  
His form was of the manliest beauty,  
His heart was kind and soft,

Faithful, below, he did his duty  
But now he's gone aloft.

Tom never from his word departed,  
His virtues were so rare;  
His friends were many and true-hearted,  
His Poll was kind and fair:  
And then he'd sing so blithe and jolly,  
Ah, many 's the time and oft!  
But mirth is turned to melancholy,  
For Tom is gone aloft.

Yet shall poor Tom find pleasant weather,  
When He, who all commands,  
Shall give, to call life's crew together,  
The word to pipe all hands.  
Thus Death, who kings and tars despatches,  
In vain Tom's life has doff'd,  
For, though his body's under hatches,  
His soul has gone aloft.

## **BLOW HIGH, BLOW LOW**

BLOW high, blow low, let tempests tear  
The mainmast by the board;  
My heart with thoughts of thee, my dear,  
And love, well stored,  
Shall brave all danger, scorn all fear,  
The roaring winds, the raging sea,  
In hopes on shore

To be once more  
Safe moor'd with thee!

Aloft while mountains high we go,  
The whistling winds that scud along,  
And surges roaring from below,  
Shall my signal be,  
To think on thee,  
And this shall be my song:  
Blow high, blow low.

And on that night when all the crew  
The mem'ry of their former lives  
O'er flowing cans of flip renew,  
And drink their sweethearts and their wives,  
I'll heave a sigh, and think on thee;  
And, as the ship rolls through the sea,  
The burthen of my song shall be  
Blow high, blow low.

### **THE JOLLY YOUNG WATERMAN**

AND did you not hear of a jolly young Waterman,  
Who at Blackfriars Bridge us'd for to ply,  
And he feather'd his oars with such skill and dexterity,  
Winning each heart and delighting each eye.  
He look'd so neat and row'd so steadily,  
The maidens all flock'd to his boat so readily,  
And he eyed the young rogues with so charming an air,  
That this Waterman ne'er was in want of a fare.

What sights of fine folks he oft row'd in his wherry,  
'Twas cleaned out so nice and so painted withall,  
He always was first oars when the fine city ladies,  
In a party to Ranelagh went, or Vauxhall.  
And oft-times would they be giggling and leering,  
But 'twas all one to Tom their jibing and jeering,  
For loving or liking he little did care,  
For this Waterman ne'er was in want of a fare.

And yet but to see how strangely things happen,  
As he row'd along thinking of nothing at all,  
He was ply'd by a damsel so lovely and charming,  
That she smil'd, and so straightway in love he did fall.  
And would this young damsel e'en banish his sorrow,  
He'd wed her to-night, before even to-morrow,  
And how should this Waterman ever know care,  
When he's married and never in want of a fare?

# ***SAMUEL TAYLOR COLERIDGE***

## **THE RIME OF THE ANCIENT MARINER**

### **PART I**

[An ancient Mariner meeteth three Gallants bidden to a wedding-feast,  
and detaineth one.]

IT is an ancient Mariner,  
And he stoppeth one of three.  
'By thy long grey beard and glittering eye,  
Now wherefore stopp'st thou me?

'The Bridegroom's doors are opened wide,  
And I am next of kin;  
The guests are met, the feast is set:  
May'st hear the merry din.'

He holds him with his skinny hand,  
'There was a ship,' quoth he.  
Hold off! unhand me, grey-beard loon!  
Eftsoons his hand dropt he.



[The Wedding-Guest is spellbound by the eye of the old seafaring man,  
and constrained to hear his tale.]

He holds him with his glittering eye—  
The Wedding-Guest stood still,  
And listens like a three years' child:  
The Mariner hath his will.

The Wedding-Guest sat on a stone:  
He cannot choose but hear;  
And thus spake on that ancient man,  
The bright-eyed Mariner.

'The ship was cheered, the harbour cleared,  
Merrily did we drop  
Below the kirk, below the hill,  
Below the lighthouse top.

[The Mariner tells how the ship sailed southward with a good wind and  
fair weather, till it reached the Line.]

'The Sun came up upon the left,  
Out of the sea came he!  
And he shone bright, and on the right,  
Went down into the sea.

Higher and higher every day,  
Till over the mast at noon'—  
The Wedding-Guest here beat his breast,  
For he heard the loud bassoon.

[The Wedding-Guest heareth the bridal music; but the Mariner continueth his tale.]

The bride hath paced into the hall,  
Red as a rose is she;  
Nodding their heads before her goes  
The merry minstrelsy.

The Wedding-Guest he beat his breast,  
Yet he cannot choose but hear;  
And thus spake on that ancient man,  
The bright-eyed Mariner.

[The ship drawn by a storm toward the south pole.]

'And now the storm-blast came, and he  
Was tyrannous and strong:  
He struck with his o'ertaking wings,  
And chased us south along.

With sloping masts and dipping prow,  
As who pursued with yell and blow  
Still treads the shadow of his foe  
And forward bends his head,  
The ship drove fast, loud roared the blast,  
And southward aye we fled.

And now there came both mist and snow,  
And it grew wondrous cold:

And ice, mast-high, came floating by,  
As green as emerald.

[The land of ice, and of fearful sounds, where no living thing was to be seen.]

And through the drifts the snowy clifts  
Did send a dismal sheen:  
Nor shapes of men nor beasts we ken—  
The ice was all between.

The ice was here, the ice was there,  
The ice was all around:  
It cracked and growled, and roared and howled,  
Like noises in a swound!

[Till a great sea-bird, called the Albatross, came through the snow-fog,  
and was received with great joy and hospitality.]

At length did cross an Albatross:  
Thorough the fog it came;  
As if it had been a Christian soul,  
We hailed it in God's name.

It ate the food it ne'er had eat,  
And round and round it flew.  
The ice did split with a thunder-fit;  
The helmsman steered us through!

[And lo! the Albatross proveth a bird of good omen, and followeth the ship as it returned northward, through fog and floating ice.]

And a good south wind sprung up behind;  
The Albatross did follow,  
And every day, for food or play,  
Came to the mariners' hollo!

In mist or cloud, on mast or shroud,  
It perched for vespers nine;  
Whiles all the night, through fog-smoke white,  
Glimmered the white moon-shine.'

[The ancient Mariner inhospitably killeth the pious bird of good omen.]

'God save thee, ancient Mariner!  
From the fiends, that plague thee thus!—  
Why look'st thou so?'—'With my cross-bow  
I shot the Albatross!

## **PART II**

'THE Sun now rose upon the right:  
Out of the sea came he,  
Still hid in mist, and on the left  
Went down into the sea.

And the good south wind still blew behind,  
But no sweet bird did follow,

Nor any day, for food or play,  
Came to the mariners' hollo!

[His shipmates cry out against the ancient  
Mariner, for killing the bird of good luck.]

And I had done a hellish thing,  
And it would work 'em woe;  
For all averred, I had killed the bird  
That made the breeze to blow.  
"Ah wretch," said they, "the bird to slay,  
That made the breeze to blow!"

[But when the fog cleared off, they justify the same. and thus make  
themselves accomplices in the crime.]

Nor dim nor red, like God's own head,  
The glorious Sun uprist:  
Then all averred, I had killed the bird  
That brought the fog and mist.  
"'Twas right," said they, "such birds to slay,  
That bring the fog and mist."

[The fair breeze continues; the ship enters the Pacific Ocean and sails  
northward, even till it reaches the Line.]

The fair breeze blew the white foam flew,  
The furrow streamed off free:

We were the first that ever burst  
Into that silent sea.

[The ship hath been suddenly becalmed.]

Down dropt the breeze,  
the sails dropt down,  
'Twas sad as sad could be;  
And we did speak only to break  
The silence of the sea!

All in a hot and copper sky,  
The bloody Sun, at noon,  
Right up above the mast did stand,  
No bigger than the Moon.

Day after day, day after day,  
We stuck, nor breath nor motion;  
As idle as a painted ship  
Upon a painted ocean.

[And the Albatross begins to be avenged.]

Water, water, everywhere,  
And all the boards did shrink;  
Water, water, everywhere,  
Nor any drop to drink.

The very deep did rot: O Christ  
That ever this should be!

Yea, slimy things did crawl with legs  
Upon the slimy sea.

About, about, in reel and rout  
The death-fires danced at night;  
The water, like a witch's oils,  
Burnt green, and blue, and white.

[A spirit had followed them: one of the invisible inhabitants of this planet, neither departed souls nor angels; concerning whom the learned Jew, Josephus, and the Platonic Constantinopolitan, Michael Psellus, may be consulted. They are very numerous, and there is no climate or element without one or more.]

And some in dreams assured were  
Of the spirit that plagued us so:  
Nine fathom deep he had followed us  
From the land of mist and snow.

And every tongue, through utter drought,  
Was withered at the root;  
We could not speak, no more than if  
We had been choked with soot.

[The shipmates, in their sore distress, would fain throw the whole guilt on the ancient Mariner: in sign whereof they hang the dead sea-bird round his neck.]

Ah! well a-day! what evil looks  
Had I from old and young!  
Instead of the cross, the Albatross  
About my neck was hung.

### **PART III**

[The ancient Mariner beholdeth a sign in the element afar off.]

'HERE passed a weary time. Each throat  
Was parched, and glazed each eye.  
A weary time! a weary time!  
How glazed each weary eye!  
When looking westward I beheld  
A something in the sky.

At first it seemed a little speck,  
And then it seemed a mist:  
It moved and moved, and took at last  
A certain shape, I wist.

A speck, a mist, a shape, I wist!  
And still it neared and neared:  
As if it dodged a water-sprite,  
It plunged and tacked and veered.

[At its nearer approach, it seemeth him to be a ship; and at a dear ransom  
he freeth his speech from the bonds of thirst.]



With throats unslaked, with black lips baked,  
We could nor laugh nor wail;  
Through utter drought all dumb we stood!  
I bit my arm, I sucked the blood,  
And cried, "A sail! a sail!"

[A flash of joy.]

With throats unslaked, with black lips baked,  
Agape they heard me call:  
Gramercy! they for joy did grin,  
And all at once their breath drew in,  
As they were drinking all.

[And horror follows. For can it be a *ship* that comes onward without wind or tide?]

"See! see!" (I cried) "she tacks no more!  
Hither to work us weal;  
Without a breeze, without a tide,  
She steadies with upright keel!"

The western wave was all a-flame,  
The day was well nigh done!  
Almost upon the western wave  
Rested the broad bright Sun;  
When that strange shape drove suddenly  
Betwixt us and the Sun.

[It seemeth him but the skeleton of a ship.]

And straight the Sun was flecked with bars,  
(Heaven's Mother send us grace!)  
As if through a dungeon grate he peered,  
With broad and burning face.

"Alas!" (thought I, and my heart beat loud)  
"How fast she nears and nears!  
Are those her sails that glance in the Sun,  
Like restless gossameres?"

[And its ribs are seen as bars on the face of the setting Sun. The spectre-  
woman and her death-mate, and no other on board the skeleton ship. Like  
vessel, like crew!]

'Are those her ribs through which the Sun  
Did peer, as through a grate?  
And is that Woman all her crew?  
Is that a DEATH? and are there two?  
Is DEATH that woman's mate?"

Her lips were red, her looks were free,  
Her locks were yellow as gold:  
Her skin was as white as leprosy,  
The night-mare LIFE-IN-DEATH was she,  
Who thicks man's blood with cold.

[Death and Life-in-Death have diced for the ship's crew, and she (the latter) winneth the ancient Mariner.]

The naked hulk alongside came,  
And the twain were casting dice;  
"The game is done! I 'ye won, I've won!"  
Quoth she, and whistles thrice.

The Sun's rim dips; the stars rush out:  
At one stride comes the dark;  
With far-heard whisper, o'er the sea,  
Off shot the spectre-bark.

We listened and looked sideways up!  
Fear at my heart, as at a cup,  
My life-blood seemed to sip!  
The stars were dim, and thick the night,  
The steersman's face by his lamp gleamed white;  
From the sails the dew did drip—  
Till clomb above the eastern bar  
The horned Moon, with one bright star  
Within the nether tip.

[At the rising of the Moon, one after another, his shipmates drop down dead.]

One after one, by the star-dogged Moon,  
Too quick for groan or sigh,  
Each turned his face with a ghastly pang,  
And cursed me with his eye.

Four times fifty living men,  
(And I heard nor sigh nor groan)  
With heavy thump, a lifeless lump,  
They dropped down one by one.

[But Life-in-Death begins her work on the ancient Mariner.]

The souls did from their bodies fly,—  
They fled to bliss or woe!  
And every soul, it passed me by,  
Like the whizz of my cross-bow!

#### **PART IV**

[The Wedding-Guest feareth that a spirit is talking to him; but the ancient Mariner assureth him of his bodily life, and proceedeth to relate his horrible penance.]

'I FEAR thee, Ancient Mariner!  
I fear thy skinny hand!  
And thou art long, and lank, and brown,  
As is the ribbed sea-sand.

I fear thee and thy glittering eye,  
And thy skinny hand, so brown.'—  
'Fear not, fear not, thou Wedding-Guest!  
This body dropt not down.

Alone, alone, all, all alone,  
Alone on a wide wide sea!  
And never a saint took pity on  
My soul in agony.

[He despiseth the creatures of the calm, And envieth that they should  
live, and so many lie dead.]

The many men, so beautiful!  
And they all dead did lie:  
And a thousand thousand slimy things  
Lived on; and so did I.

I looked upon the rotting sea,  
And drew my eyes away;  
I looked upon the rotting deck,  
And there the dead men lay.

I looked to Heaven, and tried to pray;  
But or ever a prayer had gusht,  
A wicked whisper came, and made  
My heart as dry as dust.

I closed my lids, and kept them close,  
And the balls like pulses beat;  
For the sky and the sea, and the sea and the sky,  
Lay like a load on my weary eye,  
And the dead were at my feet.

[But the curse liveth for him in the eye of the dead men.]

The cold sweat melted from their limbs,  
Nor rot nor reek did they:  
The look with which they looked on me  
Had never passed away.

An orphan's curse would drag to Hell  
A spirit from on high;  
But oh! more horrible than that  
Is the curse in a dead man's eye!  
Seven days, seven nights, I saw that curse,  
And yet I could not die.

[In his loneliness and fixedness, he yearneth towards the Moon, and the stars that still sojourn, yet still move onward; and everywhere the blue sky belongs to them, and is their appointed rest and their native country, and their own natural homes, which they enter unannounced, as lords that are certainly expected, and yet there is a silent joy at their arrival.]

The moving Moon went up the sky,  
And nowhere did abide:  
Softly she was going up,  
And a star or two beside.

Her beams bemoaned the sultry main,  
Like April hoar-frost spread;  
But where the ship's huge shadow lay,  
The charmed water burnt alway  
A still and awful red.

[By the light of the Moon he beholdeth  
God's creatures of the great calm.]

Beyond the shadow of the ship,  
I watched the water-snakes:  
They moved in tracks of shining white,  
And when they reared, the elfish light  
Fell off in hoary flakes.

Within the shadow of the ship  
I watched their rich attire:  
Blue, glossy green, and velvet black,  
They coiled and swam; and every track  
Was a flash of golden fire.

[Their beauty and their happiness.  
He blesseth them in his heart.]

O happy living things! no tongue  
Their beauty might declare:  
A spring of love gushed from my heart,  
And I blessed them unaware!  
Sure my kind saint took pity on me,  
And I blessed them unaware.

[The spell begins to break.]

The selfsame moment I could pray;  
And from my neck so free

The Albatross fell off, and sank  
Like lead into the sea.

## **PART V**

'OH sleep! it is a gentle thing,  
Beloved from pole to pole!  
To Mary Queen the praise be given!  
She sent the gentle sleep from Heaven,  
That slid into my soul.

[By grace of the holy Mother, the ancient  
Mariner is refreshed with rain.]

The silly buckets on the deck,  
That had so long remained,  
I dreamt that they were filled with dew;  
And when I awoke, it rained.

My lips were wet, my throat was cold,  
My garments all were dank;  
Sure I had drunken in my dreams,  
And still my body drank.

I moved, and could not feel my limbs:  
I was so light—almost  
I thought that I had died in sleep  
And was a blessed ghost.



[He heareth sounds, and seeth strange sights and commotions in the sky  
and the element.]

And soon I heard a roaring wind:  
It did not come anear;  
But with its sound it shook the sails,  
That were so thin and sere.

The upper air burst into life,  
And a hundred fire-flags sheen;  
To and fro they were hurried about;  
And to and fro, and in and out,  
The wan stars danced between.

And the coming wind did roar more loud,  
And the sails did sigh like sedge;  
And the rain poured down from one black cloud;  
The Moon was at its edge.

The thick black cloud was cleft, and still  
The Moon was at its side:  
Like waters shot from some high crag,  
The, lightning fell with never a jag,  
A river steep and wide.

[The bodies of the ship's crew are inspirited, and the ship moves on;]

The loud wind never reached the ship,  
Yet now the ship moved on!

Beneath the lightning and the Moon  
The dead men gave a groan.

They groaned, they stirred, they all uprose,  
Nor spake, nor moved their eyes;  
It had been strange, even in a dream,  
To have seen those dead men rise.

The helmsman steered, the ship moved on;  
Yet never a breeze up blew;  
The mariners all 'gan work the ropes,  
Where they were wont to do:  
They raised their limbs like lifeless tools—  
We were a ghastly crew.

The body of my brother's son  
Stood by me, knee to knee:  
The body and I pulled at one rope,  
But he said nought to me.'

[But not by the souls of the men, nor by demons of earth or middle air,  
but by a blessed troop of angelic spirits, sent down by the invocation of the  
guardian saint.]

'I fear thee, Ancient Mariner!'  
'Be calm, thou Wedding-Guest!  
'Twas not those souls that fled in pain,  
Which to their corses came again,  
But a troop of spirits blest:

For when it dawned—they dropped their arms,  
And clustered round the mast;  
Sweet sounds rose slowly through their mouths,  
And from their bodies passed.

Around, around, flew each sweet sound,  
Then darted to the Sun;  
Slowly the sounds came back again,  
Now mixed, now one by one.

Sometimes a-dropping from the sky  
I heard the sky-lark sing;  
Sometimes all little birds that are,  
How they seemed to fill the sea and air  
With their sweet jargoning!

And now 'twas like all instruments,  
Now like a lonely flute;  
And now it is an angel's song,  
That makes the heavens be mute.

It ceased; yet still the sails made on  
A pleasant noise till noon,  
A noise like of a hidden brook  
In the leafy month of June,  
That to the sleeping woods all night  
Singeth a quiet tune.

Till noon we quietly sailed on,  
Yet never a breeze did breathe:  
Slowly and smoothly went the ship,  
Moved onward from beneath.

[The lonesome Spirit from the South Pole carries on the ship as far as the Line, in obedience to the angelic troop, but still requireth vengeance.]

Under the keel nine fathom deep,  
From the land of mist and snow,  
The spirit slid; and it was he  
That made the ship to go.  
The sails at noon left off their tune,  
And the ship stood still also.

The Sun, right up above the mast,  
Had fixed her to the ocean;  
But in a minute she 'gan stir,  
With a short uneasy motion—  
Backwards and forwards half her length,  
With a short uneasy motion.

Then like a pawing horse let go,  
She made a sudden bound:  
It flung the blood into my head,  
And I fell down in a swoond.

[The Polar Spirit's fellow-demons, the invisible inhabitants of the element, take part in his wrong; and two of them relate, one to the other, that penance long and heavy for the ancient Mariner hath been accorded to the Polar Spirit, who returneth southward.]

How long in that same fit I lay,  
I have not to declare;  
But ere my living life returned,

I heard, and in my soul discerned  
Two voices in the air.

"Is it he?" quoth one, "is this the man?  
By Him who died on cross,  
With his cruel bow he laid full low  
The harmless Albatross.

The spirit who bideth by himself  
In the land of mist and snow,  
He loved the bird that loved the man  
Who shot him with his bow."

The other was a softer voice,  
As soft as honey-dew:  
Quoth he, "The man hath penance done,  
And penance more will do."

## **PART VI**

### *First Voice*

"BUT tell me, tell me! speak again,  
Thy soft response renewing—  
What makes that ship drive on so fast?  
What is the Ocean doing?"

### *Second Voice*

"Still as a slave before his lord,  
The Ocean hath no blast;

His great bright eye most silently  
Up to the Moon is cast—

If he may know which way to go;  
For she guides him smooth or grim.  
See, brother, see! how graciously  
She looketh down on him."

[The Mariner hath been cast into a trance; for the angelic power causeth  
the vessel to drive northward, faster than human life could endure.]

*First Voice*

"But why drives on that ship so fast,  
Without or wave or wind?"

*Second Voice*

"The air is cut away before,  
And closes from behind.

Fly, brother, fly! more high, more high  
Or we shall be belated:  
For slow and slow that ship will go,  
When the Mariner's trance is abated."

[The supernatural motion is retarded; the  
Mariner awakes, and his penance begins anew.]

I woke, and we were sailing on  
As in a gentle weather:

'Twas night, calm night, the Moon was high  
The dead men stood together.

All stood together on the deck,  
For a charnel-dungeon fitter:  
All fixed on me their stony eyes,  
That in the Moon did glitter.

The pang, the curse, with which they died,  
Had never passed away:  
I could not draw my eyes from theirs,  
Nor turn them up to pray.

[The curse is finally expiated,]

And now this spell was snapt: once more  
I viewed the ocean green,  
And looked far forth, yet little saw  
Of what had else been seen.

Like one, that on a lonesome road  
Doth walk in fear and dread,  
And having once turned round, walks on,  
And turns no more his head;  
Because he knows, a frightful fiend  
Doth close behind him tread.

But soon there breathed a wind on me  
Nor sound nor motion made:  
Its path was not upon the sea,  
In ripple or in shade.

It raised my hair, it fanned my cheek  
Like a meadow-gale of spring—  
It mingled strangely with my fears,  
Yet it felt like a welcoming.

Swiftly, swiftly flew the ship,  
Yet she sailed softly too:  
Sweetly, sweetly blew the breeze—  
On me alone it blew.

[And the ancient Mariner beholdeth his native country.]

Oh dream of joy! is this indeed  
The lighthouse top I see?  
Is this the hill? is this the kirk?  
Is this mine own countree?

We drifted o'er the harbour-bar,  
And I with sobs did pray—  
"O let me be awake, my God!  
Or let me sleep alway."

The harbour-bay was clear as glass,  
So smoothly it was strewn!  
And on the bay the moonlight lay,  
And the shadow of the moon.

The rock shone bright, the kirk no less,  
That stands above the rock:  
The moonlight steeped in silentness  
The steady weathercock.



[The angelic spirits leave the dead bodies,  
And appear in their own forms of light.]

And the bay was white with silent light,  
Till rising from the same,  
Full many shapes, that shadows were,  
In crimson colours came.

A little distance from the prow  
Those crimson shadows were:  
I turned my eyes upon the deck—  
Oh, Christ! what saw I there!

Each corse lay flat, lifeless and flat,  
And, by the holy rood!  
A man all light, a seraph-man,  
On every corse there stood.

This seraph-band, each waved his hand:  
It was a heavenly sight!  
They stood as signals to the land,  
Each one a lovely light:

This seraph-band, each waved his hand,  
No voice did they impart  
No voice; but oh! the silence sank  
Like music on my heart.

But soon I heard the dash of oars,  
I heard the Pilot's cheer;

My head was turned perforce away,  
And I saw a boat appear.

The Pilot, and the Pilot's boy,  
I heard them coming fast:  
Dear Lord in Heaven! it was a joy  
The dead men could not blast.

I saw a third—I heard his voice:  
It is the Hermit good!  
He singeth loud his godly hymns  
That he makes in the wood.  
He'll shrieve my soul, he'll wash away  
The Albatross's blood.

## **PART VII**

[The Hermit of the Wood]

'THIS Hermit good lives in that wood  
Which slopes down to the sea.  
How loudly his sweet voice he rears!  
He loves to talk of marineres  
That come from a far countree.

He kneels at morn, and noon, and eve—  
He hath a cushion plump:  
It is the moss that wholly hides  
The rotted old oak stump.

The skiff-boat neared: I heard them talk,  
"Why, this is strange, I trow!  
Where are those lights so many and fair,  
That signal made but now?"

[Approacheth the ship with wonder.]

"Strange, by my faith!" the Hermit said—  
"And they answered not our cheer!  
the with The planks look warped and see those sails,  
How thin they are and sere!  
I never saw aught like to them,  
Unless perchance it were

Brown skeletons of leaves that lag  
My forest-brook along:  
When the ivy-tod is heavy with snow,  
And the owlet whoops to the wolf below,  
That eats the she-wolf's young."

"Dear Lord! it hath a fiendish look"  
(The Pilot made reply)  
"I am a-feared"—"Push on, push on!"  
Said the Hermit cheerily.

The boat came closer to the ship,  
But I nor spake nor stirred;  
The boat came close beneath the ship,  
And straight a sound was heard.

[The ship suddenly sinketh.]

Under the water it rumbled on,  
Still louder and more dread:  
It reached the ship, it split the bay;  
The ship went down like lead.

[The ancient Mariner is saved in the Pilot's boat.]

Stunned by that loud and dreadful sound,  
Which sky and ocean smote,  
Like one that hath been seven days drowned,  
My body lay afloat;  
But swift as dreams, myself I found  
Within the Pilot's boat.

Upon the whirl, where sank the ship,  
The boat spun round and round;  
And all was still, save that the hill  
Was telling of the sound.

I moved my lips—the Pilot shrieked  
And fell down in a fit;  
The holy Hermit raised his eyes,  
And prayed where he did sit.

I took the oars: the Pilot's boy,  
Who now doth crazy go,  
Laughed loud and long, and all the while  
His eyes went to and fro.

"Ha! ha!" quoth he, "full plain I see,  
The Devil knows how to row."

And now, all in my own countree,  
I stood on the firm land!  
The Hermit stepped forth from the boat,  
And scarcely he could stand.

[The ancient Mariner earnestly entreateth the Hermit to shrieve him; and the penance of life falls on him.]

"O shrieve me, shrieve me, holy man!"  
The Hermit crossed his brow.  
"Say quick," quoth he, "I bid thee say—  
What manner of man art thou?"

Forthwith this frame of mine was wrenched  
With a woful agony,  
Which forced me to begin my tale;  
And then it left me free.

[And ever and anon throughout his future life and agony constraineth him to travel from land to land,]

Since then, at an uncertain hour,  
That agony returns;  
And till my ghastly tale is told,  
This heart within me burns.

I pass, like night, from land to land;  
I have strange power of speech;  
That moment that his face I see,  
I know the man that must hear me:  
To him my tale I teach.

What loud uproar bursts from that door  
The wedding-guests are there;  
But in the garden-bower the bride  
And bride-maids singing are;  
And hark the little vesper bell,  
Which biddeth me to prayer!

O Wedding-Guest! this soul hath been  
Alone on a wide wide sea:  
So lonely 'twas, that God himself  
Scarce seemed there to be.

O sweeter than the marriage-feast,  
'Tis sweeter far to me,  
To walk together to the kirk  
With a goodly company!—

To walk together to the kirk,  
And all together pray,  
While each to his great Father bends,  
Old men, and babes, and loving friends,  
And youths and maidens gay!

[And to teach by his own example, love and reverence to all things that  
God made and loveth.]

Farewell, farewell! but this I tell  
To thee, thou Wedding-Guest!  
He prayeth well, who loveth well  
Both man and bird and beast.

He prayeth best, who loveth best  
All things both great and small;  
For the dear God who loveth us,  
He made and loveth all.'

The Mariner, whose eye is bright,  
Whose beard with age is hoar,  
Is gone; and now the Wedding-Guest  
Turned from the bridegroom's door.

He went like one that hath been stunned,  
And is of sense forlorn:  
A sadder and a wiser man,  
He rose the morrow morn.

## *ANONYMOUS*

### **THE VICAR OF BRAY**

IN good King Charles's golden days,  
When loyalty no harm meant,  
A zealous High Churchman was I,  
And so I got preferment;  
To teach my flock I never miss'd,  
Kings were by God appointed;

And damn'd are those who do resist,  
Or touch the Lord's anointed.

And this is law, that I'll maintain,  
Until my dying day, sir,  
That whatsoever King shall reign,  
I'll be the Vicar of Bray, sir.

When royal James obtained the crown,  
And Pop'ry came in fashion,  
The penal laws I hooted down,  
And read the Declaration;  
The Church of Rome I found would fit  
Full well my constitution;  
And had become a Jesuit,  
But' for the Revolution.

When William was our King declared,  
To ease the nation's grievance,  
With this new wind about I steered,  
And swore to him allegiance;  
Old principles I did revoke,  
Set conscience at a distance;  
Passive obedience was a joke,  
A jest was non-resistance.

When gracious Anne became our Queen,  
The Church of England's glory,  
Another face of things was seen,  
And I became a Tory;  
Occasional Conformists base,  
I damn'd their moderation,



And thought the Church in danger was,  
By such prevarication.

When George in pudding-time came o'er,  
And moderate men looked big, sir,  
I turned a cat-in-pan once more,  
And so became a Whig, sir;  
And thus preferment I procured,  
From our new faith's defender,  
And almost every day abjured  
The Pope and the Pretender.

The illustrious house of Hanover,  
And Protestant succession,  
To these I do allegiance swear,  
While they can keep possession;  
For in my faith and loyalty  
I never more will falter,  
And George my lawful King shall be,  
Until the times do alter.

And this is law, that I'll maintain,  
Until my dying day, sir,  
That whatsoever King shall reign,  
I'll be the Vicar of Bray, sir.

*WILLIAM JULIUS MICKLE*

**THERE 'S NAE LUCK ABOUT THE HOUSE**

BUT are ye sure the news is true?  
And are ye sure he's weel?  
Is this a time to think o' wark?  
Ye jauds, fling by your wheel.  
There 's nae luck about the house,  
There 's nae luck at a',  
There's nae luck about the house,  
When our gudeman's awa'.

Is this a time to think o' wark,  
When Colin 's at the door?  
Rax down my cloak—I'll to the key,  
And see him come ashore.  
Rise up and make a clean fireside,  
Put on the mickle pat;  
Gie little Kate her cotton gown,  
And Jock his Sunday's coat.

And mak their shoon as black as slaes,  
Their stockins white as snaw;  
It's a' to pleasure our gudeman  
He likes to see them braw.  
There are twa hens into the crib,  
Hae fed this month and mair,  
Mak haste and thraw their necks about,  
That Colin weel may fare.

Bring down to me my bigonet,  
My bishop's sattin gown,  
For I maun tell the bailie's wife,  
That Colin's come to town.

My Turkey slippers I'll put on,  
My stockins pearl blue  
It's a' to pleasure our gudeman,  
For he's baith leal and true.

Sae true his heart, sae smooth his tongue;  
His breath's like caller air;  
His very fit has music in't  
As he comes up the stair.  
And will I see his face again?  
And will I hear him speak?  
I'm downright dizzy wi' the thought:  
In troth, I'm like to greet.

## *ANONYMOUS*

### **THE GIRL I LEFT BEHIND ME**

I'm lonesome since I cross'd the hill,  
And o'er the moor and valley;  
Such heavy thoughts my heart do fill,  
Since parting with my Sally.  
I seek no more the fine or gay,  
For each does but remind me  
How swift the hours did pass away,  
With the girl I've left behind me.

Oh, ne'er shall I forget the night  
The stars were bright above me,

And gently lent their silv'ry light  
When first she vowed to love me.  
But now I'm bound to Brighton camp  
Kind Heaven, then, pray guide me,  
And send me safely back again  
To the girl I've left behind me.

My mind her form shall still retain,  
In sleeping, or in waking,  
Until I see my love again,  
For whom my heart is breaking.  
If ever I return that way,  
And she should not decline me,  
I evermore will live and stay  
With the girl I've left behind me.

*SIR DAVID DALRYMPLE*

**EDWARD! EDWARD!**

'WHY does your brand so drop with blood?  
Edward! Edward!  
Why does your brand so drop with blood?  
And why so sad go ye, O?'

'O! I have killed my hawk so good,  
Mother! Mother!  
O! I have killed my hawk so good,  
And I have no more but he, O!'

'Your hawk's blood was never so red,  
Edward! Edward!  
Your hawk's blood was never so red,  
My dear son, I tell thee, O!'

'O! I have killed my red roan steed,  
Mother! Mother!  
O! I have killed my red roan steed,  
That once was fair and free, O!'

'Your steed was old and ye have got more,  
Edward! Edward!  
Your steed was old and ye have got more,—  
Some other dule you drie, O!'

'O! I have killed my father dear,  
Mother! Mother!  
O! I have killed my father dear,  
Alas, and woe is me, O!'

'And what penance will ye drie for that?  
Edward! Edward?  
And what penance will ye drie for that?  
My dear son, now tell me, O!'

I'll set my feet in yonder boat,  
Mother! Mother!  
I'll set my feet in yonder boat,  
And I'll fare over the sea, O!'

'And what will you do with your towers and your hall?  
Edward! Edward!

And what will you do with your towers and your hall?  
They were so fair to see, O!

'I'll let them stand till they down fall,  
Mother! Mother!  
I'll let them stand till they down fall,  
For here never more must I be, O!

'And what will you leave to your bairns and your wife?  
Edward! Edward!  
And what will you leave to your bairns and your wife?  
When you go over the sea, O!

'The world's room, let them beg through life,  
Mother! Mother!  
The world's room, let them beg through life,  
For them never more will I see, O!

'And what will you leave to your own mother dear?  
Edward! Edward!  
And what will you leave to your own mother dear?  
My dear son, now tell me, O!

'The curse of hell from me shall you bear,  
Mother! Mother!  
The curse of hell from me shall you bear,  
Such counsels you gave to me, O!

*THOMAS PERCY*

## NANNY, WILT THOU GO WITH ME?

O NANNY, wilt thou go with me,  
Nor sigh to leave the flaunting town?  
Can silent glens have charms for thee,  
The lowly cot and russet gown?  
No longer drest in silken sheen,  
No longer deck'd with jewels rare,—  
Say, canst thou quit each courtly scene,  
Where thou wert fairest of the fair?

O Nanny, when thou'rt far away,  
Wilt thou not cast a wish behind?  
Say, canst thou face the parching ray,  
Nor shrink before the wintry wind?  
Oh, can that soft and gentle mien  
Extremes of hardship learn to bear,  
Nor sad, regret each courtly scene,  
Where thou wert fairest of the fair?

O Nanny, canst thou love so true,  
Through perils keen with me to go,  
Or when thy swain mishap shall rue,  
To share with him the pang of woe?  
Say, should disease or pain befall,  
Wilt thou assume the nurse's care  
Nor wistful those gay scenes recall,  
Where thou wert fairest of the fair?

And when at last thy love shall die,  
Wilt thou receive his parting breath,

Wilt thou repress each struggling sigh,  
And cheer with smiles the bed of death?  
And wilt thou o'er his breathless clay  
Strew flowers and drop the tender tear,  
Nor then regret those scenes so gay,  
Where thou wert fairest of the fair?

### **THE FRIAR OF ORDERS GRAY**

IT was a friar of orders gray  
Walk'd forth to tell his beads;  
And he met with a lady fair  
Clad in a pilgrim's weeds.

'Now Christ thee save, thou reverend friar,  
I pray thee tell to me,  
If ever at yon holy shrine  
My true love thou didst see.'

'And how should I know your true-love  
From many another one?'  
'Oh, by his cockle-hat and staff,  
And by his sandal shoon.

'But chiefly by his face and mien,  
That were so fair to view;  
His flaxen locks that sweetly curl'd,  
And eyes of lovely blue.'

'O lady, he is dead and gone!  
Lady, he's dead and gone!



And at his head a green-grass turf,  
And at his heels a stone.

Within these holy cloisters long  
He languish'd, and he died  
Lamenting of a lady's love,  
And 'plaining of her pride.

They bore him barefaced on his bier  
Six proper youths and tall,  
And many a tear bedew'd his grave  
Within yon kirk-yard wall.'

And art thou dead, thou gentle youth  
And art thou dead and gone;  
And didst thou die for love of me?  
Break, cruel heart of stone!'

'Oh, weep not, lady, weep not so,  
Some ghostly comfort seek;  
Let not vain sorrows rive thy heart,  
Nor tears bedew thy cheek.'

Oh, do not, do not, holy friar,  
My sorrow now reprove;  
For I have lost the sweetest youth  
That e'er won lady's love.

And now, alas! for thy sad loss  
I'll ever weep and sigh;  
For thee I only wish'd to live,  
For thee I wish to die.'

'Weep no more, lady, weep no more,  
Thy sorrow is in vain;  
For violets pluck'd, the sweetest shower  
Will ne'er make grow again.

'Our joys as winged dreams do fly,  
Why then should sorrow last?  
Since grief but aggravates thy loss,  
Grieve not for what is past.'

'Oh, say not so, thou holy friar,  
I pray thee say not so;  
For since my true-love died for me,  
'Tis meet my tears should flow.

'And will he never come again?  
Will he ne'er come again?  
Ah no, he is dead and laid in his grave,  
For ever to remain.

'His cheek was redder than the rose;  
The comeliest youth was he;  
But he is dead and laid in his grave:  
Alas, and woe is me!'

'Sigh no more, lady, sigh no more;  
Men were deceivers ever;  
One foot on sea and one on land,  
To one thing constant never.

'Hadst thou been fond, he had been false,  
And left thee sad and heavy;

For young men ever were fickle found,  
Since summer trees were leafy.'

'Now say not so, thou holy friar,  
I pray thee say not so;  
My love he had the truest heart,  
Oh, he was ever true!

'And art thou dead, thou much lov'd youth,  
And didst thou die for me?  
Then farewell, home; for evermore  
A pilgrim I will be.'

'But first upon my true-love's grave  
My weary limbs I'll lay,  
And thrice I'll kiss the green-grass turf  
That wraps his breathless clay.'

'Yet stay, fair lady, rest a while  
Beneath this cloister wall;  
See, through the thorn blows cold the wind  
And drizzly rain doth fall.'

Oh, stay me not, thou holy friar;  
Oh, stay me not, I pray;  
No drizzly rain that falls on me  
Can wash my fault away.'

'Yet stay, fair lady, turn again,  
And dry those pearly tears'  
For see, beneath this gown of grey  
Thy own true-love appears.

'Here, forced by grief and hopeless love,  
These holy weeds I sought,  
And here amid these lonely walls  
To end my days I thought.

'But haply, for my year of grace  
Is not yet pass'd away,  
Might I still hope to win thy love,  
No longer would I stay.'

'Now farewell grief, and welcome joy  
Once more unto my heart;  
For since I have found thee, lovely youth,  
We never more will part.'

ROBERT SOUTHEY

### **THE INCHCAPE ROCK**

No stir in the air, no stir in the sea,  
The ship was still as she could be,  
Her sails from heaven received no motion,  
Her keel was steady in the ocean.

Without either sign or sound of their shock  
The waves How'd over the Inchcape Rock;  
So little they rose, so little they fell,  
They did not move the Inchcape Bell.

The worthy Abbot of Aberbrothock  
Had placed that bell on the Inchcape Rock;  
On a buoy in the storm it floated and swung,  
And over the waves its warning rung.

When the Rock was hid by the surge's swell,  
The mariners heard the warning bell;  
And then they knew the perilous Rock,  
And bless'd the Abbot of Aberbrothock.

The Sun in heaven was shining gay,  
All things were joyful on that day;  
The sea-birds scream'd as they wheel'd round,  
And there was joyaunce in the sound.

The buoy of the Inchcape Bell was seen,  
A darker speck on the ocean green;  
Sir Ralph the Rover walk'd his deck,  
And he fixed his eye on the darker speck.

He felt the cheering power of spring,  
It made him whistle, it made him sing;  
His heart was mirthful to excess,  
But the Rover's mirth was wickedness.

His eye was on the Inchcape float,  
Quoth he, 'My men, put out the boat,  
And row me to the Inch cape Rock,  
And I'll plague the Abbot of Aberbrothock.'

The boat is lower'd, the boatmen row,  
And to the Inchcape Rock they go;

Sir Ralph bent over from the boat,  
And he cut the Bell from the Inchcape float.

Down sank the Bell with a gurgling sound,  
The bubbles arose and burst around;  
Quoth Sir Ralph, 'The next who comes to the Rock  
Won't bless the Abbot of Aberbrothock.'

Sir Ralph the Rover sail'd away,  
He scour'd the seas for many a day;  
And now grown rich with plunder'd store,  
He steers his course for Scotland's shore.

So thick a haze o'erspreads the sky  
They cannot see the Sun on high;  
The wind hath blown a gale all day,  
At evening it hath died away.

On deck the Rover takes his stand,  
So dark it is they see no land;  
Quoth Sir Ralph, 'It will be lighter soon,  
For there is the dawn of the rising Moon.'

'Canst hear,' said one, 'the breakers roar?  
For methinks we should be near the shore.'  
'Now where we are I cannot tell,  
But I wish I could hear the Inchcape Bell.'

They hear no sound, the swell is strong;  
Though the wind hath fallen they drift along,  
Till the vessel strikes with a shivering shock,—  
'Oh Christ! it is the Inchcape Rock!'

Sir Ralph the Rover tore his hair;  
He curst himself in his despair;  
But the waves rush in on every side,  
And the vessel sinks beneath the tide.

### **THE WELL OF ST. KEYNE**

A WELL there is in the west country,  
And a clearer one never was seen;  
There is not a wife in the west country  
But has heard of the Well of St. Keyne.

An oak and an elm tree stand beside,  
And behind doth an ash-tree grow,  
And a willow from the bank above  
Droops to the water below.

A traveller came to the Well of St. Keyne;  
Joyfully he drew nigh,  
For from cock-crow he had been travelling,  
And there was not a cloud in the sky.

He drank of the water so cool and clear,  
For thirsty and hot was he,  
And he sat down upon the bank  
Under the willow-tree.

There came a man from the house hard by  
At the Well to fill his pail;  
On the Well-side he rested it,  
And he bade the stranger hail.

'Now art thou a bachelor, stranger?' quoth he,  
For an if thou hast a wife,  
The happiest draught thou hast drunk this day  
That ever thou didst in thy life.

'Or has thy good woman, if one thou hast,  
Ever here in Cornwall been?  
For an if she have, I'll venture my life  
She has drunk of the Well of St. Keyne.'

I have left a good woman who never was here,'  
The stranger he made reply,  
'But that my draught should be the better for that,  
I pray you answer me why?'

'St. Keyne,' quoth the Cornish-man, 'many a time  
Drank of this crystal Well,  
And before the angel summon'd her,  
She laid on the water a spell.

If the husband, of this gifted Well,  
Shall drink before his wife,  
A happy man thenceforth is he,  
For he shall be master for life.

'But if the wife shall drink of it first,  
God help the husband then!'  
The stranger stoopt to the Well of St. Keyne,  
And drank of the water again.

'You drank of the Well I warrant betimes?'  
He to the Cornish-man said:



But the Cornish-man smiled as the stranger spake,  
And sheepishly shook his head.

'I hasten'd as soon as the wedding was done,  
And left my wife in the porch;  
But I' faith she had been wiser than me,  
For she took a bottle to church.'

### **THE BATTLE OF BLENHEIM**

IT was a summer evening,  
Old Kaspar's work was done,  
And he before his cottage door  
Was sitting in the sun,  
And by sported on the green  
His little grandchild Wilhelmine.

She saw her brother Peterkin  
Roll something large and round,  
Which he beside the rivulet  
In playing there had found;  
He came to ask what he had found,  
That was so large, and smooth, and round.

Old Kaspar took it from the boy,  
Who stood expectant by;  
And then the old man shook his head,  
And with a natural sigh,  
'Tis some poor fellow's skull,' said he,  
'Who fell in that great victory.

'I find them in the garden,  
For there's many here about;  
And often when I go to plough,  
The ploughshare turns them out!  
For many thousand men,' said he,  
Were slain in that great victory.'

Now tell us what 'twas all about,'  
Young Peterkin he cries;  
And little Wilhelmine looks up  
With wonder-waiting eyes;  
Now tell us all about the war,  
And what they fought each other for.'

It was the English,' Kaspar cried,  
Who put the French to rout;  
But what they fought each other for,  
I could not well make out;  
But everybody said,' quoth he,  
That 'twas a famous victory.

My father lived at Blenheim then,  
Yon little stream hard by;  
They burnt his dwelling to the ground,  
And he was forced to fly;  
So with his wife and child he fled,  
Nor had he where to rest his head.

With fire and sword the country round  
Was wasted far and wide,  
And many a tender mother then,  
And new-born baby, died;

But things like that, you know, must be  
At every famous victory.

They say it was a shocking sight  
After the field was won;  
For many thousand bodies here  
Lay rotting in the sun;  
But things like that, you know, must be  
After a famous victory;

Great praise the Duke of Marlbro' won,  
And our good Prince Eugene.'—  
'Why, 'twas a very wicked thing!'  
Said little Wilhelmine.  
Nay—nay—my little girl,' quoth he,  
It was a famous victory;

'And everybody praised the Duke  
Who this great fight did win.'  
'But what good came of it at last?'  
Quoth little Peterkin.  
'Why, that I cannot tell,' said he,  
'But 'twas a famous victory.'

## **FATHER WILLIAM**

You are old, Father William, the young man cried,  
The few locks that are left you are gray;  
You are hale, Father William, a hearty old man,  
Now tell me the reason, I pray.

In the days of my youth, Father William replied,  
I remember'd that youth would fly fast,  
And abused not my health and my vigour at first,  
That I never might need them at last.

You are old, Father William, the young man cried,  
And pleasures with youth pass away,  
And yet you lament not the days that are gone,  
Now tell me the reason, I pray.

In the days of my youth, Father William replied,  
I remember'd that youth could not last;  
I thought of the future, whatever I did,  
That I never might grieve for the past.

You are old, Father William, the young man cried,  
And life must be hastening away;  
You are cheerful, and love to converse upon death!  
Now tell me the reason, I pray.

I am cheerful, young man, Father William replied;  
Let the cause thy attention engage:  
In the days of my youth I remember'd my God!  
And He hath not forgotten my age.

*MRS. COCKBURN*

**THE FLOWERS OF THE FOREST**

I'VE seen the smiling  
Of Fortune beguiling;  
I've felt all its favours, and found its decay:  
Sweet was its blessing,  
Kind its caressing;  
But now it is fled—it is fled far away.

I've seen the forest  
Adorned the foremost  
With flowers of the fairest most pleasant and gay;  
Sae bonny was their blooming!  
Their scent the air perfuming!  
But now they are withered and weeded away.

I've seen the morning  
With gold the hills adorning,  
And loud tempest storming before the mid-day,  
I've seen Tweed's silver streams,  
Shining in the sunny beams,  
Grow drumly and dark as he rowed on his way.

O fickle Fortune,  
Why this cruel sporting?  
Oh, why still perplex us, poor sons of a day?  
Nae mair your smiles can cheer me,  
Nae mair your frowns can fear me;  
For the Flowers of the Forest are a' wede away.

*WILLIAM WORDSWORTH*

## LUCY GRAY

OFT I had heard of Lucy Gray;  
And, when I crossed the wild,  
I chanced to see at break of day,  
The solitary child.

No mate, no comrade, Lucy knew;  
She dwelt on a wide moor,  
—The sweetest thing that ever grew  
Beside a human door!

You yet may spy the fawn at play,  
The hare upon the green;  
But the sweet face of Lucy Gray  
Will never more be seen.

'To-night will be a stormy night—  
You to the town must go;  
And take a lantern, child, to light  
Your mother through the snow.'

'That, father, will I gladly do!  
'Tis scarcely afternoon  
The minster-clock has just struck two,  
And yonder is the moon.'

At this the father raised his hook  
And snapped a fagot band;  
He plied his work;—and Lucy took  
The lantern in her hand.

Not blither is the mountain roe:  
With many a wanton stroke  
Her feet disperse the powdery snow,  
That rises up like smoke.

The storm came on before its time:  
She wandered up and down:  
And many a hill did Lucy climb;  
But never reached the town.

The wretched parents all that night,  
Went shouting far and wide;  
But there was neither sound nor sight  
To serve them for a guide.

At daybreak on a hill they stood  
That overlooked the moor;  
And thence they saw the bridge of wood,  
A furlong from the door.

And, turning homeward, now they cried,  
'In heaven we all shall meet!'  
—When in the snow the mother spied  
The print of Lucy's feet.

Then downward from the steep hill's edge  
They tracked the footmarks small;  
And through the broken hawthorn hedge,  
And by the long stone wall:

And then an open field they crossed:  
The marks were still the same;

They tracked them on, nor ever lost;  
And to the bridge they came.

They followed from the snowy bank  
The footmarks, one by one,  
Into the middle of the plank;  
And further there were none!

—Yet some maintain that to this day  
She is a living child;  
That you may see sweet Lucy Gray  
Upon the lonesome wild.

O'er rough and smooth she trips along,  
And never looks behind;  
And sings a solitary song  
That whistles in the wind.

## **WE ARE SEVEN**

A SIMPLE child  
That lightly draws its breath,  
And feels its life in every limb,  
What should it know of death?

I met a little cottage girl:  
She was eight years old, she said;  
Her hair was thick with many a curl  
That clustered round her head.

She had a rustic, woodland air,  
And she was wildly clad;



Her eyes were fair, and very fair;  
—Her beauty made me glad.

Sisters and brothers, little maid,  
How many may you be?'  
'How many? Seven in all,' she said,  
And wondering looked at me.

'And where are they? I pray you tell.'  
She answered, 'Seven are we;  
And two of us at Conway dwell,  
And two are gone to sea.

'Two of us in the churchyard lie,  
My sister and my brother;  
And, in the churchyard cottage, I  
Dwell near them with my mother.'

'You say that two at Conway dwell,  
And two are gone to sea,  
Yet ye are seven!—I pray you tell,  
Sweet maid, how this may be?'

Then did the little maid reply,  
'Seven boys and girls are we;  
Two of us in the churchyard lie,  
Beneath the churchyard tree.'

'You run about, my little maid,  
Your limbs they are alive;  
If two are in the churchyard laid,  
Then ye are only five.'

'Their graves are green, they may be seen,'  
The little maid replied,  
Twelve steps or more from my mother's door,  
And they are side by side.

'My stockings there I often knit,  
My kerchief there I hem;  
And there upon the ground I sit—  
I sit and sing to them.

'And often after sunset, Sir,  
When it is light and fair,  
I take my little porringer,  
And eat my supper there.

'The first that died was little Jane;  
In bed she moaning lay,  
Till God released her of her pain:  
And then she went away.

'So in the churchyard she was laid;  
And all the summer dry,  
Together round her grave we played,  
My brother John and I.

'And when the ground was white with snow,  
And I could run and slide,  
My brother John was forced to go,  
And he lies by her side.'

'How many are you, then,' said I,  
'If they two are in heaven?'

The little maiden did reply,  
'O master! we are seven.'

'But they are dead: those two are dead!  
Their spirits are in heaven!'  
'Twas throwing words away: for still  
The little maid would have her will,  
And said, 'Nay, we are seven!'

### **SHE DWELT AMONG UNTRODDEN WAYS**

SHE dwelt among the untrodden ways  
Beside the springs of Dove,  
A Maid whom there were none to praise  
And very few to love:

A violet by a mossy stone  
Half hidden from the eye!  
Fair as a star, when only one  
Is shining in the sky.

She lived unknown, and few could know  
When Lucy ceased to be;  
But she is in her grave, and oh,  
The difference to me!

### **I TRAVELLED AMONG UNKNOWN MEN**

I TRAVELL'D among unknown men,  
In lands beyond the sea;

Nor, England! did I know till then  
What love I bore to thee.

'Tis past, the melancholy dream!  
Nor will I quit thy shore  
A second time; for still I seem  
To love thee more and more.

Among thy mountains did I feel  
The joy of my desire;  
And she I cherish'd turn'd her wheel  
Beside an English fire.

Thy mornings show'd, thy nights conceal'd,  
The bowers where Lucy play'd;  
And thine too is the last green field  
That Lucy's eyes survey'd.

*SIR WALTER SCOTT*

### **LOCHINVAR**

O, YOUNG Lochinvar is come out of the west,  
Through all the wide Border his steed was the best,  
And save his good broad-sword he weapons had none;  
He rode all unarmed, and he rode all alone.  
So faithful in love, and so dauntless in war,  
There never was knight like the young Lochinvar.

He stayed not for brake, and he stopped not for stone,  
He swam the Eske river where ford there was none;  
But, ere he alighted at Netherby gate,  
The bride had consented, the gallant came late  
For a laggard in love, and a dastard in war,  
Was to wed the fair Ellen of brave Lochinvar.

So boldly he entered the Netherby hall,  
Among bride's-men and kinsmen, and brothers and all:  
Then spoke the bride's father, his hand on his sword  
(For the poor craven bridegroom said never a word),  
O come ye in peace here, or come ye in war,  
Or to dance at our bridal, young Lord Lochinvar?'

'I long wooed your daughter, my suit you denied;  
Love swells like the Solway, but ebbs like its tide—  
And now I am come, with this lost love of mine,  
To lead but one measure, drink one cup of wine.  
There are maidens in Scotland more lovely by far,  
That would gladly be bride to the young Lochinvar.'

The bride kissed the goblet; the knight took it up,  
He quaffed off the wine, and he threw down the cup,  
She looked down to blush, and she looked up to sigh,  
With a smile on her lips and a tear in her eye.  
He took her soft hand, ere her mother could bar,—  
'Now tread we a measure!' said young Lochinvar.

So stately his form, and so lovely her face,  
That never a hall such a galliard did grace;  
While her mother did fret, and her father did fume,  
And the bridegroom stood dangling his bonnet and plume;

And the bride-maidens whispered, "Twere better by far  
To have matched our fair cousin with young Lochinvar."

One touch to her hand, and one word in her ear,  
When they reached the hall-door, and the charger stood near;  
So light to the croupe the fair lady he swung,  
So light to the saddle before her he sprung!  
'She is won! we are gone, over bank, bush, and scaur;  
They'll have fleet steeds that follow,' quoth young Lochinvar.

There was mounting 'mong Graemes of the Netherby clan;  
Forsters, Fenwicks, and Musgraves, they rode and they ran:  
There was racing, and chasing, on Cannobie Lee,  
But the lost bride of Netherby ne'er did they see.  
So daring in love, and so dauntless in war,  
Have ye e'er heard of gallant like young Lochinvar?

## **CORONACH**

HE is gone on the mountain,  
He is lost to the forest,  
Like a summer-dried fountain,  
When our need was the sorest,  
The font, reappearing,  
From the rain-drops shall borrow,  
But to us comes no cheering,  
To Duncan no morrow!

The hand of the reaper  
Takes the ears that are hoary,  
But the voice of the weeper

Wails manhood in glory.  
The autumn winds rushing,  
Waft the leaves that are searest,  
But our flower was in flushing  
When blighting was nearest.

Fleet foot on the correi,  
Sage counsel in cumber,  
Red hand in the foray,  
How sound is thy slumber!  
Like the dew on the mountain,  
Like the foam on the river,  
Like the bubble on the fountain,  
Thou art gone, and for ever!

### **A WEARY LOT IS THINE**

'A WEARY lot is thine, fair maid,  
A weary lot is thine!  
To pull the thorn thy brow to braid,  
And press the rue for wine!  
A lightsome eye, a soldier's mien,  
A feather of the blue,  
A doublet of the Lincoln green,—  
No more of me you knew,  
My love!  
No more of me you knew.

'This morn is merry June, I trow,  
The rose is budding fain;  
But she shall bloom in winter snow,

Ere we two meet again.'  
He turned his charger as he spake,  
Upon the river shore,  
He gave his bridle-reins a shake,  
Said Adieu for evermore,  
My love.  
And adieu for evermore.'

### **ALLEN-A-DALE**

ALLEN-A-DALE has no fagot for burning,  
Allen-a-Dale has no furrow for turning,  
Allen-a-Dale has no fleece for the spinning,  
Yet Allen-a-Dale has red gold for the winning.  
Come, read me my riddle! come, hearken my tale!  
And tell me the craft of bold Allen-a-Dale.

The Baron of Ravensworth prances in pride,  
And he views his domains upon Arkindale side.  
The mere for his net, and the land for his game,  
The chase for the wild, and the park for the tame;  
Yet the fish of the lake, and the deer of the vale,  
Are less free to Lord Dacre than Allen-a-dale.

Allen-a-Dale was ne'er belted a knight,  
Though his spur be as sharp, and his blade be as bright;  
Allen-a-dale is no baron or lord,  
Yet twenty tall yeomen will draw at his word;  
And the best of our nobles his bonnet will veil,  
Who at Rere-cross on Stanmore meets Allen-a-Dale.



Allen-a-Dale to his wooing is come;  
The mother, she asked of his household and home:  
'Though the castle of Richmond stand fair on the hill,  
My hall,' quoth bold Allen, 'shows gallanter still;  
'Tis the blue vault of heaven, with its crescent so pale,  
And with all its bright spangles!' said Allen-a-Dale.

The father was steel, and the mother was stone;  
They lifted the latch, and they bade him be gone;  
But loud, on the morrow, their wail and their cry:  
He had laughed on the lass with his bonny black eye,  
And she fled to the forest to hear a love-tale,  
And the youth it was told by was Allen-a-Dale.

### **PIBROCH OF DONUIL DHU**

PIBROCH of Donuil Dhu,  
Pibroch of Donuil,  
Wake thy wild voice anew,  
Summon Clan Conuil.  
Come away, come away,  
Hark to the summons!  
Come in your war array,  
Gentles and Commons!

Come from deep glen, and  
From mountain so rocky;  
The war-pipe and pennon  
Are at Inverlochy.  
Come every hill-plaid, and  
True heart that wears one;

Come every steel blade, and  
Strong hand that bears one!

Leave untended the herd,  
The flock without shelter;  
Leave the corpse uninterred,  
The bride at the altar.  
Leave the deer, leave the steer,  
Leave nets and barges;  
Come with your fighting-gear,  
Broadswords and targes.

Come as the winds come, when  
Forests are rended:  
Come as the waves come, when  
Navies are stranded.  
Faster come, faster come,  
Faster and faster;  
Chief, vassal, page, and groom,  
Tenant and master.

Fast they come, fast they come;  
See how they gather!  
Wide waves the eagle plume,  
Blended with heather.  
Cast your plaids, draw your blades,  
Forward each man set;  
Pibroch of Donuil Dhu,  
Knell for the onset!

**SONG FROM 'THE PIRATE'**

LOVE wakes and weeps  
While Beauty sleeps!  
O for music's softest numbers,  
To prompt a theme  
For Beauty's dream,  
Soft as the pillow of her slumbers!

Through groves of palm  
Sigh gales of balm,  
Fire-flies on the air are wheeling;  
While through the gloom  
Comes soft perfume,  
The distant beds of flowers revealing.

O wake and live!  
No dreams can give  
A shadowed bliss, the real excelling;  
No longer sleep,  
From lattice peep,  
And list the tale that Love is telling!

## **ROSABELLE**

'O LISTEN, listen, ladies gay!  
No haughty feat of arms I tell;  
Soft is the note, and sad the lay  
That mourns the lovely Rosabelle.

'Moor, moor the barge, ye gallant crew!  
And, gentle ladye, deign to stay!

Rest thee in Castle Ravensheuch,  
Nor tempt the stormy firth to-day.

The blackening wave is edged with white;  
To inch and rock the sea-mews fly;  
The fishers have heard the Water-Sprite,  
Whose screams forebode that wreck is nigh.

Last night the gifted Seer did view  
A wet shroud swathed round ladye gay;  
Then stay thee, Fair, in Ravensheuch;  
Why cross the gloomy firth to-day?

"Tis not because Lord Lindesay's heir  
To-night at Roslin leads the ball,  
But that my ladye-mother there  
Sits lonely in her castle-hall.

'Tis not because the ring they ride,  
And Lindesay at the ring rides well,  
But that my sire the wine will chide  
If 'tis not fill'd by Rosabelle.'

—O'er Roslin all that dreary night  
A wondrous blaze was seen to gleam;  
'Twas broader than the watch-fire's light,  
And redder than the bright moonbeam.

It glared on Roslin's castled rock,  
It ruddied all the copse-wood glen;  
'Twas seen from Dryden's groves of oak,  
And seen from cavern'd Hawthornden.

Seem'd all on fire that chapel proud  
Where Roslin's chiefs uncoffin'd lie,  
Each Baron, for a sable shroud,  
Sheathed in his iron panoply.

Seem'd all on fire within, around,  
Deep sacristy and altar's pale;  
Shone every pillar foliage-bound,  
And glimmer'd all the dead men's mail.

Blazed battlement and pinnet high,  
Blazed every rose-carved buttress fair—  
So still they blaze, when fate is nigh  
The lordly line of high Saint Clair.

There are twenty of Roslin's barons bold  
Lie buried within that proud chapelle;  
Each one the holy vault doth hold  
But the sea holds lovely Rosabelle.

And each Saint Clair was buried there,  
With candle, with book, and with knell;  
But the sea-caves rung, and the wild winds sung  
The dirge of lovely Rosabelle.

## **PROUD MAISIE**

PROUD Maisie is in the wood,  
Walking so early;  
Sweet Robin sits on the bush,  
Singing so rarely.

'Tell me, thou bonny bird,  
When shall I marry me?'—  
'When six braw gentlemen  
Kirkward shall carry ye.'

'Who makes the bridal bed,  
Birdie, say truly?'—  
'The grey-headed sexton  
That delves the grave duly.  
The glowworm o'er grave and stone  
Shall light thee steady;  
The owl from the steeple sing  
Welcome, proud lady.'

*THOMAS CAMPBELL*

### **LORD ULLIN'S DAUGHTER**

A CHIEFTAIN to the Highlands bound,  
Cries, 'Boatman, do not tarry!  
And I'll give thee a silver pound  
To row us o'er the ferry.'

'Now, who be ye would cross Lochgyle,  
This dark and stormy water?'  
'Oh, I'm the chief of Ulva's isle,  
And this Lord Ullin's daughter.

'And fast before her father's men  
Three days we've fled together;

For, should he find us in the glen  
My blood would stain the heather.

'His horsemen hard behind us ride;  
Should they our steps discover,  
Then who will cheer my bonny bride  
When they have slain her lover?'

Out spoke the hardy island wight,  
'I'll go, my chief—I'm ready  
It is not for your silver bright;  
But for your winsome lady:

'And by my word, the bonny bird  
In danger shall not tarry;  
So, though the waves are raging white,  
I'll row you o'er the ferry.'

By this the storm grew loud apace,  
The water-wraith was shrieking;  
And in the scowl of heaven each face  
Grew dark as they were speaking.

But still as wilder blew the wind,  
And as the night grew drearer,  
Adown the glen rode armed men,  
Their trampling sounded nearer.

Oh! haste thee, haste!' the lady cries,  
'Though tempests round us gather;  
I'll meet the raging of the skies,  
But not an angry father.'

The boat has left a stormy land,  
A stormy sea before her,—  
When, oh! too strong for human hand,  
The tempest gathered o'er her.

And still they rowed amidst the roar  
Of waters fast prevailing;  
Lord Ullin reached that fatal shore,  
His wrath was changed to wailing.

For sore dismayed through storm and shade,  
His child he did discover:  
One lovely hand she stretched for aid,  
And one was round her lover.

Come back! come back!' he cried in grief,  
Across this stormy water;  
And I'll forgive your Highland chief,  
My daughter!—oh! my daughter!

'Twas vain: the loud waves lashed the shore,  
Return or aid preventing;  
The waters wild went o'er his child,  
And he was left lamenting.

## **THE SOLDIER'S DREAM**

OUR bugles sang truce—for the night-cloud had lowered  
And the sentinel stars set their watch in the sky;  
And thousands had sunk on the ground overpowered,  
The weary to sleep, and the wounded to die.



When reposing that night on my pallet of straw,  
By the wolf-scaring fagot that guarded the slain,  
At the dead of the night a sweet vision I saw,  
And thrice ere the morning I dreamt it again.

Methought from the battlefield's dreadful array,  
Far, far I had roamed on a desolate track;  
'Twas autumn—and sunshine arose on the way  
To the home of my fathers, that welcomed me back.

I flew to the pleasant fields traversed so oft  
In life's morning march, when my bosom was young;  
I heard my own mountain-goats bleating aloft,  
And knew the sweet strain that the corn-reapers sung.

Then pledged we the wine-cup, and fondly I swore  
From my home and my weeping friends never to part;  
My little ones kissed me a thousand times o'er,  
And my wife sobbed aloud in her fulness of heart.

Stay, stay with us—rest, thou art weary and worn';  
And fain was their war-broken soldier to stay;  
But sorrow returned with the dawning of morn,  
And the voice in my dreaming ear melted away.

## **EXILE OF ERIN**

THERE came to the beach a poor Exile of Erin,  
The dew on his thin robe was heavy and chill:  
For his country he sighed, when at twilight repairing  
To wander alone by the wind-beaten hill.

But the day-star attracted his eye's sad devotion,  
For it rose o'er his own native isle of the ocean,  
Where once, in the fire of his youthful emotion,  
He sang the bold anthem of Erin go bragh.

Sad is my fate! said the heart-broken stranger,  
The wild deer and wolf to a covert can flee;  
But I have no refuge from famine and danger,  
A home and a country remain not to me.  
Never again in the green sunny bowers,  
Where my forefathers lived, shall I spend the sweet hours,  
Or cover my harp with the wild woven flowers,  
And strike to the numbers of Erin go bragh!

Erin my country! though sad and forsaken,  
In dreams I revisit thy sea-beaten shore;  
But alas! in a fair foreign land I awaken,  
And sigh for the friends who can meet me no more!  
Oh cruel fate! wilt thou never replace me  
In a mansion of peace—where no perils can chase me?  
Never again shall my brothers embrace me?  
They died to defend me, or live to deplore!

Where is my cabin-door, fast by the wild wood?  
Sisters and sire! did ye weep for its fall?  
Where is the mother that looked on my childhood?  
And where is the bosom friend, dearer than all?  
Oh, my sad heart! long abandoned by pleasure,  
Why did it doat on a fast fading treasure?  
Tears like the rain-drop may fall without measure,  
But rapture and beauty they cannot recall.

Yet all its sad recollection suppressing,  
One dying wish my lone bosom can draw:  
Erin! an exile bequeaths thee his blessing!  
Land of my forefathers! Erin go bragh!  
Buried and cold, when my heart stills her motion,  
Green be thy fields—sweetest isle of the ocean!  
And thy harp-striking bards sing aloud with devotion  
Erin mavournin!—Erin go bragh!

## **YE MARINERS OF ENGLAND**

YE mariners of England,  
That guard our native seas;  
Whose flag has braved a thousand years  
The battle and the breeze!  
Your glorious standard launch again  
To match another foe;  
And sweep through the deep,  
While the stormy winds do blow;  
While the battle rages loud and long,  
And the stormy winds do blow!

The spirits of your fathers  
Shall start from every wave;  
For the deck it was their field of fame,  
And Ocean was their grave:  
Where Blake and mighty Nelson fell,  
Your manly hearts shall glow,  
As ye sweep through the deep,  
While the stormy winds do blow;

While the battle rages loud and long,  
And the stormy winds do blow!

Britannia needs no bulwarks,  
No towers along the steep;  
Her march is o'er the mountain wave,  
Her home is on the deep.  
With thunders from her native oak  
She quells the floods below,  
As they roar on the shore,  
When the stormy winds do blow;  
When the battle rages loud and long,  
And the stormy winds do blow!

The meteor flag of England  
Shall yet terrific burn,  
Till danger's troubled night depart,  
And the star of peace return;  
Then, then, ye ocean warriors,  
Our song and feast shall flow  
To the fame of your name,  
When the storm has ceased to blow;  
When the fiery fight is heard no more,  
And the storm has ceased to blow.

## **THE BATTLE OF THE BALTIC**

OF Nelson and the North  
Sing the glorious day's renown,  
When to battle fierce came forth  
All the might of Denmark's crown,

And her arms along the deep proudly shone:  
By each gun the lighted brand  
In a bold, determined hand;  
And the prince of all the land  
Led them on.

Like leviathans afloat,  
Lay their Bulwarks on the brine,  
While the sign of battle flew  
O'er the lofty British line:  
It was ten of April morn by the chime,  
As they drifted on their path;  
There was silence deep as death,  
And the boldest held his breath  
For a time.

But the might of England flushed,  
To anticipate the scene;  
And her van the fleeter rushed  
O'er the deadly space between.  
Hearts of oak!' our captains cried; when each gun  
From its adamant lips  
Spread a death-shade round the ships,  
Like the hurricane eclipse  
Of the sun.

Again! again! again!  
And the havoc did not slack,  
Till a feebler cheer the Dane  
To our cheering sent us back;  
Their shots along the deep slowly boom:

Then ceased, and all is wail,  
As they strike the shattered sail;  
Or, in conflagration pale,  
Light the gloom.

Out spoke the victor then,  
As he hailed them o'er the wave:  
'Ye are brothers! we are men!  
And we conquer but to save:  
So peace instead of death let us bring;  
But yield, proud foe, thy fleet,  
With the crews, at England's feet,  
And make submission meet  
To our King.'

Then Denmark blessed our chief,  
That he gave her wounds repose;  
And the sounds of joy and grief  
From her people wildly rose,  
As death withdrew his shades from the day;  
While the sun looked smiling bright  
O'er a wide and woeful sight,  
Where the fires of funeral light  
Died away.

Now joy, Old England raise,  
For the tidings of thy might,  
By the festal cities' blaze,  
Whilst the wine-cup shines in light;  
And yet amidst that joy and uproar  
Let us think of them that sleep,

Full many a fathom deep,  
By thy wild and stormy steep,  
Elsinore!

Brave hearts! to Britain's pride  
Once so faithful and so true,  
On the deck of fame that died,  
With the gallant good Riou:  
Soft sigh the winds of heaven o'er their grave;  
While the billow mournful rolls,  
And the mermaid's song condoles,  
Singing glory to the souls  
Of the brave.

## **NAPOLEON AND THE SAILOR**

NAPOLEON'S banners at Boulogne  
Arm'd in our island every freeman,  
His navy chanced to capture one  
Poor British seaman.

They suffer'd him—I know not how—  
Unprison'd on the shore to roam;  
And aye was bent his longing brow  
On England's home.

His eye, methinks, pursued the flight  
Of birds to Britain half-way over;  
With envy they could reach the white  
Dear cliffs of Dover.

A stormy midnight watch, he thought,  
Than this sojourn would have been dearer,  
If but the storm his vessel brought  
To England nearer.

At last, when care had banish'd sleep,  
He saw one morning—dreaming—doating,  
An empty hogshead from the deep  
Come shoreward floating;

He hid it in a cave, and wrought  
The livelong day laborious; lurking  
Until he launch'd a tiny boat  
By mighty working.

Heaven help us! 'twas a thing beyond  
Description wretched: such a wherry  
Perhaps ne'er ventur'd on a pond,  
Or cross'd a ferry.

For ploughing in the salt sea-field,  
It would have made the boldest shudder;  
Untarr'd, uncompass'd, and unkeel'd,  
No sail—no rudder.

From neighbouring woods he interlaced  
His sorry skiff with wattled willows;  
And thus equipp'd he would have pass'd  
The foaming billows—  
But Frenchmen caught him on the beach,  
His little Argo sorely jeering;



Till tidings of him chanced to reach  
Napoleon's hearing.

With folded arms Napoleon stood,  
Serene alike in peace and danger;  
And in his wonted attitude,  
Address'd the stranger:—

Rash man that wouldst yon channel pass  
On twigs and staves so rudely fashion'd;  
Thy heart with some sweet British lass  
Must be impassion'd.'

'I have no sweetheart,' said the lad;  
But—absent long from one another—  
Great was the longing that I had  
To see my mother!'

'And so thou shalt,' Napoleon said,  
'Ye've both my favour fairly won;  
A noble mother must have bred  
So brave a son.'

He gave the tar a piece of gold,  
And with a flag of truce commanded  
He should be shipp'd to England Old,  
And safely landed.

Our sailor oft could scantily shift  
To find a dinner plain and hearty;  
But never changed the coin and gift  
Of Bonaparte.

## THE PARROT

A PARROT, from the Spanish main,  
Full young and early caged came o'er,  
With bright wings, to the bleak domain  
Of Mullah's shore.

To spicy groves where he had won  
His plumage of resplendent hue,  
His native fruits, and skies, and sun,  
He bade adieu.

For these he changed the smoke of turf,  
A heathery land and misty sky,  
And turned on rocks and raging surf  
His golden eye.

But petted in our climate cold,  
He lived and chattered many a day:  
Until with age, from green and gold  
His wings grew grey.

At last when blind, and seeming dumb,  
He scolded, laugh'd, and spoke no more,  
A Spanish stranger chanced to come  
To Mullah's shore;

He hail'd the bird in Spanish speech,  
The bird in Spanish speech replied;

Flapp'd round the cage with joyous screech,  
Dropt down, and died.

## **HOHENLINDEN**

ON Linden when the sun was low,  
All bloodless lay the untrodden snow;  
And dark as winter was the flow  
Of Iser rolling rapidly.

But Linden saw another sight  
When the drum beat at dead of night,  
Commanding fires of death to light  
The darkness of her scenery.

By torch and trumpet fast arrayed,  
Each horseman drew his battle blade,  
And furious every charger neigh'd  
To join the dreadful revelry.

Then shook the hill, with thunder riven;  
Then rushed the steed, to battle driven;  
And louder than the bolts of Heaven  
Far flashed the red artillery.

But redder yet that light shall glow  
On Linden's hills of stained snow,  
And bloodier yet the torrent flow  
Of Iser rolling rapidly.

'Tis morn, but scarce yon level sun  
Can pierce the war-clouds, rolling dun,

Where furious Frank and fiery Hun  
Shout in their sulph'rous canopy.

The combat deepens. On, ye brave,  
Who rush to glory or the grave!  
Wave, Munich, all thy banners wave,  
And charge with all thy chivalry.

Few, few shall part where many meet;  
The snow shall be their winding-sheet;  
And every turf beneath their feet  
Shall be a soldier's sepulchre.

## **MEN OF ENGLAND**

MEN of England! who inherit  
Rights that cost your sires their blood  
Men whose undegenerate spirit  
Has been proved on land and flood:

Yours are Hampden's, Russell's glory,  
Sidney's matchless shade is yours,—  
Martyrs in heroic story,  
Worth a thousand Agincourts!

We're the sons of sires that baffled  
Crown'd and mitred tyranny:  
They defied the field and scaffold,  
For their birthright—so will we.

*JAMES HOGG*

**WHEN THE KYE COMES HAME**

COME all ye jolly shepherds  
That whistle through the glen,  
I'll tell ye of a secret  
That courtiers dinna ken;  
What is the greatest bliss  
That the tongue o' man can name?  
'Tis to woo a bonny lassie  
When the kye comes hame.

When the kye comes hame,  
When the kye comes hame,  
Tween the gloamin' and the mirk,  
When the kye comes hame.

'Tis not beneath the coronet,  
Nor canopy of state,  
'Tis not on couch of velvet,  
Nor arbour of the great—  
'Tis beneath the spreading birk,  
In the glen without the name,  
Wi' a bonny, bonny lassie,  
When the kye comes hame.

See yonder pawky shepherd  
That lingers on the hill—  
His yowes are in the fauld,  
And his lambs are lying still;

Yet he downa gang to bed,  
For his heart is in a flame  
To meet his bonny lassie  
When the kye comes hame.

When the little wee bit heart  
Rises high in the breast,  
And the little wee bit stars  
Rise bright in the east,  
O there's a joy sae dear,  
That the heart can hardly frame,  
Wi' a bonny, bonny lassie,  
When the kye comes hame.

Then since all nature joins  
In this love without alloy,  
O' wha wad prove a traitor  
To nature's dearest joy?  
Or wha wad choose a crown,  
Wi' its pearls and its fame,  
And miss his bonny lassie  
When the kye comes hame?  
When the kye comes hame,  
When the kye comes hame,  
'Tween the gloamin' and the mirk,  
When the kye comes hame.

## **THE SKYLARK**

BIRD of the wilderness,  
Blithesome and cumberless,

Sweet be thy matin o'er moorland and lea!  
Emblem of happiness,  
Blest is thy dwelling-place—  
O to abide in the desert with thee!  
Wild is thy lay and loud,  
Far in the downy cloud,  
Love gives it energy, love gave it birth,  
Where, on thy dewy wing,  
Where art thou journeying?  
Thy lay is in heaven, thy love is on earth.

O'er fell and fountain sheen,  
O'er moor and mountain green,  
O'er the red streamer that heralds the day,  
Over the cloudlet dim,  
Over the rainbow's rim,  
Musical cherub, soar, singing, away!  
Then, when the gloaming comes,  
Low in the heather blooms,  
Sweet will thy welcome and bed of love be!  
Emblem of happiness,  
Blest is thy dwelling-place—  
O to abide in the desert with thee!

*ALLAN CUNNINGHAM*

**THE YOUNG MAXWELL**

'WHERE gang ye, thou silly auld carle?  
And what do you carry there?'  
I'm gaun to the hillside, thou sodger gentleman,  
To shift my sheep their lair.'

Ae stride or twa took the silly auld carle,  
An' a gude lang stride took he:  
'I trow thou to be a feck auld carle,  
Will ye shaw the way to me?'

And he has gane wi' the silly auld carle,  
Adown by the greenwood side;  
'Light down and gang, thou sodger gentleman,  
For here ye canny ride.'

He drew the reins o' his bonny gray steed,  
An' lightly down he sprang:  
Of the comeliest scarlet was his weir coat,  
Whare the gowden tassels hang.

He has thrown aff his plaid, the silly auld carle,  
An' his bonnet frae 'boon his bree;  
An' wha was it but the young Maxwell!  
An' his gude brown sword drew he!

'Thou killed my father, thou vile South'ron!  
An' ye killed my brethren three!  
Whilk brake the heart o' my ae sister,  
I loved as the light o' my e'e!

'Draw out thy sword, thou vile South'ron  
Red wat wi' blude o' my kin!



That sword it crapped the bonniest flower  
E'er lifted its head to the sun!

'There's ae sad stroke for my dear auld father!  
There's twa for my brethren three!  
An' there's ane to thy heart for my ae sister,  
Wham I loved as the light o' my e'e.'

### **HAME, HAME, HAME**

HAME, hame, hame, hame fain wad I be,  
O hame, hame, hame, to my ain countrie!  
When the flower is i' the bud, and the leaf is on the tree,  
The larks shall sing me hame in my ain countrie;  
Hame, hame, hame, hame fain wad I be,  
O hame, hame, hame, to my ain countrie!

The green leaf o' loyalty's begun for to fa',  
The bonny white rose it is withering an' a';  
But I'll water't wi' the blude of usurping tyrannie,  
An' green it will grow in my ain countrie.  
Hame, hame, hame, hame fain wad I be,  
O hame, hame, hame to my ain countrie!

O there's naught frae ruin my country can save,  
But the keys o' kind heaven to open the grave,  
That a' the noble martyrs wha died for loyaltie,  
May rise again and fight for their ain countrie.  
Hame, hame, hame, hame fain wad I be,  
O hame, hame, hame, to my ain countrie!

The great are now gane, a' wha ventured to save,  
The new grass is springing on the tap o' their grave;  
But the sun through the mirk blinks blithe in my e'e,  
'T'll shine on ye yet in yer ain countrie.'  
Hame, hame, hame, hame fain wad I be,  
Hame, hame, hame, to my ain countrie.

### **A WET SHEET AND A FLOWING SEA**

A WET sheet and a flowing sea,  
A wind that follows fast,  
And fills the white and rustling sail,  
And bends the gallant mast;  
And bends the gallant mast, my boys,  
While, like the eagle free,  
Away the good ship flies, and leaves  
Old England on the lee.

O for a soft and gentle wind!  
I heard a landsman cry;  
But give to me the snoring breeze,  
And white waves heaving high;  
And white waves heaving high, my boys,  
The good ship tight and free—  
The world of waters is our home,  
And merry men are we.

There's tempest in yon horned moon,  
And lightning in yon cloud;  
And hark the music, mariners,  
The wind is piping loud;

The wind is piping loud, my boys,  
The lightning flashing free—  
While the hollow oak our palace is,  
Our heritage the sea.

## **MY NANIE O**

RED rows the Nith 'tween bank and brae,  
Mirk is the night and rainie O,  
Though heaven and earth should mix in storm,  
I'll gang and see my Nanie O;  
My Nanie O, my Nanie O;  
My kind and winsome Nanie O,  
She holds my heart in love's dear bands,  
And nane can do't but Nanie O.

In preaching-time sae meek she stands,  
Sae saintly and sae bonny O,  
I cannot get ae glimpse of grace,  
For thieving looks at Nanie O;  
My Nanie O, my Nanie O;  
The world's in love with Nanie O;  
That heart is hardly worth the wear  
That wadna love my Nanie O.

My breast can scarce contain my heart,  
When dancing she moves finely O;  
I guess what heaven is by her eyes,  
They sparkle sae divinely O;  
My Nanie O, my Nanie O,  
The flower o' Nithsdale's Nanie O;

Love looks frae 'neath her lang brown hair,  
And says, I dwell with Nanie O.

Tell not, thou star at grey daylight,  
O'er Tinwald-tap sae bonny O,  
My footsteps 'mang the morning dew  
When coming frae my Nanie O;  
My Nanie O, my Nanie O;  
Nane ken o' me and Nanie O;  
The stars and moon may tell't aboon,  
They winna wrang my Nanie O!

*THOMAS MOORE*

### **CANADIAN BOAT-SONG**

FAINTLY as tolls the evening chime,  
Our voices keep tune and our oars keep time.  
Soon as the woods on shore look dim,  
We'll sing at St. Ann's our parting hymn.  
Row, brothers, row! the stream runs fast,  
The rapids are near, and the daylight's past!

Why should we yet our sail unfurl?  
There's not a breath the blue wave to curl!  
But, when the wind blows off the shore,  
Oh, sweetly we'll rest our weary oar.  
Blow, breezes, blow! the stream runs fast,  
The rapids are near, and the daylight's past!

Ottawa's tide! this trembling moon  
Shall see us float o'er thy surges soon.  
Saint of this green isle, hear our prayers,  
Oh, grant us cool heavens and favouring airs.  
Blow, breezes, blow! the stream runs fast,  
The rapids are near, and the daylight's past.

### **GO WHERE GLORY WAITS THEE**

Go where glory waits thee,  
But while fame elates thee,  
Oh, still remember me.  
When the praise thou meetest  
To thine ear is sweetest,  
Oh, then remember me.  
Other arms may press thee,  
Dearer friends caress thee,  
All the joys that bless thee  
Sweeter far may be;  
But when friends are nearest,  
And when joys are dearest,  
Oh, then remember me.

When at eve thou rovest  
By the star thou lovest,  
Oh, then remember me.  
Think, when home returning,  
Bright we've seen it burning.  
Oh, thus remember me.  
Oft as summer closes,

When thine eye reposes  
On its lingering roses,  
Once so loved by thee,  
Think of her who wove them,  
Her who made thee love them,  
Oh, then remember me.

When, around thee dying,  
Autumn leaves are lying,  
Oh, then remember me.  
And, at night, when gazing  
On the gay hearth blazing,  
Oh, still remember me.  
Then, should music, stealing  
All the soul of feeling,  
To thy heart appealing,  
Draw one tear from thee;  
Then let memory bring thee  
Strains I used to sing thee,  
Oh, then remember me.

### **THE HARP THAT ONCE THROUGH TARA'S HALLS**

THE harp that once through Tara's halls,  
The soul of music shed,  
Now hangs as mute on Tara's walls  
As if that soul were fled.  
So sleeps the pride of former days,  
So glory's thrill is o'er,

And hearts, that once beat high for praise,  
Now feel that pulse no more.

No more to chiefs and ladies bright  
The harp of Tara swells:  
The chord alone, that breaks at night,  
Its tale of ruin tells.  
Thus Freedom now so seldom wakes,  
The only throb she gives  
Is when some heart indignant breaks,  
To show that still she lives.

### **RICH AND RARE WERE THE GEMS SHE WORE**

RICH and rare were the gems she wore,  
And a bright gold ring on her wand she bore;  
But, oh! her beauty was far beyond  
Her sparkling gems or snow-white wand.

'Lady, dost thou not fear to stray,  
So lone and lovely, through this bleak way?  
Are Erin's sons so good or so cold,  
As not to be tempted by woman or gold?'

Sir Knight! I feel not the least alarm,  
No son of Erin will offer me harm:  
For, though they love women and golden store  
Sir Knight! they love honour and virtue more.

On she went, and her maiden smile  
In safety lighted her round the green isle;

And blest for ever is she who relied  
Upon Erin's honour and Erin's pride.

### **THE MEETING OF THE WATERS**

THERE is not in the wide world a valley so sweet,  
As that vale in whose bosom the bright waters meet;  
Oh! the last rays of feeling and life must depart,  
Ere the bloom of that valley shall fade from my heart.

Yet it was not that Nature had shed o'er the scene  
Her purest of crystal and brightest of green;  
'Twas not her soft magic of streamlet or hill,  
Oh! No—it was something more exquisite still.

'Twas that friends, the beloved of my bosom, were near,  
Who made every dear scene of enchantment more dear,  
And who felt how the best charms of Nature improve,  
When we see them reflected from looks that we love.

### **SHE IS FAR FROM THE LAND**

SHE is far from the land where her young hero sleeps,  
And lovers are round her sighing;  
But coldly she turns from their gaze, and weeps,  
For her heart in his grave is lying.

She sings the wild songs of her dear native plains,  
Every note which he loved awaking;—  
Ah! little they think, who delight in her strains,  
How the heart of the Minstrel is breaking.



He had lived for his love, for his country he died,  
They were all that to life had entwined him;  
Nor soon shall the tears of his country be dried,  
Nor long will his love stay behind him.

Oh! make her a grave where the sunbeams rest  
When they promise a glorious morrow;  
They'll shine o'er her sleep, like a smile from the West,  
From her own loved island of sorrow.

### **BELIEVE ME, IF ALL THOSE ENDEARING YOUNG CHARMS**

BELIEVE me, if all those endearing young charms  
Which I gaze on so fondly to-day,  
Were to change by to-morrow, and fleet in my arms,  
Like fairy-gifts fading away,  
Thou wouldst still be adored, as this moment thou art,  
Let thy loveliness fade as it will,  
And around the dear ruin each wish of my heart  
Would entwine itself verdantly still.

It is not while beauty and youth are thine own,  
And thy cheeks unprofaned by a tear,  
That the fervour and faith of a soul can be known,  
To which time will but make thee more dear;  
No, the heart that has truly loved never forgets,  
But as truly loves on to the close,  
As the sun-flower turns on her god, when he sets,  
The same look which she turned when he rose.

## LOVE'S YOUNG DREAM

OH, the days are gone, when Beauty bright  
My heart's chain wove;  
When my dream of life from morn till night  
Was love, still love.  
New hope may bloom,  
And days may come  
Of milder, calmer beam,  
But there's nothing half so sweet in life  
As love's young dream;  
No, there's nothing half so sweet in life  
As love's young dream.

Though the bard to purer fame may soar,  
When wild youth's past;  
Though he wins the wise, who frown'd before,  
To smile at last;  
He'll never meet  
A joy so sweet,  
In all his noon of fame,  
As when first he sung to woman's ear  
His soul-felt flame,  
And, at every close, she blushed to hear  
The one loved name.

No—that hallowed form is ne'er forgot  
Which first love traced;  
Still it lingering haunts the greenest spot  
On memory's waste.  
'Twas odour fled

As soon as shed;  
'Twas morning's winged dream;  
'Twas a light there ne'er can shine again  
On life's dull stream:  
Oh!'twas light that ne'er can shine again  
On life's dull stream.

### **THE LAST ROSE OF SUMMER**

'Tis the last rose of summer  
Left blooming alone;  
All her lovely companions  
Are faded and gone;  
No flower of her kindred,  
No rosebud is nigh,  
To reflect back her blushes,  
To give sigh for sigh.

I'll not leave thee, thou lone one,  
To pine on the stem;  
Since the lovely are sleeping,  
Go sleep thou with them.  
Thus kindly I scatter  
Thy leaves o'er the bed,  
Where thy mates of the garden  
Lie scentless and dead.

So soon may I follow,  
When friendships decay,  
And from love's shining circle  
The gems drop away!

When true hearts lie withered  
And fond ones are flown,  
Oh, who would inhabit  
This bleak world alone?

### **THE MINSTREL-BOY**

THE Minstrel-boy to the war is gone,  
In the ranks of death you'll find him;  
His father's sword he has girded on,  
And his wild harp slung behind him.—  
'Land of song!' said the warrior-bard,  
'Though all the world betrays thee,  
One sword, at least, thy rights shall guard,  
One faithful harp shall praise thee!'

The Minstrel fell—but the foeman's chain  
Could not bring his proud soul under;  
The harp he loved ne'er spoke again,  
For he tore its cords asunder;  
And said, 'No chains shall sully thee,  
Thou soul of love and bravery!  
Thy songs were made for the brave and free,  
They shall never sound in slavery!'

### **THE TIME I'VE LOST IN WOOING**

THE time I've lost in wooing,  
In watching and pursuing  
The light that lies

In woman's eyes,  
Has been my heart's undoing.

Though Wisdom oft has sought me,  
I scorned the lore she brought me,  
My only books  
Were women's looks,  
And folly's all they've taught me.

Her smile when Beauty granted,  
I hung with gaze enchanted,  
Like him the Sprite  
Whom maids by night  
Oft meet in glen that's haunted.

Like him, too, Beauty won me;  
But while her eyes were on me,  
If once their ray  
Was turned away,  
Oh, winds could not outrun me.

And are those follies going?  
And is my proud heart growing  
Too cold or wise  
For brilliant eyes  
Again to set it glowing?

No—vain, alas! th'endeavour  
From bonds so sweet to sever;—  
Poor Wisdom's chance  
Against a glance  
Is now as weak as ever.

## THE LIGHT OF OTHER DAYS

OFT in the stilly night  
Ere slumber's chain has bound me,  
Fond Memory brings the light  
Of other days around me:  
The smiles, the tears  
Of boyhood's years,  
The words of love then spoken;  
The eyes that shone,  
Now dimm'd and gone,  
The cheerful hearts now broken!

Thus in the stilly night  
Ere slumber's chain has bound me,  
Sad Memory brings the light  
Of other days around me.  
When I remember all  
The friends so link'd together,  
I've seen around me fall  
Like leaves in wintry weather,  
I feel like one  
Who treads alone  
Some banquet-hall deserted,  
Whose lights are fled  
Whose garlands dead  
And all but he departed!  
Thus in the stilly night  
Ere slumber's chain has bound me,  
Sad Memory brings the light  
Of other days around me.

*LORD BYRON*

## **THE DESTRUCTION OF SENNACHERIB**

THE Assyrian came down like the wolf on the fold,  
And his cohorts were gleaming in purple and gold;  
And the sheen of their spears was like stars on the sea,  
When the blue wave rolls nightly on deep Galilee.

Like the leaves of the forest when Summer is green,  
That host with their banners at sunset were seen:  
Like the leaves of the forest when Autumn hath blown,  
That host on the morrow lay withered and strown.

For the Angel of Death spread his wings on the blast,  
And breathed in the face of the foe as he passed;  
And the eyes of the sleepers waxed deadly and chill,  
And their hearts but once heaved, and for ever grew still!

And there lay the steed with his nostrils all wide,  
But through it there rolled not the breath of his pride:  
And the foam of his gasping lay white on the turf,  
And cold as the spray of the rock-beating surf.

And there lay the rider distorted and pale,  
With the dew on his brow and the rust on his mail;  
And the tents were all silent, the banners alone,  
The lances unlifted, the trumpet unblown.

And the widows of Ashur are loud in their wail,  
And the idols are broke in the temple of Baal;

And the might of the Gentile, unsmote by the sword,  
Hath melted like snow in the glance of the Lord!

### **WHEN WE TWO PARTED**

WHEN we two parted  
In silence and tears,  
Half broken-hearted  
To sever for years,  
Pale grew thy cheek and cold,  
Colder thy kiss;  
Truly that hour foretold  
Sorrow to this.

The dew of the morning  
Sank chill on my brow—  
It felt like the warning  
Of what I feel now.  
Thy vows are all broken,  
And light is thy fame;  
I hear thy name spoken,  
And share in its shame.

They name thee before me,  
A knell to mine ear;  
A shudder comes o'er me  
Why wert thou so dear?  
They know not I knew thee,  
Who knew thee too well:  
Long, long shall I rue thee,  
Too deeply to tell.



In secret we met—  
In silence I grieve,  
That thy heart could forget,  
Thy spirit deceive.  
If I should meet thee  
After long years,  
How should I greet thee?—  
With silence and tears.

## **SONG**

THERE be none of Beauty's daughters  
With a magic like thee;  
And like music on the waters  
Is thy sweet voice to me:  
When, as if its sound were causing  
The charmed ocean's pausing,  
The waves lie still and gleaming,  
And the lull'd winds seem dreaming:

And the midnight moon is weaving  
Her bright chain o'er the deep;  
Whose breast is gently heaving,  
As an infant's asleep:  
So the spirit bows before thee,  
To listen and adore thee;  
With a full but soft emotion,  
Like the swell of Summer's ocean.

## **WE'LL GO NO MORE A-ROVING**

So, we'll go no more a-roving  
So late into the night,  
Though the heart be still as loving,  
And the moon be still as bright.

For the sword outwears its sheath,  
And the soul wears out the breast,  
And the heart must pause to breathe,  
And love itself have rest.

Though the night was made for loving,  
And the day returns too soon,  
Yet we'll go no more a-roving  
By the light of the moon.

### **SHE WALKS IN BEAUTY**

SHE walks in beauty, like the night  
Of cloudless climes, and starry skies:  
And all that's best of dark and bright  
Meet in her aspect and her eyes:  
Thus mellowed to that tender light  
Which Heaven to gaudy day denies.

One shade the more, one ray the less,  
Had half impaired the nameless grace,  
Which waves in every raven tress,  
Or softly lightens o'er her face;  
Where thoughts serenely sweet express,  
How pure, how dear their dwelling-place.

And on that cheek, and o'er that brow,  
So soft, so calm, yet eloquent,  
The smiles that win, the tints that glow,  
But tell of days in goodness spent.  
A mind at peace with all below,  
A heart whose love is innocent!

*B. W. PROCTER*

**KING DEATH**

KING DEATH was a rare old fellow,  
He sat where no sun could shine,  
And he lifted his hand so yellow,  
And poured out his coal-black wine!  
Hurrah, for the coal-black wine!

There came to him many a maiden  
Whose eyes had forgot to shine,  
And widows with grief o'erladen,  
For a draught of his coal-black wine.  
Hurrah, for the coal-black wine!

The scholar left all his learning,  
The poet his fancied woes,  
And the beauty her bloom returning,  
Like life to the fading rose.  
Hurrah, for the coal-black wine!

All came to the rare old fellow,  
Who laughed till his eyes dropped brine,  
And he gave them his hand so yellow,  
And pledged them in Death's black wine.  
Hurrah, for the coal-black wine!

## **SONG FOR TWILIGHT**

HIDE me, O twilight air,  
Hide me from thought, from care,  
From all things foul or fair,  
Until to-morrow!  
To-night I strive no more;  
No more my soul shall soar:  
Come, sleep, and shut the door  
'Gainst pain and sorrow!

If I must see through dreams,  
Be mine Elysian gleams,  
Be mine by morning streams  
To watch and wander;  
So may my spirit cast  
(Serpent-like) off the past,  
And my free soul at last  
Have leave to ponder.

And shouldst thou 'scape control,  
Ponder on love, sweet soul;  
On joy, the end and goal  
Of all endeavour:  
But if earth's pains will rise,

(As damps will seek the skies,)
Then, night, seal thou mine eyes,
In sleep for ever.

*CHARLES WOLFE*

### **THE BURIAL OF SIR JOHN MOORE AT CORUNNA**

Nor a drum was heard, not a funeral note,  
As his corpse to the rampart we hurried;  
Not a soldier discharged his farewell shot  
O'er the grave where our hero we buried.

We buried him darkly at dead of night,  
The sods with our bayonets turning;  
By the struggling moonbeam's misty light  
And the lantern dimly burning.

No useless coffin enclosed his breast,  
Not in sheet or in shroud we wound him;  
But he lay like a warrior taking his rest,  
With his martial cloak around him.

Few and short were the prayers we said,  
And we spoke not a word of sorrow;  
But we steadfastly gazed on the face that was dead,  
And we bitterly thought of the morrow.

We thought, as we hollow'd his narrow bed  
And smoothed down his lonely pillow,

That the foe and the stranger would tread o'er his head,  
And we far away on the billow!

Lightly they'll talk of the spirit that's gone  
And o'er his cold ashes upbraid him,—  
But little he'll reck, if they let him sleep on  
In the grave where a Briton has laid him.

But half of our heavy task was done  
When the clock struck the hour for retiring:  
And we heard the distant and random gun  
That the foe was sullenly firing.

Slowly and sadly we laid him down,  
From the field of his fame fresh and gory;  
We carved not a line, and we raised not a stone,  
But we left him alone with his glory.

## *PERCY BYSSHE SHELLEY*

### **I ARISE FROM DREAMS OF THEE**

I ARISE from dreams of thee,  
In the first sweet sleep of night,  
When the winds are breathing low,  
And the stars are shining bright;  
I arise from dreams of thee,  
And a spirit in my feet  
Has led me—who knows how?  
To thy chamber-window, Sweet.

The wandering airs they faint  
On the dark, the silent stream,—  
The champetre odours fail,  
Like sweet thoughts in a dream,  
The nightingale's complaint  
It dies upon her heart,  
As I must die on thine,  
O beloved as thou art!

O lift me from the grass!  
I die, I faint, I fail.  
Let thy love in kisses rain  
On my lips and eyelids pale.  
My cheek is cold and white, alas!  
My heart beats loud and fast.  
Oh! press it close to thine again,  
Where it will break at last.

## **LAMENT**

O WORLD! O life! O time!  
On whose last steps I climb,  
Trembling at that where I had stood before;  
When will return the glory of your prime?  
No more—oh, never more!

Out of the day and night  
A joy has taken flight:  
Fresh spring, and summer, and winter hoar,  
Move my faint heart with grief, but with delight  
No more—oh, never more!

## **LOVE'S PHILOSOPHY**

THE fountains mingle with the river,  
And the rivers with the ocean,  
The winds of heaven mix for ever  
With a sweet emotion;  
Nothing in the world is single;  
All things by a law divine  
In one another's being mingle—  
Why not I with thine?

See the mountains kiss high heaven,  
And the waves clasp one another;  
No sister flower would be forgiven  
If it disdained its brother:  
And the sunlight clasps the earth,  
And the moonbeams kiss the sea;—  
What are all these kissings worth,  
If thou kiss not me?

## **HYMN OF PAN**

FROM the forests and highlands  
We come, we come;  
From the river-girt islands,  
Where loud waves are dumb,  
Listening to my sweet pipings.  
The wind in the reeds and the rushes,  
The bees on the bells of thyme,  
The birds on the myrtle bushes,  
The cicale above in the lime,



And the lizards below in the grass,  
Were as silent as ever old Tmolus was,  
Listening to my sweet pipings.

Liquid Peneus was flowing,  
And all dark Tempe lay  
In Pelion's shadow, outgrowing  
The light of the dying day,  
SPEEDED by my sweet pipings.  
The Sileni and Sylvans and Fauns,  
And the Nymphs of the woods and waves,  
To the edge of the moist river-lawns,  
And the brink of the dewy caves,  
And all that did then attend and follow,  
Were silent with love, as you now, Apollo,  
With envy of my sweet pipings.

I sang of the dancing stars,  
I sang of the daedal earth,  
And of heaven, and the giant wars,  
And love, and death, and birth.  
And then I changed my pipings  
Singing how down the vale of Maenalus  
I pursued a maiden, and clasp'd a reed:  
Gods and men, we are all deluded thus;  
It breaks in our bosom, and then we bleed.  
All wept—as I think both ye now would,  
If envy or age had not frozen your blood—  
At the sorrow of my sweet pipings.

*JOHN KEATS*

**LA BELLE DAME SANS MERCI**

'O WHAT can ail thee, knight-at-arms,  
Alone and palely loitering?  
The sedge has wither'd from the lake,  
And no birds sing.

'O what can ail thee, knight-at-arms!  
So haggard and so woe-begone?  
The squirrel's granary is full,  
And the harvest's done.

'I see a lily on thy brow  
With anguish moist and fever-dew.  
And on thy cheeks a fading rose  
Fast withereth too.'

'I met a lady in the meads,  
Full beautiful—a faery's child,  
Her hair was long, her foot was light,  
And her eyes were wild.

'I made a garland for her head,  
And bracelets too, and fragrant zone;  
She look'd at me as she did love,  
And made sweet moan.

'I set her on my pacing steed  
And nothing else saw all day long,

For sidelong would she bend, and sing  
A faery's song.

'She found me roots of relish sweet,  
And honey wild and manna-dew,  
And sure in language strange she said,  
"I love thee true."

'She took me to her elfin grot,  
And there she wept and sigh'd full sore;  
And there I shut her wild wild eyes  
With kisses four.

'And there she lulled me asleep,  
And there I dream'd—Ah! woe betide  
The latest dream I ever dream'd  
On the cold hill's side.

'I saw pale kings and princes too,  
Pale warriors, death-pale were they all:  
They cried—"La belle Dame sans Merci  
Hath thee in thrall!"

'I saw their starved lips in the gloam  
With horrid warning gaped wide,  
And I awoke and found me here  
On the cold hill's side.

'And this is why I sojourn here  
Alone and palely loitering,  
Though the sedge is wither'd from the lake,  
And no birds sing.'

## *THOMAS HOLCROFT*

### **GAFFER GRAY**

HO, why dost thou shiver and shake,  
Gaffer Gray?  
And why does thy nose look so blue?  
'Tis the weather that's cold,  
'Tis I'm grown very old,  
And my doublet is not very new,  
Well-a-day!'

Then line thy worn doublet with ale,  
Gaffer Gray;  
And warm thy old heart with a glass.  
Nay, but credit I've none,  
And my money's all gone;  
Then say how may that come to pass?  
Well-a-day!'

Hie away to the house on the brow,  
Gaffer Gray;  
And knock at the jolly priest's door.  
'The priest often preaches  
Against worldly riches,  
But ne'er gives a mite to the poor,  
Well-a-day!'

The lawyer lives under the hill,  
Gaffer Gray;  
Warmly fenced both in back and in front.

'He will fasten his locks,  
And will threaten the stocks  
Should he ever more find me in want,  
Well-a-day!'

The squire has fat beeves and brown ale,  
Gaffer Gray;  
And the season will welcome you there.  
'His fat beeves and his beer,  
And his merry new year,  
Are all for the flush and the fair,  
Well-a-day!'

My keg is but low, I confess,  
Gaffer Gray;  
What then? While it lasts, man, we'll live.'  
The poor man alone,  
When he hears the poor moan,  
Of his morsel a morsel will give,  
Well-a-day!'

*FELICIA HEMANS*

### **THE PILGRIM FATHERS**

THE breaking waves dash'd high  
On a stern and rock-bound coast;  
And the woods, against a stormy sky,  
Their giant branches toss'd;

And the heavy night hung dark,  
The hills and waters o'er,  
When a band of exiles moor'd their bark  
On the wild New England shore.

Not as the conqueror comes,  
They, the true-hearted, came;  
Not with the roll of the stirring drums,  
And the trumpet that sings of fame;—

Not as the flying come,  
In silence, and in fear;—  
They shook the depths of the desert's gloom  
With their hymns of lofty cheer.

Amidst the storm they sang:  
Till the stars heard, and the sea;  
And the sounding aisles of the dim woods rang,  
To the anthem of the free.

The ocean-eagle soar'd  
From his nest, by the white wave's foam,  
And the rocking pines of the forest roar'd:  
Such was their welcome home.

There were men with hoary hair  
Amidst that pilgrim band:  
Why had they come to wither there,  
Away from their childhood's land?

There was woman's fearless eye,  
Lit by her deep love's truth;

There was manhood's brow serenely high,  
And the fiery heart of youth.

What sought they thus afar?  
Bright jewels of the mine?  
The wealth of seas? the spoils of war?—  
No—'twas a faith's pure shrine.

Yes, call it holy ground,  
Which first their brave feet trod!  
They have left unstain'd what there they found—  
Freedom to worship God!

## **THE VOICE OF SPRING**

I COME, I come! ye have called me long,  
I come o'er the mountains with light and song;  
Ye may trace my step o'er the wakening earth,  
By the winds which tell of the violet's birth,  
By the primrose stars in the shadowy grass,  
By the green leaves opening as I pass.

I have breathed on the South, and the chestnut-flowers  
By thousands have burst from the forest-bowers;  
And the ancient graves, and the fallen fanes,  
Are veiled with wreaths on Italian plains.  
—But it is not for me, in my hour of bloom,  
To speak of the ruin or the tomb!

I have passed o'er the hills of the stormy North,  
And the larch has hung all his tassels forth,

The fisher is out on the sunny sea,  
And the rein-deer bounds through the pasture free,  
And the pine has a fringe of softer green,  
And the moss looks bright where my step has been.

I have sent through the wood-paths a gentle sigh,  
And called out each voice of the deep-blue sky,  
From the night-bird's lay through the starry time,  
In the groves of the soft Hesperian clime,  
To the swan's wild note by the Iceland lakes,  
When the dark fir-bough into verdure breaks.

From the streams and founts I have loosed the chain:  
They are sweeping on to the silvery main,  
They are flashing down from the mountain-brows,  
They are flinging spray on the forest-boughs,  
They are bursting fresh from their sparry caves,  
And the earth resounds with the joy of waves.

Come forth, O ye children of gladness, come!  
Where the violets lie may now be your home.  
Ye of the rose-cheek and dew-bright eye,  
And the bounding footstep, to meet me fly,  
With the lyre, and the wreath, and the joyous lay,  
Come forth to the sunshine,—I may not stay.

Away from the dwellings of care-worn men,  
The waters are sparkling in wood and glen;  
Away from the chamber and dusky hearth,  
The young leaves are dancing in breezy mirth,  
Their light stems thrill to the wild-wood strains,  
And Youth is abroad in my green domains.



## THE HOMES OF ENGLAND

THE stately homes of England,  
How beautiful they stand,  
Amidst their tall ancestral trees,  
O'er all the pleasant land!  
The deer across their greensward bound  
Through shade and sunny gleam,  
And the swan glides past them with the sound  
Of some rejoicing stream.

The merry homes of England—  
Around their hearths by night,  
What gladsome looks of household love  
Meet in the ruddy light!  
There woman's voice flows forth in song,  
Or childhood's tale is told;  
Or lips move tunefully along  
Some glorious page of old.

The blessed homes of England,  
How softly on their bowers,  
Is laid the holy quietness  
That breathes from Sabbath hours!  
Solemn, yet sweet, the church bells' chime  
Floats through their woods at morn,  
All other sounds in that still time  
Of breeze and leaf are born.

The cottage homes of England  
By thousands on her plains,

They are smiling o'er the silvery brooks,  
And round the hamlet fanes.  
Through glowing orchards forth they peep,  
Each from its nook of leaves,  
And fearless there the lowly sleep,  
As the bird beneath their eaves.

The free fair homes of England,  
Long, long, in hut and hall,  
May hearts of native proof be reared  
To guard each hallowed wall.  
And green for ever be the groves,  
And bright the flowery sod,  
Where first the child's glad spirit loves  
Its country and its God.

### **THE CHILD'S FIRST GRIEF**

'OH, call my brother back to me!  
I cannot play alone;  
The summer comes with flower and bee—  
Where is my brother gone?

'The butterfly is glancing bright  
Across the sunbeam's track;  
I care not now to chase its flight  
Oh, call my brother back!

'The flowers run wild—  
the flowers we sow'd  
Around our garden tree;

Our vine is drooping with its load  
Oh, call him back to me!

'He could not hear thy voice, fair child,  
He may not come to thee;  
The face that once like spring-time smiled,  
On earth no more thou'lt see.

'A rose's brief bright life of joy,  
Such unto him was given;  
Go—thou must play alone, my boy!  
Thy brother is in heaven!'

'And has he left his birds and flowers,  
And must I call in vain?  
And, through the long, long summer hours,  
Will he not come again?

'And by the brook, and in the glade,  
Are all our wanderings o'er?  
Oh, while my brother with me play'd,  
Would I had loved him more!'

## **THE GRAVES OF A HOUSEHOLD**

THEY grew in beauty side by side,  
They filled one home with glee,  
Their graves are severed far and wide,  
By mount, and stream, and sea.  
The same fond mother bent at night  
O'er each fair sleeping brow,

She had each folded flower in sight,  
Where are those dreamers now?

One midst the forests of the West,  
By a dark stream, is laid;  
The Indian knows his place of rest  
Far in the cedar's shade.  
The sea, the blue lone sea, hath one,  
He lies where pearls lie deep,  
He was the loved of all, yet none  
O'er his low bed may weep.

One sleeps where southern vines are drest  
Above the noble slain;  
He wrapt his colours round his breast  
On a blood-red field of Spain.  
And one, o'er her the myrtle showers  
Its leaves, by soft winds fann'd;  
She faded midst Italian flowers,  
The last of that bright band.

And, parted thus, they rest—who played  
Beneath the same green tree,  
Whose voices mingled as they prayed  
Around one parent knee!  
They that with smiles lit up the hall,  
And cheered with song the hearth,  
Alas for love, if thou wert all,  
And nought beyond, oh earth!

**CASABIANCA**

THE boy stood on the burning deck,  
Whence all but him had fled;  
The flame that lit the battle's wreck,  
Shone round him o'er the dead.

Yet beautiful and bright he stood,  
As born to rule the storm;  
A creature of heroic blood,  
A proud, though child-like form.

The flames roll'd on—he would not go,  
Without his father's word;  
That father, faint in death below,  
His voice no longer heard.

He call'd aloud—'Say, father, say  
If yet my task is done?'  
He knew not that the chieftain lay  
Unconscious of his son.

'Speak, father!' once again he cried,  
If I may yet be gone!'  
—And but the booming shots replied,  
And fast the flames roll'd on.

Upon his brow he felt their breath,  
And in his waving hair;  
And look'd from that lone post of death,  
In still, yet brave despair:

And shouted but once more aloud,  
'My father! must I stay?'

While o'er him fast, through sail and shroud  
The wreathing fires made way.  
They wrapt the ship in splendour wild,  
They caught the flag on high,  
And stream'd above the gallant child,  
Like banners in the sky.

There came a burst of thunder sound—  
The boy—oh, where was he?  
—Ask of the winds that far around  
With fragments strew'd the sea!

*THOMAS HOOD*

### **THE DREAM OF EUGENE ARAM**

'Twas in the prime of summer time,  
An evening calm and cool,  
And four-and-twenty happy boys  
Came bounding out of school:  
There were some that ran, and some that leapt,  
Like troutlets in a pool.

Away they sped with gamesome minds,  
And souls untouch'd by sin;  
To a level mead they came, and there  
They drave the wickets in;  
Pleasantly shone the setting sun  
Over the town of Lynn.

Like sportive deer they coursed about,  
And shouted as they ran—  
Turning to mirth all things of earth,  
As only boyhood can:  
But the usher sat remote from all,  
A melancholy man.

His hat was off, his vest apart,  
To catch heaven's blessed breeze;  
For a burning thought was in his brow,  
And his bosom ill at ease:  
So he lean'd his head on his hands, and read  
The book between his knees.

Leaf after leaf he turn'd it o'er,  
Nor ever glanced aside;  
For the peace of his soul he read that book  
In the golden eventide:  
Much study had made him very lean,  
And pale, and leaden-eyed.

At last he shut the ponderous tome;  
With a fast and fervent grasp  
He strain'd the dusky covers close,  
And fix'd the brazen hasp:  
'O Heav'n, could I so close my mind,  
And clasp it with a clasp!'

Then leaping on his feet upright,  
Some moody turns he took;  
Now up the mead, then down the mead,

And past a shady nook: And lo, he saw a little boy  
That pored upon a book.

'My gentle lad, what is't you read—  
Romance or fairy fable?  
Or is it some historic page  
Of kings and crowns unstable?'  
The young boy gave an upward glance—  
'It is the death of Abel.'

The usher took six hasty strides,  
As smit with sudden pain;  
Six hasty strides beyond the place,  
Then slowly back again:  
And down he sat beside the lad,  
And talked with him of Cain;

And long since then, of bloody men,  
Whose deeds tradition saves;  
Of lonely folk cut off unseen,  
And hid in sudden graves;  
Of horrid stabs in groves forlorn,  
And murders done in caves;

And how the sprites of injured men  
Shriek upward from the sod—  
Ay, how the ghostly hand will point  
To show the burial clod;  
And unknown facts of guilty acts  
Are seen in dreams from God.



He told how murderers walk'd the earth  
Beneath the curse of Cain  
With crimson clouds before their eyes,  
And flames about their brain:  
For blood has left upon their souls  
Its everlasting stain.

'And well,' quoth he, 'I know, for truth,  
Their pangs must be extreme—  
Wo, wo, unutterable wo—  
Who spill life's sacred stream!  
For why? Methought last night I wrought  
A murder in a dream!

'One that had never done me wrong—  
A feeble man, and old;  
I led him to a lonely field,  
The moon shone clear and cold:  
Now here, said I, this man shall die,  
And I will have his gold!

'Two sudden blows with a ragged stick,  
And one with a heavy stone,  
One hurried gash with a hasty knife,  
And then the deed was done:  
There was nothing lying at my feet,  
But lifeless flesh and bone!

'Nothing but lifeless flesh and bone,  
That could not do me ill;  
And yet I fear'd him all the more,  
For lying there so still:

There was a manhood in his look  
That murder could not kill.

'And lo, the universal air  
Seem'd lit with ghastly flame—  
Ten thousand, thousand dreadful eyes  
Were looking down in blame:  
I took the dead man by the hand,  
And call'd upon his name!

'Oh me, it made me quake to see  
Such sense within the slain!  
But when I touch'd the lifeless clay,  
The blood gush'd out again!  
For every clot, a burning spot  
Was scorching in my brain!

'My head was like an ardent coal,  
My heart as solid ice;  
My wretched, wretched soul, I knew,  
Was at the devil's price:  
A dozen times I groan'd; the dead  
Had never groan'd but twice.

'And now from forth the frowning sky,  
From the heaven's topmost height,  
I heard a voice—the awful voice  
Of the blood-avenging sprite:  
"Thou guilty man, take up thy dead,  
And hide it from my sight!"

'I took the dreary body up  
And cast it in a stream  
A sluggish water, black as ink,  
The depth was so extreme.  
My gentle boy, remember, this  
Is nothing but a dream!

'Down went the corse with a hollow plunge,  
And vanish'd in the pool;  
Anon I cleansed my bloody hands,  
And washed my forehead cool,  
And sat among the urchins young  
That evening in the school.

'O heaven, to think of their white souls,  
And mine so black and grim!  
I could not share in childish prayer,  
Nor join in evening hymn:  
Like a devil of the pit I seem'd,  
'Mid holy cherubim!

'And peace went with them, one and all,  
And each calm pillow spread;  
But Guilt was my grim chamberlain  
That lighted me to bed,  
And drew my midnight curtains round,  
With fingers bloody red!

'All night I lay in agony,  
In anguish dark and deep;  
My fever'd eyes I dared not close,  
But star'd aghast at Sleep;

For sin had render'd unto her  
The keys of hell to keep!

'All night I lay in agony,  
From weary chime to chime,  
With one besetting horrid hint,  
That rack'd me all the time—  
A mighty yearning, like the first  
Fierce impulse unto crime.

'One stern tyrannic thought that made  
All other thoughts its slave;  
Stronger and stronger every pulse  
Did that temptation crave—  
Still urging me to go and see  
The dead man in his grave.

'Heavily I rose up—as soon  
As light was in the sky—  
And sought the black accursed pool  
With a wild misgiving eye;  
And I saw the dead, in the river bed,  
For the faithless stream was dry!

'Merrily rose the lark, and shook  
The dew-drop from its wing;  
But I never mark'd its morning flight,  
I never heard it sing:  
For I was stooping once again  
Under the horrid thing.

'With breathless speed, like a soul in chase,  
I took him up and ran—  
There was no time to dig a grave  
Before the day began:  
In a lonesome wood, with heaps of leaves,  
I hid the murder'd man.

'And all that day I read in school,  
But my thought was elsewhere;  
As soon as the mid-day task was done,  
In secret I was there:  
And a mighty wind had swept the leaves,  
And still the corse was bare!

'Then down I cast me on my face,  
And first began to weep;  
For I knew my secret then was one  
That earth refused to keep;  
Or land, or sea, though he should be  
Ten thousand fathoms deep.

So wills the fierce avenging sprite,  
Till blood for blood atones;  
Ay, though he's buried in a cave,  
And trodden down with stones,  
And years have rotted off his flesh  
The world shall see his bones.

Oh me—that horrid, horrid dream  
Besets me now awake!  
Again, again, with a dizzy brain,  
The human life I take;

And my red right hand grows raging hot,  
Like Cranmer's at the stake.

'And still no peace for the restless clay  
Will wave or mould allow;  
The horrid thing pursues my soul—  
It stands before me now  
The fearful boy looked up and saw  
Huge drops upon his brow.

That very night, while gentle sleep  
The urchin's eyelids kiss'd,  
Two stern-faced men set out from Lynn.  
Through the cold and heavy mist;  
And Eugene Aram walk'd between,  
With gyves upon his wrist.

## **THE SONG OF THE SHIRT**

WITH fingers weary and worn,  
With eyelids heavy and red,  
A woman sat, in unwomanly rags,  
Plying her needle and thread—

Stitch—stitch—stitch  
In poverty, hunger, and dirt,  
And still with a voice of dolorous pitch  
She sang the Song of the Shirt.

'Work—work—work  
While the cock is crowing aloof;

And work—work—work  
Till the stars shine through the roof  
It 's O! to be a slave  
Along with the barbarous Turk,  
Where woman has never a soul to save  
If this is Christian work!

'Work—work—work  
Till the brain begins to swim;  
Work—work—work  
Till the eyes are heavy and dim  
I Seam, and gusset, and band,  
Band, and gusset, and seam,  
Till over the buttons I fall asleep,  
And sew them on in a dream!

'O men with Sisters dear!  
O men with Mothers and Wives!  
It is not linen you're wearing out,  
But human creatures' lives!  
Stitch—stitch—stitch,  
In poverty, hunger, and dirt,  
Sewing at once with a double thread,  
A Shroud as well as a Shirt.

But why do I talk of Death?  
That phantom of grisly bone,  
I hardly fear his terrible shape,  
It seems so like my own—  
It seems so like my own,  
Because of the fasts I keep;

Oh God, that bread should be so dear,  
And flesh and blood so cheap!

'Work—work—work!  
My labour never flags;  
And what are its wages? A bed of straw,  
A crust of bread—and rags.  
That shattered roof—and this naked floor,—  
A table,—a broken chair,—  
And a wall so blank, my shadow I thank  
For sometimes falling there.

'Work—work—work  
From weary chime to chime,  
Work—work—work  
As prisoners work for crime!  
Band, and gusset, and seam,  
Seam, and gusset, and band,  
Till the heart is sick, and the brain benumbed,  
As well as the weary hand.

'Work—work—work,  
In the dull December light,  
And work—work—work,  
When the weather is warm and bright  
While underneath the eaves  
The brooding swallows cling,  
As if to show me their sunny backs  
And twit me with the Spring.

'Oh, but to breathe the breath  
Of the cowslip and primrose sweet



With the sky above my head,  
And the grass beneath my feet,  
For only one short hour  
To feel as I used to feel,  
Before I knew the woes of want  
And the walk that costs a meal!

'Oh, but for one short hour!  
A respite however brief!  
No blessed leisure for Love or Hope,  
But only time for Grief!  
A little weeping would ease my heart,  
But in their briny bed  
My tears must stop, for every drop  
Hinders needle and thread!'

With fingers weary and worn,  
With eyelids heavy and red,  
A woman sat, in unwomanly rags,  
Plying her needle and thread—  
Stitch—stitch—stitch!  
In poverty, hunger, and dirt,  
And still with a voice of dolorous pitch,—  
Would that its tone could reach the Rich!  
She sang this 'Song of the Shirt!'

## **THE STARS ARE WITH THE VOYAGER**

THE stars are with the voyager,  
Wherever he may sail;  
The moon is constant to her time,

The sun will never fail,  
But follow, follow, round the world,  
The green earth and the sea;  
So love is with the lover's heart,  
Wherever he may be.

Wherever he may be, the stars  
Must daily lose their light,  
The moon will veil her in the shade,  
The sun will set at night;  
The sun may set, but constant love  
Will shine when he's away,  
So that dull night is never night,  
And day is brighter day.

## **RUTH**

SHE stood breast high amid the corn,  
Clasped by the golden light of morn,  
Like the sweetheart of the sun,  
Who many a glowing kiss had won.

On her cheek an autumn flush  
Deeply ripened—such a blush  
In the midst of brown was born—  
Like red poppies grown with corn.

Round her eyes her tresses fell,  
Which were blackest none could tell,  
But long lashes veiled a light  
That had else been all too bright.

And her hat, with shady brim,  
Made her tressy forehead dim:—  
hus she stood amid the stooks,  
Praising God with sweetest looks:—

Sure, I said, Heav'n did not mean  
Where I reap thou shouldst but glean,  
Lay thy sheaf adown and come  
Share my harvest and my home.

## *LORD MACAULAY*

### **IVRY**

Now glory to the Lord of Hosts, from whom all glories are!  
And glory to our sovereign liege, King Henry of Navarre!  
Now let there be the merry sound of music and of dance,  
Through thy cornfields green, and sunny vines, oh pleasant land of France!  
And thou, Rochelle, our own Rochelle, proud city of the waters,  
Again let rapture light the eyes of all thy mourning daughters.  
As thou wert constant in our ills, be joyous in our joy,  
For cold, and stiff, and still are they who wrought thy walls annoy.  
Hurrah! hurrah! a single field hath turned the chance of war,  
Hurrah! hurrah! for Ivry, and Henry of Navarre.

Oh! how our hearts were beating, when, at the dawn of day,  
We saw the army of the League drawn out in long array;  
With all its priest-led citizens, and all its rebel peers,  
And Appenzel's stout infantry, and Egmont's Flemish spears.

There rode the brood of false Lorraine, the curses of our land;  
And dark Mayenne was in the midst, a truncheon in his hand:  
And, as we looked on them, we thought of Seine's empurpled flood,  
And good Coligni's hoary hair all dabbled with his blood;  
And we cried unto the living God, who rules the fate of war,  
To fight for His own holy name, and Henry of Navarre.

The king is come to marshal us, all in his armour drest;  
And he has bound a snow-white plume upon his gallant crest.  
He looked upon his people, and a tear was in his eye;  
He looked upon the traitors, and his glance was stern and high.  
Right graciously he smiled on us, as rolled from wing to wing,  
Down all our line, a deafening shout, 'God save our lord the King.'  
'And if my standard-bearer fall, as fall full well he may  
For never saw I promise yet of such a bloody fray—  
Press where ye see my white plume shine, amidst the ranks of war,  
And be your oriflamme, to-day, the helmet of Navarre.'

Hurrah! the foes are moving! Hark to the mingled din  
Of fife, and steed, and trump, and drum, and roaring culverin.  
The fiery Duke is pricking fast across St. Andre's plain,  
With all the hireling chivalry of Guelders and Almayne.  
Now by the lips of those ye love, fair gentlemen of France,  
Charge for the golden lilies—upon them with the lance!  
A thousand spurs are striking deep, a thousand spears in rest,  
A thousand knights are pressing close behind the snow-white crest;  
And in they burst, and on they rushed, while, like a guiding-star,  
Amidst the thickest carnage blazed the helmet of Navarre.

Now, God be praised, the day is ours! Mayenne hath turned his rein.  
D'Aumale hath cried for quarter. The Flemish Count is slain.

Their ranks are breaking like thin clouds before a Biscay gale;  
The field is heaped with bleeding steeds, and flags, and cloven mail.  
And then we thought on vengeance, and all along our van,  
'Remember St. Bartholomew,' was passed from man to man;  
But out spake gentle Henry: No Frenchman is my foe:  
Down, down with every foreigner, but let your brethren go.'  
Oh! was there ever such a knight, in friendship or in war,  
As our sovereign lord, King Henry, the soldier of Navarre!

Right well fought all the Frenchmen who fought for France to-day;  
And many a lordly banner God gave them for a prey.  
But we of the religion have borne us best in fight;  
And the good lord of Rosny hath ta'en the cornet white.  
Our own true Maximilian the cornet white hath ta'en,  
The cornet white with crosses black, the flag of false Lorraine.  
Up with it high; unfurl it wide; that all the host may know  
How God hath humbled the proud house which wrought His church such  
woe.  
Then on the ground, while trumpets sound their loudest points of war,  
Fling the red shreds, a foot-cloth meet for Henry of Navarre.

Ho! maidens of Vienna! Ho! matrons of Lucerne!  
Weep, weep, and rend your hair for those who never shall return.  
Ho! Philip, send, for charity, thy Mexican pistoles,  
That Antwerp monks may sing a mass for thy poor spearmen's souls!  
Ho! gallant nobles of the League, look that your arms be bright;  
Ho! burghers of Saint Genevieve, keep watch and ward to-night.  
For our God hath crushed the tyrant, our God hath raised the slave,  
And mocked the counsel of the wise, and the valour of the brave.  
Then glory to His holy name, from whom all glories are;  
And glory to our sovereign lord, King Henry of Navarre.

## THE ARMADA

ATTEND, all ye who list to hear our noble England's praise:  
I sing of the thrice famous deeds she wrought in ancient days,  
When that great fleet invincible, against her bore, in vain,  
The richest spoils of Mexico, the stoutest hearts in Spain.

It was about the lovely close of a warm summer's day,  
There came a gallant merchant ship full sail to Plymouth bay;  
The crew had seen Castile's black fleet, beyond Aurigny's isle,  
At earliest twilight, on the waves, lie heaving many a mile.  
At sunrise she escaped their van, by God's especial grace;  
And the tall Pinta, till the noon, had held her close in chase.  
Forthwith a guard, at every gun, was placed along the wall;  
The beacon blazed upon the roof of Edgecombe's lofty hall;  
Many a light fishing bark put out, to pry along the coast;  
And with loose rein, and bloody spur, rode inland many a post.

With his white hair, unbonneted, the stout old sheriff comes,  
Behind him march the halberdiers, before him sound the drums:  
The yeomen, round the market cross, make clear and ample space,  
For there behoves him to set up the standard of her grace:  
And haughtily the trumpets peal, and gaily dance the bells,  
As slow upon the labouring wind the royal blazon swells.  
Look how the lion of the sea lifts up his ancient crown,  
And underneath his deadly paw treads the gay lilies down!  
So stalked he when he turned to flight, on that famed Picard field,  
Bohemia's plume, and Genoa's bow, and Caesar's eagle shield;  
So glared he when, at Agincourt, in wrath he turned to bay,  
And crushed and torn, beneath his claws, the princely hunters lay.  
Ho! strike the flagstaff deep, sir knight! ho! scatter flowers, fair maids!

Ho, gunners! fire a loud salute! ho, gallants! draw your blades!  
Thou, sun, shine on her joyously! ye breezes, waft her wide!  
Our glorious *semper eadem* the banner of our pride!

The fresh'ning breeze of eve unfurled that banner's massy fold  
The parting gleam of sunshine kissed that haughty scroll of gold:  
Night sunk upon the dusky beach, and on the purple sea;  
Such night in England ne'er had been, nor ne'er again shall be.  
From Eddystone to Berwick bounds, from Lynn to Milford bay,  
That time of slumber was as bright, as busy as the day;  
For swift to east, and swift to west, the warning radiance spread—  
High on St. Michael's Mount it shone—it shone on Beachy Head.

Far o'er the deep the Spaniard saw, along each southern shire,  
Cape beyond cape, in endless range, those twinkling points of fire.  
The fisher left his skiff to rock on Tamar's glittering waves,  
The rugged miners poured to war, from Mendip's sunless caves;  
O'er Longleat's towers, or Cranbourne's oaks, the fiery herald flew,  
And roused the shepherds of Stonehenge—the rangers of Beaulieu.  
Right sharp and quick the bells rang out all night from Bristol town;  
And, ere the day, three hundred horse had met on Clifton Down.

The sentinel on Whitehall gate looked forth into the night,  
And saw, o'erhanging Richmond Hill, that streak of blood-red light:  
The bugle's note, and cannon's roar, the death-like silence broke,  
And with one start, and with one cry, the royal city woke;  
At once, on all her stately gates, arose the answering fires;  
At once the wild alarm clashed from all her reeling spires;  
From all the batteries of the Tower pealed loud the voice of fear,  
And all the thousand masts of Thames sent back a louder cheer:  
And from the farthest wards was heard the rush of hurrying feet,

And the broad streams of flags and pikes dashed down each rousing street:  
And broader still became the blaze, and louder still the din,  
As fast from every village round the horse came spurring in;  
And eastward straight, for wild Blackheath, the warlike errand went;  
And roused, in many an ancient hall, the gallant squires of Kent:  
Southward, for Surrey's pleasant hills, flew those bright coursers forth;  
High on black Hampstead's swarthy moor, they started for the north;  
And on, and on, without a pause, untired they bounded still;  
All night from tower to tower they sprang, all night from hill to hill;  
Till the proud peak unfurled the flag o'er Derwent's rocky dales;  
Till, like volcanoes, flared to heaven the stormy hills of Wales;  
Till twelve fair counties saw the blaze on Malvern's lonely height;  
Till streamed in crimson, on the wind, the Wrekin's crest of light;  
Till, broad and fierce, the star came forth, on Ely's stately fane,  
And town and hamlet rose in arms, o'er all the boundless plain;  
Till Belvoir's lordly towers the sign to Lincoln sent,  
And Lincoln sped the message on, o'er the wide vale of Trent;  
Till Skiddaw saw the fire that burnt on Gaunt's embattled pile,  
And the red glare on Skiddaw roused the burghers of Carlisle.

### *LORD TENNYSON*

#### **LADY CLARE**

IT was the time when lilies blow,  
And clouds are highest up in air,  
Lord Ronald brought a lily-white doe  
To give his cousin, Lady Clare.



I trove they did not part in scorn:  
Lovers long-betroth'd were they:  
They two will wed the morrow morn;  
God's blessing on the day!

'He does not love me for my birth,  
Nor for my lands so broad and fair;  
He loves me for my own true worth,  
And that is well,' said Lady Clare.

In there came old Alice the nurse,  
Said, Who was this that went from thee?'  
'It was my cousin,' said Lady Clare,  
To-morrow he weds with me.'

O God be thank'd!' said Alice the nurse,  
That all comes round so just and fair:  
Lord Ronald is heir of all your lands,  
And you are not the Lady Clare.'

'Are ye out of your mind, my nurse, my nurse?'  
Said Lady Clare, that ye speak so wild?'  
As God's above,' said Alice the nurse,  
I speak the truth: you are my child.

'The old Earl's daughter died at my breast;  
I speak the truth, as I live by bread!  
I buried her like my own sweet child,  
And put my child in her stead.'

Falsely, falsely have ye done,  
O mother,' she said, 'if this be true,

To keep the best man under the sun  
So many years from his due.'

Nay now, my child,' said Alice the nurse,  
But keep the secret for your life,  
And all you have will be Lord Ronald's,  
When you are man and wife'

'If I'm a beggar born,' she said,  
I will speak out, for I dare not lie.  
Pull off, pull off, the broach of gold,  
And fling the diamond necklace by.'

'Nay now, my child,' said Alice the nurse,  
'But keep the secret all ye can.'  
She said, 'Not so: but I will know  
If there be any faith in man.'

'Nay now, what faith?' said Alice the nurse,  
'The man will cleave unto his right.'  
'And he shall have it,' the lady replied,  
Tho' I should die to-night.'

'Yet give one kiss to your mother dear!  
Alas, my child, I sinn'd for thee.'  
'O mother, mother, mother,' she said,  
So strange it seems to me.

'Yet here 's a kiss for my mother dear,  
My mother dear, if this be so,  
And lay your hand upon my head,  
And bless me, mother, ere I go.'

She clad herself in a russet gown,  
She was no longer Lady Clare:  
She went by dale, and she went by down,  
With a single rose in her hair.

The lily-white doe Lord Ronald had brought  
Leapt up from where she lay,  
ropt her head in the maiden's hand,  
And follow'd her all the way.

Down stept Lord Ronald from his tower:  
'O Lady Clare, you shame your worth!  
Why come you drest like a village maid,  
That are the flower of the earth?'

'If I come drest like a village maid,  
I am but as my fortunes are:  
I am a beggar born,' she said,  
And not the Lady Clare.'

'Play me no tricks,' said Lord Ronald,  
For I am yours in word and in deed.  
Play me no tricks,' said Lord Ronald,  
Your riddle is hard to read.'

O and proudly stood she up!  
Her heart within her did not fail:  
She look'd into Lord Ronald's eyes,  
And told him all her nurse's tale.

He laugh'd a laugh of merry scorn:  
He turn'd, and kiss'd her where she stood

'If you are not the heiress born,  
And I,' said he, the next in blood—

'If you are not the heiress born,  
And I,' said he, the lawful heir,  
We two will wed to-morrow morn,  
And you shall still be Lady Clare.'

### **THE LORD OF BURLEIGH**

IN her ear he whispers gaily,  
'If my heart by signs can tell,  
Maiden, I have watch'd thee daily,  
And I think thou lov'st me well.'  
She replies, in accents fainter,  
'There is none I love like thee.'  
He is but a landscape-painter,  
And a village maiden she.  
He to lips, that fondly falter,  
Presses his without reproof:  
Leads her to the village altar,  
And they leave her father's roof.  
'I can make no marriage present:  
Little can I give my wife.  
Love will make our cottage pleasant,  
And I love thee more than life.'  
They by parks and lodges going  
See the lordly castles stand:  
Summer woods, about them blowing,  
Made a murmur in the land.

From deep thought himself he rouses,  
Says to her that loves him well,  
'Let us see these handsome houses  
Where the wealthy nobles dwell.'  
So she goes by him attended,  
Hears him lovingly converse,  
Sees whatever fair and splendid  
Lay betwixt his home and hers;  
Parks with oak and chestnut shady,  
Parks and order'd gardens great,  
Ancient homes of lord and lady,  
Built for pleasure and for state.  
All he shows her makes him dearer:  
Evermore she seems to gaze  
On that cottage growing nearer,  
Where they twain will spend their days.  
O but she will love him truly!  
He shall have a cheerful home;  
She will order all things duly,  
When beneath his roof they come.  
Thus her heart rejoices greatly,  
Till a gateway she discerns  
With armorial bearings stately,  
And beneath the gate she turns;  
Sees a mansion more majestic  
Than all those she saw before:  
Many a gallant gay domestic  
Bows before him at the door.  
And they speak in gentle murmur,  
When they answer to his call,

While he treads with footstep firmer,  
Leading on from hall to hall.  
And, while now she wonders blindly,  
Nor the meaning can divine,  
Proudly turns he round and kindly,  
'All of this is mine and thine.'  
Here he lives in state and bounty,  
Lord of Burleigh, fair and free,  
Not a lord in all the county  
Is so great a lord as he.  
All at once the colour flushes  
Her sweet face from brow to chin:  
As it were with shame she blushes,  
And her spirit changed within.  
Then her countenance all over  
Pale again as death did prove:  
But he clasp'd her like a lover,  
And he cheer'd her soul with love.  
So she strove against her weakness,  
Tho' at times her spirits sank:  
Shaped her heart with woman's meekness  
To all duties of her rank:  
And a gentle consort made he,  
And her gentle mind was such  
That she grew a noble lady,  
And the people loved her much.  
But a trouble weigh'd upon her,  
And perplex'd her, night and morn,  
With the burthen of an honour  
Unto which she was not born.

Faint she grew, and ever fainter,  
As she murmur'd, 'Oh, that he  
Were once more that landscape-painter,  
Which did win my heart from me!'  
So she droop'd and droop'd before him,  
Fading slowly from his side:  
Three fair children first she bore him,  
Then before her time she died.  
Weeping, weeping late and early,  
Walking up and pacing down,  
Deeply mourn'd the Lord of Burleigh,  
Burleigh-house by Stamford-town.  
And he came to look upon her,  
And he look'd at her and said,  
'Bring the dress and put it on her,  
That she wore when she was wed.'  
Then her people, softly treading,  
Bore to earth her body, drest  
In the dress that she was wed in,  
That her spirit might have rest.

## **EDWARD GRAY**

SWEET Emma Moreland of yonder town  
Met me walking on yonder way,  
'And have you lost your heart?' she said;  
And are you married yet, Edward Gray?

Sweet Emma Moreland spoke to me:  
Bitterly weeping I turn'd away:

'Sweet Emma Moreland, love no more  
Can touch the heart of Edward Gray.

'Ellen Adair she loved me well,  
Against her father's and mother's will:  
To-day I sat for an hour and wept,  
By Ellen's grave, on the windy hill.

'Shy she was, and I thought her cold;  
Thought her proud, and fled over the sea;  
Fill'd I was with folly and spite,  
When Ellen Adair was dying for me.

'Cruel, cruel the words I said!  
Cruelly came they back to-day:  
"You're too slight and fickle," I said,  
"To trouble the heart of Edward Gray."

'There I put my face in the grass  
Whisper'd, "Listen to my despair:  
I repent me of all I did:  
Speak a little, Ellen Adair!"

'Then I took a pencil, and wrote  
On the mossy stone, as I lay,  
"Here lies the body of Ellen Adair;  
And here the heart of Edward Gray!"

'Love may come, and love may go,  
And fly, like a bird, from tree to tree:  
But I will love no more, no more,  
Till Ellen Adair come back to me.



'Bitterly wept I over the stone:  
Bitterly weeping I turn'd away:  
There lies the body of Ellen Adair!  
And there the heart of Edward Gray!'

## **THE OWL**

### **I**

WHEN cats run home and light is come,  
And dew is cold upon the ground,  
And the far-off stream is dumb,  
And the whirring sail goes round,  
And the whirring sail goes round:  
Alone and warming his five wits,  
The white owl in the belfry sits.

### **II**

When merry milkmaids click the latch,  
And rarely smells the new-mown hay,  
And the cock hath sung beneath the thatch  
Twice or thrice his roundelay,  
Twice or thrice his roundelay:  
Alone and warming his five wits,  
The white owl in the belfry sits.

## **ORIANA**

MY heart is wasted with my woe,  
Oriana.

There is no rest for me below,  
Oriana.

When the long dun wolds are ribb'd with snow,  
And loud the Norland whirlwinds blow,  
Oriana,  
Alone I wander to and fro,  
Oriana.

Ere the light on dark was growing,  
Oriana,  
At midnight the cock was crowing,  
Oriana:  
Winds were blowing, waters flowing,  
We heard the steeds to battle going,  
Oriana;  
Aloud the hollow bugle blowing,  
Oriana.

In the yew-wood black as night,  
Oriana,  
Ere I rode into the fight,  
Oriana,  
While blissful tears blinded my sight  
By star-shine and by moonlight,  
Oriana,  
I to thee my troth did plight,  
Oriana.

She stood upon the castle wall,  
Oriana:  
She watch'd my crest among them all,

Oriana:

She saw me fight, she heard me call,  
When forth there stept a foeman tall,  
Oriana,  
Atween me and the castle wall,  
Oriana.

The bitter arrow went aside,

Oriana:

The false, false arrow went aside,  
Oriana:  
The damned arrow glanced aside,  
And pierced thy heart, my love, my bride,  
Oriana!

Thy heart, my life, my love, my bride,

Oriana!

Oh, narrow, narrow was the space,  
Oriana.

Loud, loud rung out the bugle's brays,  
Oriana.

Oh, deathful stabs were dealt apace,  
The battle deepen'd in its place,  
Oriana;

But I was down upon my face,  
Oriana.

They should have stabb'd me where I lay, Oriana!

How could I rise and come away,  
Oriana?

How could I look upon the day?

They should have stabb'd me where I lay  
Oriana—  
They should have trod me into clay,  
Oriana.

O breaking heart that will not break,  
Oriana!  
O pale, pale face so sweet and meek,  
Oriana!  
Thou smilest, but thou dost not speak,  
And then the tears run down my cheek,  
Oriana:  
What wantest thou? whom dost thou seek,  
Oriana?

I cry aloud: none hear my cries,  
Oriana.  
Thou comest atween me and the skies,  
Oriana.  
I feel the tears of blood arise  
Up from my heart unto my eyes,  
Oriana.  
Within my heart my arrow lies,  
Oriana.

O cursed hand! O cursed blow!  
Oriana!  
O happy thou that liest low,  
Oriana!  
All night the silence seems to flow  
Beside me in my utter woe,

Oriana.

A weary, weary way I go,

Oriana.

When Norland winds pipe down the sea,

Oriana,

I walk, I dare not think of thee,

Oriana.

Thou liest beneath the greenwood tree,

I dare not die and come to thee,

Oriana.

I hear the roaring of the sea,

Oriana.

## **THE LADY OF SHALOTT**

### **PART I**

ON either side the river lie

Long fields of barley and of rye,

That clothe the wold and meet the sky;

And thro' the field the road runs by

To many-tower'd Camelot;

And up and down the people go,

Gazing where the lilies blow

Round an island there below,

The island of Shalott.

Willows whiten, aspens quiver,

Little breezes dusk and shiver

Thro' the wave that runs for ever

By the island in the river  
Flowing down to Camelot.  
Four gray walls, and four gray towers,  
Overlook a space of flowers,  
And the silent isle embowers  
The Lady of Shalott.

By the margin, willow-veil'd,  
Slide the heavy barges trail'd  
By slow horses; and unhail'd  
The shallop flitteth silken sail'd  
Skimming down to Camelot:  
But who hath seen her wave her hand?  
Or at the casement seen her stand?  
Or is she known in all the land,  
The Lady of Shalott?

Only reapers, reaping early  
In among the bearded barley,  
Hear a song that echoes cheerly  
From the river winding clearly,  
Down to tower'd Camelot:  
And by the moon the reaper weary,  
Piling sheaves in uplands airy,  
Listening, whispers 'Tis the fairy  
Lady of Shalott.'

## **PART II**

There she weaves by night and day  
A magic web with colours gay.

She has heard a whisper say,  
A curse is on her if she stay  
To look down to Camelot.  
She knows not what the curse may be,  
And so she weaveth steadily,  
And little other care has she,  
The Lady of Shalott.

And moving thro' a mirror clear  
That hangs before her all the year,  
Shadows of the world appear.  
There she sees the highway near  
Winding down to Camelot:  
There the river eddy whirls,  
And there the surly village-churls,  
And the red cloaks of market girls,  
Pass onward from Shalott.

Sometimes a troop of damsels glad,  
An abbot on an ambling pad,  
Sometimes a curly shepherd-lad,  
Or long-hair'd page in crimson clad,  
Goes by to tower'd Camelot;  
And sometimes thro' the mirror blue  
The knights come riding two and two  
She hath no loyal knight and true,  
The Lady of Shalott.

But in her web she still delights  
To weave the mirror's magic sights,  
For often thro' the silent nights

A funeral, with plumes and lights,  
And music, went to Camelot:  
Or when the moon was overhead,  
Came two young lovers lately wed;  
'I am half sick of shadows,' said  
The Lady of Shalott.

### **PART III**

A bow-shot from her bower-eaves,  
He rode between the barley-sheaves,  
The sun came dazzling thro' the leaves,  
And flamed upon the brazen greaves  
Of bold Sir Lancelot.  
A red-cross knight for ever kneel'd  
To a lady in his shield,  
That sparkled on the yellow field  
Beside remote Shalott.

The gemmy bridle glitter'd free,  
Like to some branch of stars we see  
Hung in the golden Galaxy.  
The bridle bells rang merrily  
As he rode down to Camelot:  
And from his blazon'd baldrick slung  
A mighty silver bugle hung,  
And as he rode his armour rung,  
Beside remote Shalott.

All in the blue unclouded weather  
Thick-jewell'd shone the saddle-leather



The helmet and the helmet-feather  
Burn'd like one burning flame together,  
As he rode down to Camelot.  
As often thro' the purple night,  
Below the starry clusters bright,  
Some bearded meteor, trailing light,  
Moves over still Shalott.

His broad clear brow in sunlight glow'd;  
On burnish'd hooves his war-horse trod;  
From underneath his helmet flow'd  
His coal-black curls as on he rode,  
As he rode down to Camelot.  
From the bank and from the river  
He flash'd into the crystal mirror,  
'Tirra lirra,' by the river  
Sang Sir Lancelot.

She left the web, she left the loom,  
She made three paces thro' the room,  
She saw the water-lily bloom,  
She saw the helmet and the plume,  
She look'd down to Camelot.  
Out flew the web and floated wide;  
The mirror crack'd from side to side;  
'The curse is come upon me,' cried  
The Lady of Shalott.

#### **PART IV**

In the stormy east-wind straining,  
The pale yellow woods were waning,  
The broad stream in his banks complaining,  
Heavily the low sky raining  
Over tower'd Camelot;  
Down she came and found a boat  
Beneath a willow left afloat,  
And round about the prow she wrote  
*The Lady of Shalott.*

And down the river's dim expanse—  
Like some bold seer in a trance,  
Seeing all his own mischance—  
With a glassy countenance  
Did she look to Camelot.  
And at the closing of the day  
She loosed the chain, and down she lay;  
The broad stream bore her far away,  
The Lady of Shalott.

Lying, robed in snowy white  
That loosely flew to left and right  
The leaves upon her falling light  
Thro' the noises of the night  
She floated down to Camelot.  
And as the boat-head wound along  
The willowy hills and fields among,  
They heard her singing her last song,  
The Lady of Shalott.

Heard a carol, mournful, holy,  
Chanted loudly, chanted lowly,  
Till her blood was frozen slowly,  
And her eyes were darken'd wholly,  
Turn'd to tower'd Camelot;  
For ere she reach'd upon the tide  
The first house by the water-side,  
Singing in her song she died,  
The Lady of Shalott.

Under tower and balcony,  
By garden-wall and gallery,  
A gleaming shape she floated by,  
Dead-pale between the houses high,  
Silent into Camelot.  
Out upon the wharfs they came,  
Knight and burgher, lord and dame,  
And round the prow they read her name,  
*The Lady of Shalott.*

Who is this? and what is here?  
And in the lighted palace near  
Died the sound of royal cheer;  
And they cross'd themselves for fear,  
All the knights at Camelot:  
But Lancelot mused a little space;  
He said, 'She has a lovely face;  
God in his mercy lend her grace,  
The Lady of Shalott.'

**SONG**

MOVE eastward, happy earth, and leave  
Yon orange sunset waning slow:  
From fringes of the faded eve,  
O, happy planet, eastward go;  
Till over thy dark shoulder glow  
Thy silver sister-world, and rise  
To glass herself in dewy eyes  
That watch me from the glen below.

Ah, bear me with thee, lightly borne,  
Dip forward under starry light,  
And move me to my marriage-morn,  
And round again to happy night.

### **BREAK, BREAK, BREAK**

BREAK, break, break,  
On thy cold grey stones, O Sea!  
And I would that my tongue could utter  
The thoughts that arise in me.

O well for the fisherman's boy,  
That he shouts with his sister at play!  
O well for the sailor lad,  
That he sings in his boat on the bay.

And the stately ships go on  
To their haven under the hill;  
But O for the touch of a vanish'd hand,  
And the sound of a voice that is still!

Break, break, break,  
At the foot of thy crags, O Sea!  
But the tender grace of a day that is dead  
Will never come back to me.

## **THE GOOSE**

I KNEW an old wife lean and poor,  
Her rags scarce held together;  
There strode a stranger to the door,  
And it was windy weather.

He held a goose upon his arm,  
He utter'd rhyme and reason,  
'Here, take the goose, and keep you warm  
It is a stormy season.'

She caught the white goose by the leg,  
A goose—'twas no great matter.  
The goose let fall a golden egg  
With cackle and with clatter.

She dropt the goose, and caught the pelf,  
And ran to tell her neighbours;  
And bless'd herself, and cursed herself,  
And rested from her labours.

And feeding high, and living soft,  
Grew plump and able-bodied;  
Until the grave churchwarden doff'd,  
The parson smirk'd and nodded.

So sitting, served by man and maid,  
She felt her heart grow prouder:  
But ah! the more the white goose laid  
It clack'd and cackled louder.

It clutter'd here, it chuckled there;  
It stirr'd the old wife's mettle:  
She shifted in her elbow-chair,  
And hurl'd the pan and kettle.

'A quinsy choke thy cursed note!'  
Then wax'd her anger stronger.  
'Go, take the goose, and wring her throat,  
I will not bear it longer.'

Then yelp'd the cur, and yawl'd the cat;  
Ran Gaffer, stumbled Gammer.  
The goose flew this way and flew that,  
And fill'd the house with clamour.

As head and heels upon the floor  
They flounder'd all together,  
There strode a stranger to the door,  
And it was windy weather:

He took the goose upon his arm,  
He utter'd words of scorning;  
'So keep you cold, or keep you warm,  
It is a stormy morning.'

The wild wind rang from park and plain,  
And round the attics rumbled,

Till all the tables danced again,  
And half the chimneys tumbled.

The glass blew in, the fire blew out,  
The blast was hard and harder.  
Her cap blew off, her gown blew up,  
And a whirlwind clear'd the larder;

And while on all sides breaking loose  
Her household fled the danger,  
Quoth she, 'The Devil take the goose,  
And God forget the stranger!'

## **IN AUTUMN**

### **I**

A SPIRIT haunts the year's last hours  
Dwelling amid these yellowing bowers:  
To himself he talks;  
For at eventide, listening earnestly,  
At his work you may hear him sob and sigh  
In the walks;  
Earthward he boweth the heavy stalks  
Of the mouldering flowers:  
Heavily hangs the broad sunflower  
Over its grave i' the earth so chilly;  
Heavily hangs the hollyhock,  
Heavily hangs the tiger-lily.

### **II**

The air is damp, and hush'd, and close,  
As a sick man's room when he taketh repose  
An hour before death;  
My very heart faints and my whole soul grieves  
At the moist rich smell of the rotting leaves,  
And the breath  
Of the fading edges of box beneath,  
And the year's last rose.  
Heavily hangs the broad sunflower  
Over its grave i' the earth so chilly;  
Heavily hangs the hollyhock,  
Heavily hangs the tiger-lily.

### **AS THROUGH THE LAND AT EVE WE WENT**

As thro' the land at eve we went,  
And plucked the ripened ears,  
We fell out, my wife and I,  
We fell out, I know not why,  
And kissed again with tears.

And blessings on the falling out  
That all the more endears,  
When we fall out with those we love,  
And kiss again with tears!

For when we came where lies the child  
We lost in other years,  
There above the little grave,  
O there above the little grave,  
We kissed again with tears.



## **THE BUGLE**

THE splendour falls on castle walls  
And snowy summits, old in story:  
The long light shakes across the lakes,  
And the wild cataract leaps in glory.  
Blow, bugle, blow, set the wild echoes flying,  
Blow, bugle; answer, echoes, dying, dying, dying.

O hark, O hear! how thin and clear,  
And thinner, clearer, farther going!  
O sweet and far from cliff and scar  
The horns of Elfland faintly blowing!  
Blow, let us hear the purple glens replying:  
Blow, bugle; answer, echoes, dying, dying, dying.

O love, they die in yon rich sky,  
They faint on hill or field or river:  
Our echoes roll from soul to soul,  
And grow for ever and for ever.  
Blow, bugle, blow, set the wild echoes flying,  
And answer, echoes, answer, dying, dying, dying.

## **HOME THEY BROUGHT HER WARRIOR DEAD**

HOME they brought her warrior dead:  
She nor swoon'd, nor utter'd cry:  
All her maidens, watching, said,  
'She must weep or she will die.'

Then they praised him, soft and low,  
Call'd him worthy to be loved,  
Truest friend and noblest foe;  
Yet she neither spoke nor moved.

Stole a maiden from her place,  
Lightly to the warrior stept,  
Took the face-cloth from the face;  
Yet she neither moved nor wept.

Rose a nurse of ninety years,  
Set his child upon her knee  
Like summer tempest came her tears—  
'Sweet my child, I live for thee.'

## **THE BROOK**

I COME from haunts of coot and hern,  
I make a sudden sally,  
And sparkle out among the fern,  
To bicker down a valley.

By thirty hills I hurry down,  
Or slip between the ridges,  
By twenty thorps, a little town,  
And half a hundred bridges.

Till last by Philip's farm I flow  
To join the brimming river,  
For men may come, and men may go,  
But I go on for ever.

I chatter over stony ways,  
In little sharps and trebles,  
I bubble into eddying bays,  
I babble on the pebbles.

With many a curve my bank I fret  
By many a field and fallow,  
And many a fairy foreland set  
With willow-weed and mallow.

I chatter, chatter, as I flow  
To join the brimming river,  
For men may come, and men may go,  
But I go on for ever.

I wind about, and in and out,  
With here a blossom sailing,  
And here and there a lusty trout,  
And here and there a grayling,

And here and there a foamy flake  
Upon me as I travel,  
With many a silvery waterbreak  
Above the golden gravel,

And draw them all along and flow  
To join the brimming river,  
For men may come, and men may go,  
But I go on for ever.

I steal by lawns and grassy plots,  
I slide by hazel covers,

I move the sweet forget-me-nots  
That grow for happy lovers.

I slip, I slide, I gloom, I glance,  
Among my skimming swallows;  
I make the netted sunbeam dance  
Against my sandy shallows.

I murmur under moon and stars  
In brambly wildernesses;  
I linger by my shingly bars;  
I loiter round my tresses;

And out again I curve and flow  
To join the brimming river,  
For men may come, and men may go,  
But I go on for ever.

## **SWEET AND LOW**

SWEET and low, sweet and low,  
Wind of the western sea,  
Low, low, breathe and blow,  
Wind of the western sea!  
Over the rolling waters go,  
Come from the dropping moon, and blow,  
Blow him again to me;  
While my little one, while my pretty one sleeps.

Sleep and rest, sleep and rest,  
Father will come to thee soon;

Rest, rest, on mother's breast,  
Father will come to thee soon;  
Father will come to his babe in the nest,  
Silver sails all out of the west  
Under the silver moon:  
Sleep, my little one, sleep, my pretty one, sleep.

### **COME INTO THE GARDEN, MAUD**

COME into the garden, Maud,  
For the black bat, night, has flown,  
Come into the garden, Maud,  
I am here at the gate alone;  
And the woodbine spices are wafted abroad,  
And the musk of the roses blown.

For a breeze of morning moves,  
And the planet of Love is on high,  
Beginning to faint in the light that she loves  
On a bed of daffodil sky,  
To faint in the light of the sun she loves,  
To faint in his light, and to die.

All night have the roses heard  
The flute, violin, bassoon;  
All night has the casement jessamine stirr'd  
To the dancers dancing in tune;  
Till a silence fell with the waking bird,  
And a hush with the setting moon.

I said to the lily, 'There is but one  
With whom she has heart to be gay.  
When will the dancers leave her alone?  
She is weary of dance and play.'  
Now half to the setting moon are gone,  
And half to the rising day;  
Low on the sand and loud on the stone  
The last wheel echoes away.

I said to the rose, 'The brief night goes  
In babble and revel and wine.  
O young lord-lover, what sighs are those,  
For one that will never be thine?  
But mine, but mine,' so I sware to the rose,  
'For ever and ever, mine.'

And the soul of the rose went into my blood,  
As the music clash'd in the hall;  
And long by the garden lake I stood,  
For I heard your rivulet fall  
From the lake to the meadow and on to the wood,  
Our wood, that is dearer than all;

From the meadow your walks have left so sweet  
That whenever a March-wind sighs  
He sets the jewel-print of your feet  
In violets blue as your eyes,  
To the woody hollows in which we meet  
And the valleys of Paradise.

The slender acacia would not shake  
One long milk-bloom on the tree;

The white lake-blossom fell into the lake,  
As the pimpernel dozed on the lea;  
But the rose was awake all night for your sake,  
Knowing your promise to me;  
The lilies and roses were all awake,  
They sigh'd for the dawn and thee.

Queen rose of the rosebud garden of girls,  
Come hither, the dances are done,  
In gloss of satin and glimmer of pearls,  
Queen lily and rose in one;  
Shine out, little head, sunning over with curls,  
To the flowers, and be their sun.

There has fallen a splendid tear  
From the passion-flower at the gate.  
She is coming, my dove, my dear;  
She is coming, my life, my fate;  
The red rose cries, 'She is near, she is near';  
And the white rose weeps, 'She is late';  
The larkspur listens, 'I hear, I hear';  
And the lily whispers, 'I wait.'

She is coming, my own, my sweet,  
Were it ever so airy a tread,  
My heart would hear her and beat,  
Were it earth in an earthy bed;  
My dust would hear her and beat,  
Had I lain for a century dead;  
Would start and tremble under her feet,  
And blossom in purple and red.

## **ASK ME NO MORE**

ASK me no more: the moon may draw the sea;  
The cloud may stoop from heaven and take the shape,  
With fold to fold, of mountain or of cape;  
But O too fond, when have I answer'd thee?  
Ask me no more.

Ask me no more: what answer should I give?  
I love not hollow cheek or faded eye:  
Yet, O my friend, I will not have thee die!  
Ask me no more, lest I should bid thee live;  
Ask me no more.

Ask me no more: thy fate and mine are seal'd  
I strove against the stream and all in vain:  
Let the great river take me to the main:  
No more, dear love, for at a touch I yield;  
Ask me no more.

## **THE SOLDIER**

WHEN all among the thundering drums  
Thy soldier in the battle stands,  
Thy face across his fancy comes  
And gives the battle to his hands:

A moment while the trumpets blow,  
He sees his brood about thy knee—  
The next—like fire he meets the foe,



And strikes him dead for them and thee!  
Tara ta tantara!

## **DUSK**

Now sleeps the crimson petal, now the white;  
Nor waves the cypress in the palace walk;  
Nor winks the gold fin in the porphyry font:  
The fire-fly wakens:  
waken thou with me.

Now droops the milkwhite peacock like a ghost,  
And like a ghost she glimmers on to me.

Now lies the Earth all Danae to the stars,  
And all thy heart lies open unto me.

Now slides the silent meteor on, and leaves  
A shining furrow, as thy thoughts in me.

Now folds the lily all her sweetness up,  
And slips into the bosom of the lake:  
So fold thyself, my dearest, thou, and slip  
Into my bosom and be lost in me.

## **A FAREWELL**

FLOW down, cold rivulet, to the sea,  
Thy tribute wave deliver:  
No more by thee my steps shall be,  
For ever and for ever.

Flow, softly flow, by lawn and lea,  
A rivulet then a river:  
No where by thee my steps shall be,  
For ever and for ever.

But here will sigh thine alder-tree,  
And here thine aspen shiver;  
And here by thee will hum the bee,  
For ever and for ever.

A thousand suns will stream on thee,  
A thousand moons will quiver;  
But not by thee my steps shall be,  
For ever and for ever.

## **THE BEGGAR MAID**

HER arms across her breast she laid;  
She was more fair than words can say:  
Bare-footed came the beggar maid  
Before the king Cophetua.

In robe and crown the king stept down,  
To meet and greet her on her way;  
'It is no wonder,' said the lords,  
She is more beautiful than day.'

As shines the moon in clouded skies,  
She in her poor attire was seen:  
One praised her ankles, one her eyes,  
One her dark hair and lovesome mien.

So sweet a face, such angel grace,  
In all that land had never been  
Cophetua sware a royal oath:  
'This beggar maid shall be my queen!'

### **COME NOT, WHEN I AM DEAD**

COME not, when I am dead,  
To drop thy foolish tears upon my grave,  
To trample round my fallen head,  
And vex the unhappy dust thou wouldst not save.  
There let the wind sweep and the plover cry;  
But thou, go by.

Child, if it were thine error or thy crime  
I care no longer, being all unblest:  
Wed whom thou wilt, but I am sick of Time,  
And I desire to rest.  
Pass on, weak heart, and leave me where I lie:  
Go by, go by.

### **O SWALLOW, SWALLOW**

'O SWALLOW, Swallow, flying, flying South,  
Fly to her, and fall upon her gilded eaves,  
And tell her, tell her what I tell to thee.

'O tell her, Swallow, thou that knowest each,  
That bright and fierce and fickle is the South,  
And dark and true and tender is the North.

'O Swallow, Swallow, if I could follow, and light  
Upon her lattice, I would pipe and trill,  
And cheep and twitter twenty million loves.

'O were I thou that she might take me in,  
And lay me on her bosom, and her heart  
Would rock the snowy cradle till I died.

'Why lingereth she to clothe her heart with love,  
Delaying as the tender ash delays  
To clothe herself, when all the woods are green?

'O tell her, Swallow, that thy brood is flown:  
Say to her, I do but wanton in the South  
But in the North long since my nest is made.

'O tell her, brief is life but love is long,  
And brief the sun of summer in the North,  
And brief the moon of beauty in the South.

'O Swallow, flying from the golden woods,  
Fly to her, and pipe and woo her, and make her mine,  
And tell her, tell her, that I follow thee.'

### **THE MILLER'S DAUGHTER**

IT is the miller's daughter,  
And she is grown so dear, so dear,  
That I would be the jewel  
That trembles at her ear:  
For hid in ringlets day and night,  
I'd touch her neck so warm and white.

And I would be the girdle  
About her dainty dainty waist,  
And her heart would beat against me,  
In sorrow and in rest:  
And I should know if it beat right,  
I'd clasp it round so close and tight.

And I would be the necklace,  
And all day long to fall and rise  
Upon her balmy bosom,  
With her laughter or her sighs,  
And I would lie so light, so light,  
I scarce should be unclasp'd at night.

*WILLIAM MAKEPEACE THACKERAY*

### **LITTLE BILLEE**

THERE were three sailors of Bristol city  
Who took a boat and went to sea,

But first with beef and captain's biscuits  
And pickled pork they loaded she.

There was gorging Jack and guzzling Jimmy,  
And the youngest he was little Billee.

Now when they got as far as the Equator  
They'd nothing left but one split pea.

Says gorging Jack to guzzling Jimmy,  
'I am extremely hungaree.'

To gorging Jack says guzzling Jimmy,  
'We've nothing left; us must eat we.'

Says gorging Jack to guzzling Jimmy,  
'With one another we shouldn't agree!

'There's little Bill, he's young and tender,  
We're old and tough, so let's eat he.'

'Oh, Bill, we're going to kill and eat you,  
So undo the button of your chemie.'

When Bill received this information  
He used his pocket handkerchie.

'First let me say my catechism,  
Which my poor mammy taught to me.'

'Make haste, make haste,' says guzzling Jimmy,  
While Jack pulled out his snickersnee.

So Billy went up to the main-top gallant mast,  
And down he fell on his bended knee.

He scarce had come to the twelfth commandment  
When up he jumps. 'There's land I see:

'There's Jerusalem and Madagascar,  
And North and South Amerikee:

'There's the British flag a-riding at anchor,  
With Admiral Napier, K.C.B.'

So when they got aboard of the Admiral's,  
He hanged fat Jack and flogged Jimmee:

But as for little Bill, he made him  
The Captain of a Seventy-three.

*ARTHUR HUGH CLOUGH*

### **GREEN FIELDS OF ENGLAND**

GREEN fields of England! wheresoe'er  
Across this watery waste we fare,  
One image at our hearts we bear,  
Green fields of England, everywhere.

Sweet eyes in England, I must flee  
Past where the waves' last confines be,  
Ere your loved smile I cease to see,  
Sweet eyes in England, dear to me.

Dear home in England, safe and fast,  
If but in thee my lot lie cast,  
The past shall seem a nothing past  
To thee, dear home, if won at last;  
Dear home in England, won at last.

*ROBERT BROWNING*

**HOW THEY BROUGHT THE GOOD NEWS FROM GHENT TO  
AIX**

I SPRANG to the stirrup, and Joris, and he'  
I galloped, Dirck galloped, we galloped all three;  
Good speed!' cried the watch, as the gate-bolts undrew;  
'Speed!' echoed the wall to us galloping through;  
Behind shut the postern, the lights sank to rest,  
And into the midnight we galloped abreast.

Not a word to each other; we kept the great pace  
Neck by neck, stride by stride, never changing our place;  
I turned in my saddle and made its girths tight,  
Then shortened each stirrup, and set the pique right,  
Rebuckled the cheek-strap, chained slacker the bit,  
Nor galloped less steadily Roland a whit.

'Twas moonset at starting; but while we drew near  
Lokeren, the cocks crew, and twilight dawned clear;  
At Boom, a great yellow star came out to see;  
At Duffeld, 'twas morning as plain as could be;  
And from Mecheln church-steeple we heard the half chime,  
So Joris broke silence with 'Yet there is time!'

At Aerschot, up leaped of a sudden the sun,  
And against him the cattle stood black every one,  
To stare through the mist at us galloping past,  
And I saw my stout galloper Roland at last,



With resolute shoulders, each butting away  
The haze, as some bluff river headland its spray.

And his low head and crest, just one sharp ear bent back  
For my voice, and the other pricked out on his track;  
And one eye's black intelligence—ever that glance  
O'er its white edge at me, his own master askance!  
And the thick heavy spume-flakes which aye and anon  
His fierce lips shook upwards in galloping on.

By Hasselt, Dirck groaned; and cried Joris, 'Stay spur!  
Your Ross galloped bravely, the fault's not in her,  
We'll remember at Aix—for one heard the quick wheeze  
Of her chest, saw her stretched neck and staggering knees,  
And sunk tail, and horrible heave of the flank,  
As down on her haunches she shuddered and sank.

So we were left galloping, Joris and I,  
Past Looz and past Tongres, no cloud in the sky;  
The broad sun above laughed a pitiless laugh,  
'Neath our feet broke the brittle bright stubble like chaff;  
Till over by Dalhem a dome-spire sprang white,  
And 'Gallop,' gasped Joris, 'for Aix is in sight!'

'How they'll greet us!' and all in a moment his roan  
Rolled neck and crop over; lay dead as a stone;  
And there was my Roland to bear the whole weight  
Of the news which alone could save Aix from her fate,  
With his nostrils like pits full of blood to the brim,  
And with circles of red for his eye-socket's rim.

Then I cast loose my buff-coat, each holster let fall,  
Shook off both my jack-boots, let go belt and all,  
Stood up in the stirrup, leaned, patted his ear,  
Called my Roland his pet-name, my horse without peer;  
Clapped my hands, laughed and sang, any noise, bad or good,  
Till at length into Aix Roland galloped and stood.

And all I remember is, friends flocking round  
As I sat with his head 'twixt my knees on the ground,  
And no voice but was praising this Roland of mine,  
As I poured down his throat our last measure of wine,  
Which (the burgesses voted by common consent)  
Was no more than his due who brought good news from Ghent.

## **MARCHING ALONG**

### **I**

KENTISH Sir Byng stood for his King,  
Bidding the crop-headed Parliament swing  
And, pressing a troop unable to stoop  
And see the rogues flourish and honest folk droop,  
Marched them along, fifty-score strong,  
Great-hearted gentlemen, singing this song.

### **II**

God for King Charles! Pym and such carles  
To the Devil that prompts 'em their treasonous parles.  
Cavaliers, up! Lips from the cup,  
Hands from the pasty, nor bite take nor sup  
Till you 're—

Marching along, fifty-score strong,  
Great-hearted gentlemen, singing this song.

### III

Hampden to hell, and his obsequies' knell  
Serve Hazelrig, Fiennes, and young Harry as well!  
England, good cheer! Rupert is near!  
Kentish and loyalists, keep we not here,  
Marching along, fifty-score strong,  
Great-hearted gentlemen, singing this song!

### IV

Then, God for King Charles! Pym and his snarls  
To the Devil that pricks on such pestilent carles!  
Hold by the right, you double your might;  
So, onward to Nottingham, fresh for the fight,  
Marching along, fifty-score strong,  
Great-hearted gentlemen, singing this song.

## *LADY DUFFERIN*

### **THE IRISH EMIGRANT**

I'M sitting on the stile, Mary,  
Where we sat side by side,  
On a bright May morning long ago,  
When first you were my bride.  
The corn was springing fresh and green,  
And the lark sang loud and high,

And the red was on your lip, Mary,  
And the love light in your eye.

The place is little changed, Mary,  
The day's as bright as then;  
The lark's loud song is in my ear,  
And the corn is green again,  
But I miss the soft clasp of your hand,  
And your warm breath on my cheek,  
And I still keep listening for the words  
You never more may speak.

'Tis but a step down yonder lane,  
The village church stands near,  
The church where we were wed, Mary,  
I see the spire from here.  
But the grave-yard lies between, Mary,  
And my step might break your rest,  
Where I've laid you, darling, down to sleep,  
With your baby on your breast.

I'm very lonely now, Mary,  
For the poor make no new friends;  
But, oh, they love the better  
The few our Father sends.  
And you were all I had, Mary,  
My blessing and my pride;  
There's nothing left to care for now,  
Since my poor Mary died.

I'm bidding you a long farewell,  
My Mary kind and true,

But I'll not forget you, darling,  
In the land I'm going to.  
They say there's bread and work for all,  
And the sun shines always there,  
But I'll not forget old Ireland,  
Were it fifty times less fair.

*LORD HOUGHTON*

### **SONG**

I WANDER'D by the brook-side,  
I wander'd by the mill,—  
I could not hear the brook flow,  
The noisy wheel was still;  
There was no burr of grasshopper,  
Nor chirp of any bird;  
But the beating of my own heart  
Was all the sound I heard.

I sat beneath the elm-tree,  
I watch'd the long, long shade,  
And as it grew still longer  
I did not feel afraid;  
For I listen'd for a footfall,  
I listen'd for a word,—  
But the beating of my own heart  
Was all the sound I heard.

He came not,—no, he came not;  
The night came on alone;  
The little stars sat one by one  
Each on his golden throne;  
The evening air pass'd by my cheek,  
The leaves above were stirr'd,—  
But the beating of my own heart  
Was all the sound I heard.

Fast silent tears were flowing,  
When some one stood behind;  
A hand was on my shoulder,  
I knew its touch was kind:  
It drew me nearer, nearer;  
We did not speak a word,—  
For the beating of our own hearts  
Was all the sound we heard.

### **THE LONG-AGO**

ON that deep-retiring shore  
Frequent pearls of beauty lie,  
Where the passion-waves of yore  
Fiercely beat and mounted high:  
Sorrows that are sorrows still  
Lose the bitter taste of woe;  
Nothing's altogether ill  
In the griefs of Long-ago.

Tombs where lonely love repines,  
Ghastly tenements of tears,

Wear the look of happy shrines  
Through the golden mist of years  
Death, to those who trust in good,  
Vindicates his hardest blow;  
Oh! we would not, if we could,  
Wake the sleep of Long-ago!

Though the doom of swift decay  
Shocks the soul where life is strong,  
Though for frailer hearts the day  
Lingers sad and overlong—  
Still the weight will find a leaven,  
Still the spoiler's hand is slow,  
While the future has its heaven,  
And the past its Long-ago.

*REV. CHARLES KINGSLEY*

### **THE SANDS OF DEE**

'OH, Mary, go and call the cattle home,  
And call the cattle home,  
And call the cattle home,  
Across the sands of Dee.'  
The western wind was wild and dank with foam,  
And all alone went she.

The western tide crept up along the sand,  
And o'er and o'er the sand,

And round and round the sand,  
As far as eye could see.  
The rolling mist came down and hid the land:  
And never home came she.

'Oh! is it weed, or fish, or floating hair—  
A tress of golden hair,  
A drowned maiden's hair,  
Above the nets at sea?'  
Was never salmon yet that shone so fair  
Among the stakes of Dee.

They rowed her in across the rolling foam,  
The cruel crawling foam,  
The cruel hungry foam,  
To her grave beside the sea.  
But still the boatmen hear her call the cattle home,  
Across the sands of Dee.

### **THREE FISHERS**

THREE fishers went sailing out into the west,  
Out into the west, as the sun went down,  
Each thought of the woman who loved him best,  
And the children stood watching them out of the town;  
For men must work, and women must weep,  
And there's little to earn, and many to keep,  
Though the harbour-bar be moaning.

Three wives sat up in the lighthouse tower,  
And they trimmed the lamps as the sun went down;



They looked at the squall, and they looked at the shower,  
And the night-rack came rolling up ragged and brown;  
But men must work, and women must weep,  
Though storms be sudden, and waters deep,  
And the harbour-bar be moaning.

Three corpses lie out on the shining sands,  
In the morning gleam, as the tide goes down,  
And the women are weeping and wringing their hands,  
For those who will never come home to the town.  
For men must work, and women must weep,  
And the sooner it's over, the sooner to sleep,  
And good-bye to the bar and its moaning.

*ROBERT BURNS*

### **AULD LANG SYNE**

For auld lang syne, my dear,  
For auld lang syne,  
We'll tak a cup o' kindness yet  
For auld lang syne!

SHOULD auld acquaintance be forgot,  
And never brought to min'?  
Should auld acquaintance be forgot,  
And auld lang syne.

We twa hae run about the braes,  
And pou'd the gowans fine,

But we've wander'd mony a weary fit  
Sin' auld lang syne.

We twa hae paidl'd i' the burn  
Frae morning sun till dine,  
But seas between us braid hae roar'd  
Sin' auld lang syne.

And here 's a hand, my trusty fiere,  
And gie 's a hand o' thine,  
And we 'll tak a right guid willie-waught  
For auld lang syne.

And surely ye'll be your pint-stowp,  
And surely I'll be mine,  
And we 'll tak a cup o' kindness yet  
For auld lang syne.  
For auld lang syne, my dear,  
For auld lang syne,  
We'll tak a cup o' kindness yet  
For auld lang syne!

*HENRY CAREY*

## **GOD SAVE THE KING**

GOD save our gracious King,  
Long live our noble King,  
God save the King.  
Send him victorious,

Happy and glorious,  
Long to reign over us,  
God save the King.

O Lord our God, arise!  
Scatter his enemies,  
And make them fall!  
Confound their politics,  
Frustrate their knavish tricks;  
On Thee our hopes we fix  
God save us all.

Thy choicest gifts in store  
On him be pleased to pour,  
Long may he reign!  
May he defend our laws,  
And ever give us cause  
To sing, with heart and voice,  
God save the King!

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